

Sponsorship—Our Privilege and Responsibility

The Twenty-Sixth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1976

Final Report

**Hotel Roosevelt
New York
April 19-24**



Copyright 1976 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.

Mail address: Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, N.Y. 10017



Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

Regional trustees: See p. 35 (Nominating Committee report), pp. 41, 44, 45 (Advisory Actions 6, 51, 54), and pp. 53-54 (information on current trustees).

A.A. regional forums (new name selected by the 1976 Conference to replace "regional mini-conferences"): See pp. 38-39 (staff and trustee reports) and p. 41 (Advisory Action 5).

Changes of region: See p. 35 (Nominating Committee report) and p. 44 (Advisory Action 52).

Confidential — full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

Contents

		Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees General Service Board A.A. World Services Literature distributed - 1975 Archives Conference Cooperation with the Professional Community Finance Group Services Coordinator Assistant Group Services Institutions 1980 International Convention Internationalists Literature Loners Nominating Overseas Policy Public Information Regional Mini-Conferences Staff Coordinator World Service Meeting	28 28 29 29 30 31 31 32 32 33 33 34 34 35 35 36 37 37 38 39 40
Regional Map of U.S. and Canada Million-Member Announcement Opens 26th Conference "Sponsorship - Our Privilege and Responsibility" - Is the Silent Legacy of A.A. (keynote) Delegates' Spouses "On the Town" Tour of Offices "The Important Thing Was . . . Unity" (closing talk) Closing Brunch Stirs Up Memories and Emotions Groups and Members - Spring 1976	2 5 5 6 6 6 7 7	Reports From the A.A. Grapevine Advisory Actions: Consensus Reached on Fellowship Concerns Floor Actions Actions Based on Conference Committee Reports Agenda Cooperation with the Professional Community Finance Grapevine Institutions Literature Conference Policy/Admissions Public Information Committee on Trustees Conference Report and Charter Delegates' Meeting Financial Data Income Statement: General Service Office Income Statement: A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Combined Balance Sheet: G.S.O. and Grapevine 1976 G.S.O. Budget 1976 Grapevine Budget 1975 Group Contributions Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action Rosters 1976 Trustees' Committees 1976 Conference Committees 1976 Conference Members Trustees (General Service Board) A.A.W.S. directors, G.S.O. staff, Grapevine directors, Grapevine staff Area delegates Dr. Bob's Farewell Talk	40 40 41 41 42 42 42 43 43 43 44 44 45 45 46 47 48 49 49 50 51 51 52 53 55 55 59
Presentations and Workshops: Focus on Sponsorship, Literature, P.I. Sponsorship Twelfth Step work - carrying the A.A. message Learning the A.A. way of life Group sponsorship A.A.W.S. - on Literature How A.A. literature happens and what it does Paperback Big Book and alternatives Public Information Media have changed. Can we? Anonymity inside and outside A.A. The difference between attraction and promotion Area Service Highlights Workshops and Discussion Topics: Hospitals, Concepts, A.A. Basics Discussed A.A. and Hospitals Workshops on hospitals produce information Unstructured Workshops Delegates share views and area experiences in wide-open talk sessions The Twelve Concepts For use anywhere in A.A., the Twelve Concepts are both practical and spiritual How the Concepts are applied locally Back to Basics We must not make judgments Do we forget that this is a spiritual program? The Role of the General Service Delegate A sense of responsibility Kitty cans at meetings remind members of A.A. service beyond the group level Facts or Opinions Sought Through Ask-It Basket Who Makes Up the Conference?	9 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 20 20 20 20 21 22 22 23 23 24 27		

BLANK PAGE

Million-Member Announcement

Opens 26th Conference

Opening day

An historic first marked the 1976 annual meeting of the A.A. General Service Conference (U.S. and Canada), April 19-24, at New York's Hotel Roosevelt. The estimated membership of Alcoholics Anonymous has at last reached the "over one million" figure, John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., nonalcoholic chairman of the G.S. Board, revealed in the annual board report to the Conference at the opening session Monday morning.

It was a fitting reminder of the important role that sponsorship has played in the growth of the 41-year-old Fellowship. Dr. Jack stood behind a banner proclaiming the Conference theme: "Sponsorship—Our Privilege and Responsibility." Keynote speaker Pete Watters, Eastern Canada regional trustee, called sponsorship "our silent legacy" (see excerpts below).

Routine matters handled at the opening session included an explanation of who makes up the Conference and introduction of Conference committee chairpeople by Byron Barnes (Eastern Missouri), area delegate chairman. Bob Pearson, manager of G.S.O., then introduced the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs and about 70 G.S.O. and GV employees and department heads as they walked around the Terrace Room, forming an impressive "circle of help" heartily applauded by those present.

About 275 Conference members and spouses, G.S.O. employees, and guests (including Lois Wilson, co-founder Bill's widow) attended the opening dinner in the Grand Ballroom Monday evening. Len Jordan (Southeastern New York) led the A.A. meeting after dinner. Speakers were Harry Lake (Hawaii), Ann Nuckols (Virginia), and Bill Syms (Northeastern Ontario).

Each daily session began with the Serenity Prayer and closed with the Lord's Prayer. Readings of the General Warranties of the Conference, the Concepts, the Traditions, the Steps, or "A Vision for You" from the Big Book were also part of each day's ritual.

Participants were Fran Adams (Chicago), Olga Morris (Southeastern Texas), Raymond Houle (Southeastern Quebec), Fran Green (Eastern Pennsylvania), Gus Jowers (Arkansas), Charlie McCarthy (Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador), Jerry Lapointe (Northeastern Quebec), Robert Wall (Central New York), and Joe Holman (Northern Indiana).

Some morning and afternoon coffee breaks took place either in committee or workshop meeting rooms or in the Terrace Room of the hotel, where all full Conference sessions were held. During breaks, members examined 15 displays and bulletin boards showing facets of A.A.'s world services.

Keynote

'Sponsorship—Our Privilege and Responsibility'—is the silent legacy of A.A.

A.A. had its origin in the principle of sponsorship — the need we have for one another. Sharing our experience, strength, and hope with each other could mean our survival.

This principle is equally as valid today as when Bill carried the message to Dr. Bob. The world of alcoholism has changed, will continue to change. But our need for one another remains as vital today as it was in Akron in 1935. The need is best exemplified by sponsorship.

The privilege of being a sponsor insures our sobriety. It also helps us function effectively in recovery by recognizing the needs of others. It enables us to find within ourselves a response to those needs. Watching a fellow member grow in A.A. is a spiritual experience. It is a privilege for us to be used as instruments in the lives of others.

A gut level of communication occurs in sponsorship. Surely, it is as much a privilege to share the joy of sobriety as it is to share the sadness of the past. No one should be deprived of sponsorship and the fringe benefits that come with it. And no one who enjoys a privilege does so without a degree of responsibility. The most important feature of our Fellowship to the outside world is our accepting the responsibility of caring for another alcoholic. Do we justly deserve this identification? Are we true to our responsibility? Do we confuse sponsorship with fellowship?

Our responsibility is to insure that sponsorship remains a vital part of our program. To minimize it is to deprive ourselves and those to come of the spiritual growth gained in sharing ourselves with others.

Sponsorship is woven intricately through our Legacies. To deny it could weaken our Fellowship. Sponsorship in A.A. has an extra dimension — a loving God. Bill calls it the language of the heart. It transcends the appearance and the personality of the individual and goes directly to the soul.

Many wonderful changes are taking place in the field of alcoholism. But let us not forget that the great strength of A.A. is always one drunk talking to another, where sponsorship begins.

Friends have warned us that the two greatest adversaries of A.A. are power and money. Sponsorship asks nothing of either. It requires a personal giving that neither money nor power provides.

Sponsorship is the silent legacy of our Fellowship, given to us by those who went before us. It can spell the difference between survival and stagnation.

Is sponsorship changing or outdated because of the changing world of alcoholism? The answer stares at us every day. Detox centers and rehab hospitals have brought about a great influx of members. Might we get caught up in the treadmill notion that bigness means greatness, and become impressed by quantity?

Should we not ask ourselves what we are doing with those newcomers we have? Do we insure that they in turn can be responsible when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help? Isn't sponsorship our best way to insure this? Responsible sponsorship can assure us of growth, not only in numbers, but more important, in quality.

Sponsorship is our insurance against becoming a revolving door for drunks, the problem that has plagued many agencies in the field of alcoholism. These agencies eventually recognize the value of referring people to our Fellowship, because they see in us that third dimension characterized by sponsorship. If we are to meet the needs of the changing world of alcoholism, it can best be done through reaffirmation of the principle of sponsorship. A.A. will never be what outside agencies want us to be. We have to be ourselves.

We have often heard it said that we should give until it hurts. In sponsorship, we give until it feels good, and that is just a little

further. To love the lovable requires very little effort, but you and I are called upon to love the unlovable, to help that person become lovable. Can you think of any greater responsibility? Can you think of any better way to do it than sponsorship?

Let us, through this Conference, reaffirm our privilege of and responsibility for sponsorship. Let us go forth as trusted servants, firm in our belief that the love and service upon which our Fellowship was founded will continue to guide us as long as God wishes.

Peter A. G. Watters, regional trustee (Eastern Canada)

Delegates' spouses 'on the town'

New York A.A.'s took turns on the mezzanine of the hotel each day, greeting Conference members' spouses and arranging tours, shopping, and other entertainment. They formed the Hospitality Committee chaired by Muriel Tierney of Manhattan's Lenox Hill Group.



At 468 Park Avenue South, Lois Wilson and former trustee Tom Sharpe took part in a ribbon-cutting ceremony to open the archives suite. Archivist Nell Wing consults microfilm files, displays the Lasker Award, given to A.A. in 1951.



Activities available included sightseeing, boat rides, opera, ballet, theater, sports events, the circus, luncheons, and teas—plus, of course, lots of visits to meetings of local A.A. and Al-Anon groups.

Tour of offices

Delegates trekked by subway and taxi Thursday afternoon to 468 Park Avenue South to see the offices that G.S.O. and the Grapevine occupy on three floors. The shipping department, where A.A. literature is stored and readied for mailing, was an eye-opener to many, as were the large rooms devoted to filing, accounting, and secretarial services and the separate suite of offices where the Grapevine is produced.

But delegates seemed most fascinated by the new archives rooms, where priceless memorabilia of A.A.'s earliest days are displayed and invaluable records of the Fellowship's history are stored for safekeeping.



Closing talk

'The important thing was . . . unity between the two sections of the Conference'

Hi, everybody! I'm a little out of breath. I want to tell you a little bit about our Al-Anon Conference, but first I want to thank you all for showing Al-Anon the way, because we in Al-Anon have copied you in our structure. However, we do have a few changes; our attitudes, our temperaments, and our experience have been different from A.A. members'. But we're liv-

ing the same kind of spiritual program that A.A. offers. At least, we're trying to.

Our Al-Anon Conference has been one of the biggest experiences I've had in a long time. For several years, we've had dissension. The people at Headquarters—at Al-Anon W.S.O. [World Service Office]—were *we*, and the delegates were *they*, or the other way around. The delegates felt, "We are we, and people at Headquarters are they."

How this evolved, I really cannot say, but it was something that was making us all extremely unhappy, both the delegates and the people at Headquarters.

Then our chairman, Ted, had a wonderful idea. The first meeting of the Conference was what he called a "green light" session. Everybody had a chance to ask a question and to say what they wanted to say—all the delegates, all the Headquarters staff, and all the trustees. Each member got up and said what he or she wanted to say. And we went through this "roll call" over and over until everybody had said all they wanted to say. Then we put important questions into categories, for discussion. A lot of the regular Conference agenda was skipped over, because the important thing was to get unity between the two sections of the Conference. It really worked.

We've been laughing half the time and crying half the time, and it has been a terrific experience. I'm just so full of it that I had to come and tell you. It has been simply a beautiful, beautiful Conference—and we have gotten some business done, too!

So again I want to return to thanking you all for showing me personally the way. I don't know what my life would have been like without A.A. and Al-Anon. As I say so often, I don't know which I am, whether I'm an A.A. or whether I'm an Al-Anon member, because A.A. was my first love. I am sure our two great Fellowships will go along hand in hand for as long as God shall need them.

Lois Wilson

It was Donald Shipp (Mississippi) who suggested a new kind of vote of thanks for Conference members as sessions drew to a close Friday. Don asked that gratitude be expressed "to the folks back home who made it possible for us to be here — such as wives, husbands, children, employers, and others." A long round of applause indicated Don had voiced the entire Conference's sense of gratitude.

Closing Brunch Stirs Up Memories and Emotions

Choked-up voices told of deep emotions stirred Saturday morning when four retiring trustees delivered their own "last messages" at the brunch that closed the Conference. (The brunch is not a business session. Afterward, delegates and their wives were guests of Lois Wilson at a reception at Stepping Stones, the Wilson home in Bedford Hills, N.Y.)

Arriving in the Terrace Room that morning, members found on each plate an Early Bird Conference edition of *Box 4-5-9*, summarizing proceedings of the 26th meeting.

Among those on the dais was "Dr. Jack" Norris, who asked for a moment of silence in grateful memory of Dr. Bob, Bill, Father Ed Dowling, the Rev. Sam Shoemaker, Dr. William D. Silkworth, Sister Ignatia, John D. Rockefeller Jr., Henrietta Seiberling, Dr. Harry Tiebout, Ebby, Bernard Smith, and others who had "gone before."

Jim Smith (Arizona), the newly elected area delegate chairman, read "How It Works" from the Big Book, and Byron Barnes (Eastern Missouri), Jim's predecessor, offered thoughts on unity and trust. Bob Pearson introduced many of the people

Groups and members — spring 1976

	Groups	Members
United States	15,308	292,646
Canada	2,511	43,903
Overseas	6,153	126,455
Hospitals	1,351	32,711
Prisons	1,133	36,958
Lone Members		381
Internationalists		536
Totals	26,456	533,590

(Including nonreported groups and members, it is estimated that there are nearly 28,000 groups and more than 1,000,000 members, in 92 countries.)

"behind the scenes" who had worked so hard to keep the Conference running smoothly; then Bob Hitchens offered witty and moving tributes to the four retiring trustees. Summaries of their "last talks" (at a Conference) follow.

'Group conscience . . . the central miracle'

We all have a certain amount of inner tension at saying goodbyes, of course. But undoubtedly, they are a necessary part of the renewal process.

Imagine a laboratory-research-type nonalcoholic like me being welcomed into A.A.! But I have been. And imagine our now having a million members! Yet A.A. is still not a bureaucracy. Power-seeking does not succeed in A.A.

Part of the A.A. miracle is G.S.O. — full of such knowledgeable people, yet always seeking the group conscience. The group conscience is perhaps the central miracle of A.A. I have only one fear for A.A. — fear of the penalty of success. For example, money. When you give it away, you have less of it. But in A.A., the more love you give away, the more of it you have.

Bill used to keep asking me what I was doing about alcoholism in my professional research. He kept worrying about the alcoholics A.A. doesn't reach, and he wanted more and more laboratory-type research done into alcoholism. So I have decided to give a major part of my scientific effort to alcoholism in the future.

And now, as the drunk said, "All right, officer. I'll go quietly."

Vincent P. Dole, M.D.

'God must have a great sense of humor'

I'm convinced strongly that this is a God-given program. That's not a quote. It's from my own experience. My own spiritual background was negative, and in 1963 I was a broken man in body and in spirit — an object more of humor than of pity — a drunken college professor. I was an unemployable man in a profession you practically *can't* get kicked out of. I had lost my

home, my wife and three children, and all self-respect and human dignity.

But finally I got dry — in part because of service for the Grapevine, believe it or not. You see, I went out and celebrated my first A.A. anniversary as a college professor would — I got drunk. But I called Paula at the Grapevine, and my service here began.

Meanwhile, my wife had joined A.A. before me. So we were eventually remarried — this time in a church.

In 1968, I passed another kind of invisible line. Suddenly, surely, I knew there was a God. So I prayed: How could I pay back what I had been given? I didn't dream that would lead to service on the Grapevine Corporate Board and the General Service Board. And God must have a great sense of humor, because once again I am fearfully in debt!

I am now leaving the service structure, but not service. I should like to conclude my A.A. life, not with good words, but with good works. But in farewell I shall read from this scroll we have recently had prepared for the archives. A.A.W.S. will soon make it available. [George read "Dr. Bob's Farewell Talk," a copy of which is shown on the inside back cover of this report. Suitable for framing, like "Bill's Last Message," it can now be ordered from G.S.O.]

George N. Gordon, Ph.D.

'We could have free literature'

I've thought about this moment for four years, and last night tried to make some notes, but gave up.

Let me share a concern of mine. It is about group contributions coming in to G.S.O. — or rather, *not* coming in. I think we owe A.A. \$3.65 apiece a year. Are we going to keep letting the publishing company make the money to support G.S.O., and not support it ourselves? If we all did our share, we could have *free* literature! At any rate, prices will drop when we contribute enough to keep our world services going.

I was born in a town so small they put a decimal point in front of the Zip Code. And I'm not going to tell you about all the groovy things I did in my drinking life. All I remember is throwing up. Once, I went on the wagon . . . temporarily. Then my wife said, "It didn't last very long, did it?" She had already put a clipping about A.A. in my lunch bucket. I figured there would certainly be no A.A. in a town as small as ours, so I said I would call A.A. But when I looked in the phone directory, there it was!

I called and they said, "Come on up." But I got lost and had to park and telephone again. I was right across the street! I knew I was home as soon as I started up the stairs. There at the top was a big picture of a pink elephant. I gave them all my troubles, really unloaded. God, it felt good! Then at the closing of the meeting, I discovered I didn't remember the Lord's Prayer. That got me. I *used* to know it. Why had I forgotten it?

I left pretty fast — headed for a bar around the corner, of course. But suddenly I saw, sticking out of all my pockets, these handfuls of A.A. pamphlets. Naturally, I couldn't go into a bar like that, so I went over to the car to throw them in, but

then got in and found myself driving home instead. I had had my last drink.

Finally, I became a G.S.R., thinking, "My God, they trust me, to act for *them*!" Being D.C.M. certainly helped me — but then the assembly elected a dummy delegate not half so smart as me.

Now that my tour as trustee has ended, I have so doggone much to do, I don't know how I'll get it all done. They have taught me so much; there are so many, many ways to serve, so many things to do. I now fly my own plane. (You helped me realize this dream.) I have my talks with God at 8,000 feet. If I can be of any service, please call, and I'll be winging on my way. I owe you so much!

James G. Griffin

'They weren't gonna blackball me'

I went through all the stages of alcoholism. I went to A.A., left, and drank again. But when the heat was on, I'd go back. Finally, it got out of control, and I decided I really had to quit. Then I ran into some A.A.'s who said they weren't gonna blackball me, although I had told them to go to hell a couple of times. They really wanted me back! It began a whole new feeling, which is still growing.

All I wanted was sobriety. I didn't want all those other things — serenity, moral inventory, and stuff. Now, sobriety is almost incidental, but of course vital. My problems now are me, not drinking.

I owe so much and have given so little. If I live to be 1,000, I'll never be able to repay. I'll be forever grateful for getting to know our nonalcoholic trustees, such as Vincent, Milton, Austin, John, and Arthur. Canadian drunks like me are not supposed to get to associate with such people!

I love them all very much. Furthermore, I do not know of a single instance in which G.S.O. has selected the wrong staff member. I should tell you that when I became chairman of a trustee committee, I thought I, of course, should make the decisions. To my surprise, Bob Hitchins agreed absolutely, and the whole staff backed me up.

Seeing continent-wide A.A. represented in this room is marvelous. I have no fear for A.A. New delegates will get to good bottom lines despite all our foolishness. I'm confident A.A. will go on.

Now, nothing is more past than a past trustee. I've even thought of becoming a social drinker, then applying for a nonalcoholic trusteeship! Board service has been my training period for me. Now my real work begins.

Terrance Penton

In memoriam

Walter Fetterer (Southeast New York), Panel 25
Charles T. McCarthy (Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador), Panel 25

Sponsorship

Sponsorship was the subject of the first presentation-discussion, Monday afternoon, presided over by John Waterfield, Northeastern U.S. regional trustee.

Twelfth Step work—carrying the A.A. message

Involved in both Twelfth Step work and sponsorship are: (1) gratitude for my own recovery, and (2) caring enough to share recovery with another alcoholic.

My recovery started with a faint hope that A.A. might work for me. I had realized on a bleak Sunday morning that I was at my “dead-end street,” and had literally said to myself, “Okay, old girl, you’re hooked!” An A.A. member cared enough to carry the message to me. That was the most important call I have ever received.

There is unsurpassed communication, I believe, between a suffering alcoholic and a recovering alcoholic. Love and concern expressed in eye-to-eye communication—the drinking story, followed by the recovery story—are a Higher Power at work. Twelfth Step work can happen at a meeting, in my office, in a grocery store. I’m now carrying the A.A. message to those who knew me before and those who see me in A.A.

One sponsor told me I had a choice in accepting sponsorship of someone. I had an experience that proved it true. It is unfair to a new person, as well as to myself, if I attempt to do the impossible. I am depriving the newcomer of an opportunity to find the right person if I hang on. I’ll go as far as I can, but when I’ve come to a brick wall, I must back off, for my sake as well as the newcomer’s.

I do Twelfth Step work and sponsorship for two reasons. In every instance, it is a two-way street, going back to what A.A. is: sharing the experience, strength, and hope I have found by helping others. In doing so, my own sobriety is enhanced. If I wanted what I found here, I had to give it away.

While Twelfth Step work and sponsorship don’t necessarily go together, I believe there are prerequisites for both: truly caring for the newcomers, so it is done out of love; having the ability to put myself in their shoes; letting them know I have been there and know how they feel; having established good communication as a result of these efforts, then sharing the recovery story as well. I know in my own heart it is not I, but God as I understand Him, who is truly doing the Twelfth Step work.

In our area, there is still much first-contact work going on. Two-thirds or more of our new people come to A.A. as referrals from courts and hospitals. Many members are helping those people. There are various ways of doing Twelfth Step work. The first impression a new person gets walking into our meeting can be a matter of life or death. Thus it becomes our group responsibility to carry the message by the way we walk and talk, the way we meet and greet people. Boiled down, that simply means attraction — or inspiring them to want what we have.

With new members who got sober in a treatment center, I feel I must give them time and, by attraction, help them to find our way of life. It doesn’t matter to me personally *where* a per-

son got sober, or *who* made the initial Twelfth Step call. What is important to me is that I am available to help another member, old or new, when help is needed.

As an A.A. member, I truly am responsible for carrying our message of recovery. I am what I am this day because someone cared enough to carry the A.A. message to me.

Retha M. Gresham (Central and Southeastern Ohio)

Learning the A.A. way of life

One of the first things I heard in A.A. was: “A.A. doesn’t ask you to change much—just everything you think or do!” After I chose a sponsor, the full significance of that came to me. I thought I was coming to A.A. to stop drinking, and the rest would take care of itself. Little did I realize abstinence was only the beginning.

Today, I recognize just how much I am indebted to my sponsor. He began by impressing on me the necessity of living for today alone, often repeating himself four or five times a day on that subject. Next, he conveyed to me the genuine feeling that he did care what happened to me, that no matter what time of day or night I felt I needed help, I could call him and he would be there. Further, he promised me that if I would do things A.A. asked me to do, A.A. would work for me, too, no matter how unique I thought my case was.

He stated quite firmly that lasting, meaningful sobriety took discipline and lots of hard work. I agreed to abide by his rules. I had to call him every day at an appointed hour. I promised him that if I wanted to drink to solve my problems, I would call him first, and would call him before making any decision of consequence.

We discussed my current problems: My wife was divorcing me; the I.R.S. was after me; and I was out on bail from a grand-theft charge. He said, “Jim, I want you to mentally put your problems in a paper bag and hand them to me. Later on, we will take them out one at a time and work on them. But for now, concentrate all your efforts on not taking the first drink and learning to trust your fellowman. You have forgotten how.”

So changes began to come. Changes, changes, changes, A different way of doing almost everything, but I stayed sober.

The first few times we sponsor someone, it is probably an ego trip, in which we carry the disease rather than the message. Bill W. failed a lot at first, but he stayed sober. You never know a subject well until you teach it. I was told by my sponsor that it would be effective if I would show the way by going the way. By doing things I was telling the new person to do, I would derive the benefits.

The ultimate test of sponsorship is whether or not it is effective on both sides. This does not mean the sponsor is going to be successful every time. But if the sponsor is diligent, he will stay sober.

People voice concern today about strong sponsorship, accusing sponsors of being dictators. “Dictatorships” in A.A. are predicated upon a daily agreement with the dictatee, who can terminate the relationship any time.

I have suggestions I use when working with a new person. They are:

- 1 Go to lots of meetings and don't drink in between.
- 2 When attending meetings, always thank the speaker with a handshake, regardless of how good or bad you thought the talk.
- 3 There is some good in every meeting, so never leave in the middle.
- 4 Be on time at meetings.
- 5 Become active in your group; being passive looks more spiritual, but being active keeps us around longer.
- 6 Making mistakes and doing wrong things are inevitable, but defending them is a big no-no.
- 7 Trust your sponsor, and your trust will not be abused.
- 8 Pick up your share of cups and ashtrays, then pick up one more.
- 9 Call your sponsor every day, even if you just say, "Hi!"
- 10 Don't worry; let your sponsor worry for you.
- 11 Never say no to an A.A. request. You might have to make one yourself some time.
- 12 Help other newcomers, whether you feel like it or not.

I believe a sponsor should be careful not to let the newcomer manipulate him into adjusting to the person he is working with. In turn, the newcomer will respect you more. We cannot change the treatment to suit the patient; the remedy is the same for us all.

Jim Shaw (Southern California)

Group sponsorship

All too often, we concentrate on building a group in numbers and competing with other groups to be the biggest contributor to area or G.S.O. funds, forgetting that the most important person, the one who helps to swell those numbers, is the newcomer—even if he or she arrives at the last minute, sits in the back row, and leaves as soon as the meeting is over.

Some groups rely on the initial contact to sponsor the newcomer for the first three or four months, often with the initial "contact" being only an announcement that the literature is free and the books are available for sale. I thank God it wasn't that way with me.

In the beginning, when I was around the program by coercion, not really believing I needed it, my wife would phone my sponsor. He would call me, and when I said I was doing nothing, he said he needed my company to go to a meeting. He had decided to go after my wife's call, regardless of what he had been doing. Sometimes, he was ready to drive 300 miles round-trip, in the middle of the week. Or he would take 15 minutes

to arrange a card game and call me to say they needed my company as a fourth. Of course, these games always turned out to be just another A.A. meeting with three older members and a newcomer (me).

In one group, a committee gets together immediately it is known a member is present at his first meeting. The committee members take him or her into another room for about 20 minutes to explain some of the program; then they all join the regular meeting. Usually, one of this committee becomes a temporary sponsor.

Another group, normally a study group, suspends study and turns the meeting into a general beginners meeting, probably discussing the First Step.

A greeters committee is a must, with one or more members to greet each person with a handshake, show newcomers to the coffeepot, and introduce them to other members. When a member is sick, a card is sent signed by all members at the previous meeting. On an A.A. birthday, some groups supply sandwiches and goodies to help celebrate. Some groups give a subscription to the Grapevine on the first anniversary, hoping the celebrant will become addicted and carry it on.

When referrals are received from prisons, hospitals, clinics, or recovery homes, some groups maintain a list of people who will meet these referrals on their release and remain with them till they get to a meeting the same day. A list of phone numbers of consenting members is given to such newcomers, so they will always feel they have a friend just a dime away, not the loneliness they have been accustomed to.

I believe group sponsorship is a necessary stimulant to declining individual sponsorship. If our Fellowship is to survive and grow, we must put sponsorship first. Remember: "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible."

Earl G. Homuth (Eastern Ontario)

Workshop report-back: In nine groups of ten each, delegates met four times during the Conference for informal exchange of ideas on various topics. Each workshop was also attended by a trustee and a G.S.O. or Grapevine staff member, but moderated by a delegate.

Delegate-reporters from each workshop met afterward to pool opinions expressed in all workshop sections, and chose one reporter to present a combined report-back to the full Conference. (Workshop reports are not binding or even Advisory Actions; they are simply shared experience.)

Sponsorship was the subject of the first day's workshops, and each section took up nine questions. Sam Smith (Southern Florida) summarized replies in his report-back as follows:

- 1 Almost all older members and all new ones, it was believed, are willing to make Twelfth Step calls on drinking alcoholics. Most A.A. groups have some form of Twelfth Step list.
- 2 Ideas for getting more members interested in sponsorship include: (a) talking about it in discussion meetings; (b) a group inventory; (c) encouraging new people to sponsor; (d) sponsor-

ship workshops or group meetings; (e) forming sponsorship committees; (f) making sponsorship talks; (g) reading Chapter 7 in the Big Book; (h) taking newcomers on Twelfth Step calls; (i) sponsorship chains in the areas; and (j) training area teams to take meetings on sponsorship into districts.

3 In most areas, temporary (60-90-day) sponsors are not appointed. Suggested instead were beginners meetings, hospital-ity committees, exchanging phone numbers or business cards, providing rides to meetings, or letting the group secretary or someone else handle this.

4 Most groups do not have sponsorship committees, but use some of the techniques described in #3 above.

5 Newcomers referred by outside agencies are usually handled just as any other newcomers are. Also suggested were cooperation with court programs, visiting such referrals within facilities before discharge, and special beginners meetings for them.

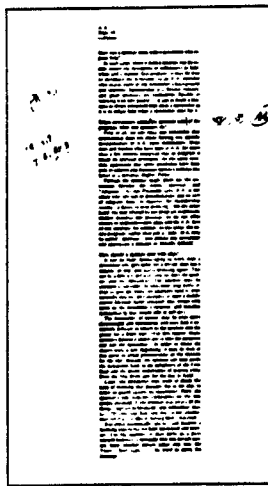
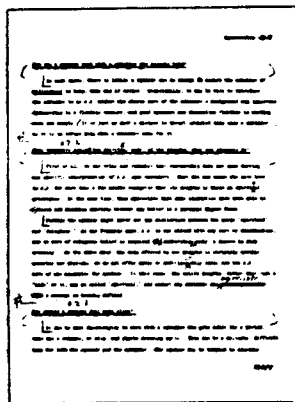
6 Most delegates agreed that both sponsorship and twelfth-stepping seem to be falling down because of availability of treatment facilities. The difference between twelfth-stepping and sponsorship is pretty well understood, but there is room for improvement.

7 No particular different type of sponsorship is needed by alcoholics coming from treatment centers, it was agreed. Sponsorship should be tailored to meet *individual* needs.

8 In most areas, workshops on sponsorship have been held or soon will be.

9 Majority agreed that sponsors try to interest the newcomer in service if they are involved in service work themselves.

Advisory Actions related to sponsorship: 14d, 15, 16 (p. 42)



Pamphlet's progress

After material for a new or revised pamphlet has been approved by trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, it is marked with instructions for the typesetter. Meanwhile, an artist's sketch for a cover design also must be approved. Set in long galleys, type is proofread and arranged to fit pamphlet pages. In the reader's hands, the result helps to carry the message.



A.A.W.S.—on literature

A.A.-published literature and the distribution of other literature by A.A. W.S. were the topics of a presentation-discussion session on Tuesday afternoon. High interest was generated by an exploration of the pros and cons of printing the Big Book in a paperback edition.

How A.A. literature happens and what it does

Historically, the first function of the General Service Office was to publish and distribute the book "Alcoholics Anonymous," in the late 1930's. Income from the book sales enabled the office to handle the flood of inquiries that followed the *Liberty* Magazine article in 1939 and the *Saturday Evening Post* article in early 1941. As the Fellowship began to spread, sales of the Big Book increased, and the office began other services to the fledgling groups as they formed.

The publication and distribution of A.A. literature has continued to be a major function of G.S.O. It is handled through a nonprofit corporation, A.A. World Services, Inc., wholly owned by the General Service Board.

A.A. literature consists of four books, two booklets, 27 pamphlets, and other service material.

The books are:

- "Alcoholics Anonymous," the Big Book, our biggest seller. Its sales are an index of A.A. growth. In 1970, we distributed 54,700 copies; in 1975, 176,300 copies!
- "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (both regular and gift-size).
- "A.A. Comes of Age," our main source of historical lore and insight into the early days.
- "As Bill Sees It," our book of daily readings.

The booklets are:

- “Came to Believe . . .,” the spiritual adventure of A.A. as experienced by individual members.
- “Living Sober,” our newest, a runaway best-seller.

Of our 27 pamphlets, 18 are recovery literature, such as “Is A.A. for You?,” “This Is A.A.,” “A.A. — 44 Questions and Answers,” “Letter to a Woman Alcoholic.”

There are nine service pamphlets. Some pertain directly to service activity within A.A., like “The A.A. Group,” “Inside A.A.,” and “Twelve Traditions Illustrated.” Other pertain to our relations with the medical profession, the clergy, and industrial alcoholism programs. Still others are for public information, like “A.A. in Your Community.”

We also produce a great variety of other service material, including: directories, “The A.A. Service Manual,” “Twelve Concepts for World Service,” P.I. Kits, wallet cards, parchments and wall plaques, a hanging display of the Twelve Steps, displays, and Guidelines.

We have two films, “Bill’s Own Story” and “Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions.”

Generally speaking, G.S.O. is *not* in the business of distributing tapes. A number of individual A.A. members do this quite competently, so, except for the historical material in the archives, we do not involve ourselves in this medium.

New recovery pamphlets originate via the trustees’ Literature Committee. Ideas and suggestions from the Fellowship go first to the committee for evaluation. If the board accepts the committee’s recommendation, the suggestion is referred to the Conference Literature Committee. The latter’s recommendations go to the full Conference for approval, and then, through a Conference Advisory Action, back to the board to be implemented. The project is then referred to A.A.W.S. for writing and production of the pamphlet.

New service pamphlets usually originate via the trustees’ committee or Conference committee concerned — e.g., Public Information, Cooperation with the Professional Community, Institutions—or via the A.A.W.S. board (for the money folder and the G.S.O. folder). The committee perceives a need and recommends a new pamphlet to the Conference via the board.

Concern has been expressed over the proliferation of A.A. literature. In 1975, a Conference action was taken to drop certain older pieces and combine others.

About 6% of all literature distributed by G.S.O. is not sold at all, but is sent out free. In the last (April-May 1976) issue of *Box 4-5-9*, you may have seen the report on this subject, which stated that no-charge literature “amounted last year to well over 300,000 pieces—almost all in answer to individual people writing to A.A., expressing individual needs that must be carefully and conscientiously met.”

A.A. literature always has been, and is today, one of the important ways of carrying the message.

Robert Macpherson, director, A.A.W.S.

Paperback Big Book and alternatives

The 1975 Conference made the following recommendation: “That a feasibility study regarding a paperback edition of the Big Book, and alternatives, be made and reported on at the 1976 Conference.”

The possibility of a paperback had been discussed at several Conferences, without action.

A task force at G.S.O., consisting of Bob Hitchins, Bob Pearson, Dennis Manders, and Midge McFadden, studied the feasibility of a paperback edition. The task force met with: the American Bible Society, which publishes both hardbound and paperback editions of the same books and is one of the largest publishers and distributors of paperback books in the world; Avon Books, a major paperback publisher; Bradbury Thompson, a book consultant; Western Publishing Company and Arcata Graphics, both large printers of paperbacks.

Economic aspects

It is economically and practically feasible to publish and distribute a paperback edition of “Alcoholics Anonymous” if the Conference wishes us to do so after weighing other considerations.

To cover all actual costs and return a proportionate income to help support group services and provide working capital, the retail price of a paperback Big Book would have to be about \$3.50 to \$3.80.

Here is how prices are arrived at, for both the present hardback Big Book and the hypothetical paperback (based on print orders of 200,000):

	Present hardback third edition	Paperback edition
Cost of manufacturing (paper, printing, binding, endpapers, dust jacket, printer’s storage, shipping)	\$1.15	\$.25
Royalty (15% of retail price)	.94	.52
Group discount	.50	.25
Discount donated to pension fund	.50	.25
Average bulk discount	.37	.25
Mailing and overhead costs	1.25	1.10
Total cost per book	4.71	2.62
Income to help support group services and provide working capital	1.54	.88
Retail price per book	6.25	3.50

The example given above is based on resetting the type of the Big Book so it would fit into 336 pages instead of the present 608. Alternatively, it would be possible to reproduce the present pages exactly, reduced slightly to paperback book size. So it would still contain 608 pages. (Cost: 12¢ more per copy.)

Note that in both the above cases, net income to G.S.O. amounts to 25% of the retail price.

Note also that, although all the figures above are based on the retail price, nearly 95% of Big Books sold at present are sold at

the *group* price of \$5.75, or less in the case of bulk orders. A paperback would presumably sell the same way, that is: 95% at the group price of \$3.25 to \$3.55, or less for bulk orders.

Unknown at this time is to what extent sales of a paperback would decrease sales of the hardback. Let us assume for the sake of illustration that we might sell 100,000 copies per year in paperback and 100,000 in the present hardback edition (vs. 176,000 hardback in 1975). The effect would be to lessen G.S.O.'s net income by \$66,000. However, if sales of the regular edition were to drop off even more drastically, then adjustments in the price of the paperback might have to be made.

Alternatives

If the Conference should decide to authorize a paperback edition of the Big Book, then A.A.W.S. would need Conference guidance regarding several options which would then be open, each of which would affect the economics to some extent.

1 Would you prefer a better, more permanent grade of paper than that found in most commercial paperbacks? (Cost: 10¢ to 15¢ more per copy.)

2 A suggestion has repeatedly been made to publish the basic text of "Alcoholics Anonymous" (i.e., the first 164 pages of the Big Book) without the stories in the back. (Some foreign-language editions are published this way, because the American stories are not applicable.) This could be done as a paperback, if the Conference decided to do so. (Savings in cost: up to 10¢ per copy.)

3 Another suggestion has been to publish a gift edition of the Big Book, smaller in size than the present regular edition, bound like the gift edition of the "Twelve and Twelve." If we were to publish a paperback edition, it would be very easy to bind some of the copies into hard cover for this purpose. (These would sell at a considerably higher price.)

4 We have assumed that the 1975 Conference had in mind a so-called rack size of paperback book. There could be, of course, a paperback with a slightly larger page size, like "Living Sober" and "Came to Believe . . ." (Cost: 20¢ more per copy than the rack size.)

Questions to be considered

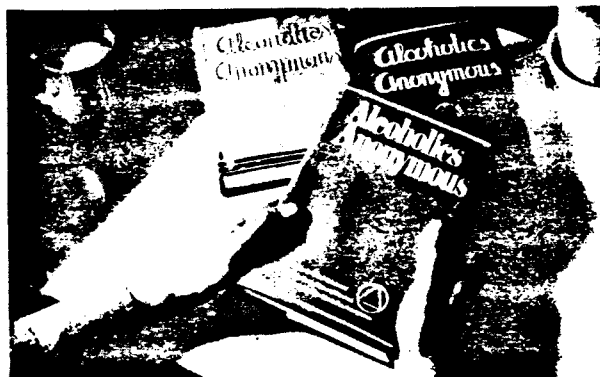
The G.S.O. task force suggests some questions:

- What is the primary purpose of the book "Alcoholics Anonymous"? To carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic? To be a textbook and reference book for each member's continuing sobriety? To be a vehicle for public information?
- Is any newcomer deprived of the A.A. message (or of a Big Book) at present?
- Is the price of the present Big Book a hardship to groups? To individuals?
- Is the purpose of a paperback edition to achieve wider distribution? If so, does the Fellowship want the widest possible distribution?—for example, on the racks in drugstores and airline terminals. Is the Big Book the best vehicle for *attracting* the general public in this way?

- Is the purpose to provide better portability, greater ease in carrying?
- Is a paperback more acceptable to younger newcomers, because they are more accustomed to this format?
- How important is durability? (A paperback book is not designed for multiple readings indefinitely.)
- How important is dignity? Or psychological impact? (In paperback format, the Big Book would no longer be actually a big book in terms of size.)

Robert E. Hitchins, president, A.A.W.S.

Advisory Actions related to literature: 2, 3, 4 (p. 41); 19 (p. 42); 30, 31, 32, 33, 34 (p. 43)



New type, accenting the two A's, and a lighter blue jacket (similar to this report's cover) mark the third edition.

Public information

A.A.'s biggest public information activity of 1975 was based on the Denver Convention, the Conference was reminded Thursday morning by Walter Murphy, chairman of the trustees' P.I. Committee.

But year-round, between-Conventions public information is an ongoing challenge, explored in depth with presentations and discussion.

Media have changed. Can we?

The Conference expressed A.A.'s public information (P.I.) policy thus in 1956: "In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help the still-suffering alcoholic. . . . We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest." This primary objective — to let the alcoholic know there is help — has not changed. But in our 41st year, we face conditions somewhat different from those of our early years, and possibly we have new P.I. needs.

Originally, P.I. efforts were needed to let the practicing alcoholic know that he or she suffered from an illness, and that Alcoholics Anonymous existed and offered hope. Few people had heard of us, and A.A. was almost alone in telling the public about alcohol-

ism. Today, most Americans and Canadians probably know of A.A. and have some idea (possibly incorrect) about what A.A. does. Also, many agencies are informing the public about the problem of alcoholism.

This is a happier situation for the suffering alcoholic. But along with progress, we have new problems and challenges. We may take it for granted that a person with a drinking problem will know about A.A. or will be referred to A.A. by a professional. So some A.A. members feel P.I. efforts are no longer needed. This is not necessarily true; our basic story needs to be continually told and retold to the public and to professionals.

When working with the media, we have conditions different from those of 30 or 35 years ago. Beginning with the Cleveland *Plain Dealer*, *Liberty Magazine*, and Jack Alexander articles, press and broadcasters have treated A.A. very favorably. However, news people want *news*. Our story may not be considered as newsworthy as it once was. A.A. is well established, and the media may feel a need to find new or sensational approaches, or areas for criticism, in the interest of newsworthiness.

We can't blame them; that's their business. One example is the extreme interest in teenagers in A.A. Recently, an A.A. gathering was covered by a young San Francisco newspaperwoman, who was going to write a story titled "A.A. Is Changing." After talking to an A.A. P.I. committee, she produced a fine article emphasizing that A.A.'s basic recovery program and Traditions have not changed at all, but membership now includes more women, young people, and members of minority groups, and A.A. attitudes have progressed along with changing social conditions.

This suggests that we have a challenge: to help the press and broadcasters find interesting ways of telling our story, while also preserving our Traditions and avoiding sensationalism. Perhaps we can show more imagination in working with news people. For example, we may give up a little too easily on television, feeling that, because of anonymity, it is not our medium. Members appear on TV as "recovered alcoholics" without disclosing A.A. membership. But there seems to be very little real A.A. reporting on TV.

Members who were handling the press at the International Conference of Young People in A.A. panicked when told that a TV crew would shortly tape an interview. But after a brief explanation of the Tradition (grasped instantly), TV conveyed, without breaking anonymity, an unforgettable impression of a vital, attractive man with a new way of life. The interview began with an explanation of our anonymity Tradition. There was no implication that secrecy was the result of the stigma of alcoholism. The camera moved constantly, and the film was possibly more dramatic than a static, full-face interview.

The proliferation of agencies has created confusion. A.A.'s role is confused with that of agencies dealing with the alcoholism *problem*. There appears to be less need in our P.I. efforts nowadays to talk about the *problem* of alcoholism; others are doing this very well. But there is a great need to emphasize A.A.'s message of *recovery*, to let the public and professionals know what A.A. is and — just as important — what it is not. More than ever before, in P.I. it is necessary to stress our Traditions: that A.A. is free and self-supporting; that it cooperates, but does not affiliate; and that it neither endorses nor opposes anything.

There has been substantial increase in the number of requests to speak at schools, and speakers report they are talking directly to some practicing alcoholics in such cases. It is recommended that this activity be conducted on a committee (rather than individual) basis, with periodic training for speakers. It is also felt that thorough knowledge of the A.A. Traditions and ability to articulate their meaning are important prerequisites for speaking to professional groups.

A final reason for P.I. really is a fringe benefit. Members who become interested, particularly those who speak to schools and outside organizations, become students themselves, learning about A.A. history, structure, and Traditions. In the process, they gain a broader view of A.A. worldwide. They have much more interest in A.A. service at all levels, and improve the quality of their sobriety.

George Dorsey (Northern Coastal California)

Anonymity inside and outside A.A.

This most important subject has caused problems, through lack of understanding.

"Anonymous" means giving or having no name, unknown, lacking marked individuality or personality.

Our Twelfth Tradition clearly states the case for anonymity: "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities."

In the days of our entrance into A.A., anonymity gave us a sort of security and closeness. We had to use only our first names. Anonymity remains important to those still-suffering alcoholics trying to get in today.

Later on, the quiet disclosure of A.A. affiliation helps the newcomer lose fear of the alcoholic stigma and spread the news of A.A.'s existence in the community, as Bill W. said.

No member should ever reveal another's membership in A.A. Nor should A.A. become an underground movement or a secret society. It might well die.

There is nothing in the Traditions against using full names, either within A.A. or on a person-to-person basis outside the Fellowship. In Washington, D.C., we have for several years urged the use of full names at our assemblies.

Our Eleventh Tradition takes care of anonymity outside A.A.: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio, and films."

Anonymity at the public level protects us from big-shot-ism. The member participating in public events might get drunk, and this would harm the Fellowship's image. Some suggested guides are: (1) Maintain personal anonymity in any articles or autobiographies; (2) use only the first name when speaking as an A.A. member at non-A.A. meetings, and request that no pictures be taken; (3) the title of "A.A. counselor" should be avoided when a member is employed as a professional in the field of alcoholism.

Anonymity proves that personal ambition has no place in A.A.

Each member should be an active guardian of the anonymity tradition.

It is the privilege of all members of A.A. to use as much personal anonymity as they desire. Fellow A.A.'s should respect their wishes. I had my anonymity broken after I had been in about 17 months. I was asked before a group of people, "Fred, are you in Alcoholics Anonymous?"

This had never happened to me before, and I was shaken up. I knew I had to tell the truth. My answer was a curt "Yes. So what the hell is it to you?"

I have never forgotten the reply: "Hey, you're real touchy about it, aren't you? I've been in A.A. for 12 years. Let me tell you something. If no one knows you are in A.A., how can you do any good?" This cured me of ever being anything but proud of being an A.A. member. I am not anonymous except as it is called for in our Traditions. As a newsman, I well understand the need for anonymity at the public level. I will guard your anonymity, too, and never break it for any reason whatsoever.

I believe there is tremendous need for people willing to let themselves be known as persons available to help the still-suffering alcoholic. My doctor, my clergyman, my lawyer, and my boss all know that I am a recovering alcoholic.

We are making progress with the word "alcoholic." It is no longer such a dirty word. Alcoholism is now known as a treatable disease, not a moral issue. This progress was not made by ducking the issue or hiding. This progress was made by devoted members of A.A. and friends of A.A., standing up to be counted and accepting the responsibility to pass on the message that saved our lives.

Fred A. Forbes (District of Columbia)

The difference between attraction and promotion

Probably nothing in A.A. has caused as much controversy as the difference between attraction and promotion. Bill W., of course, was our first promoter. He learned through bitter experience that it is best to let friends do our drum-beating. From these experiences, our Traditions were written.

In the long form, our Eleventh Tradition reads: "Our relations with the general public should be characterized by personal anonymity. We think A.A. ought to avoid sensational advertising. Our names and pictures as A.A. members ought not be broadcast, filmed, or publicly printed. Our public relations should be guided by the principle of attraction rather than promotion. There is never need to praise ourselves. We feel it better to let our friends recommend us."

This tells clearly how important anonymity is. As long as we keep the precepts of A.A., we will attract. Occasionally, in our enthusiasm for our new way of life, some of us slip over the thin line that separates attraction from promotion. In many such instances, we end up promoting our own ego.

We need to remember that we are speaking of anonymity *at the public level*. It is very important that I tell people who were affected by my drinking where I found my help. I need to sponsor my doctor, lawyer, employer, and minister. Many new

members come to A.A. because of referrals by our professional friends who have been impressed by our actions since becoming A.A.'s. Others among our friends do not know the benefits and privileges of A.A. membership. If they have a need to know, how better could we carry the message?

A.A., no doubt, would enable *anyone* who attempts our program to experience a better life. But promotion of the Fellowship as a panacea for *all* who have problems is not our purpose. When early members began to have grandiose ideas about hospitals, research, education, and the like, group conscience forced us to take a second look. We realized these were services best left to the professionals. Acceptance of these precepts, however, in no way prevents us as individuals from working in any project that can benefit from our knowledge.

We hear concern voiced about what some outside agency is doing to our program, and fear that A.A. will be destroyed. It is my firm conviction that no harm can ever come to A.A. except from within our own membership, and the responsibility for keeping A.A. strong begins with me and each of you.

As the "Twelve and Twelve" tells us, "This [Eleventh] tradition is a constant and practical reminder that personal ambition has no place in A.A."

As long as we stick to what we know best, and set an example in our daily lives, we can attract the still-suffering alcoholic. To do otherwise is to promote.

Edith Campbell (North Carolina)

Workshop report-back: Seven questions were taken up in the Thursday-morning P.I. workshop. Summarized by Gus Jowers (Arkansas) in the report-back were these answers:

- 1 General service area or district committees handle P.I. in most areas; but in large cities, it is often done by central offices; in rural areas, by A.A. groups.
- 2 Planning meetings for P.I. workers are now held in most areas, and will be in others. One workshop suggested we stress cooperation between intergroups and G.S. committees on P.I. work.
- 3 Meetings to brief A.A.'s who speak at non-A.A. gatherings are held in most areas, using the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."
- 4 Most delegates were not aware of the special P.I. discount packages available from G.S.O.
- 5 Not everyone was aware of the background editorial material available, but most of those who were said it was used.
- 6 The P.I. approach most used is speaking at non-A.A. meetings. News-media coverage and cooperation with the professional community are next most popular.
- 7 Continual reminders of the difference between revealing A.A. membership at the personal level and breaking anonymity in the media are needed.

Area Service Highlights

Alaska: In the last ten years, the Fellowship here has had steady growth, due to the flow of people coming to Alaska. Take the city of Anchorage as an example. In 1957, population was about 60,000; today, it is approximately 175,000. Meetings are being held in all the major camps along the pipeline corridor. We have about 55 active groups. Rural areas have had small increases as well. Success of the Fellowship depends on the newcomer and how we are carrying the message. My sobriety and life depend on A.A. —*Joe Fuller*

Alberta: When my group asked me to be their G.S.R., it opened a door to a new dimension of A.A. that I had never known existed. I had never read "A.A. Comes of Age" or "The A.A. Service Manual." At the first assembly I attended, I saw Third Legacy election procedure, and was amazed that it worked so well. There were 20 members from 185 groups. Last September, there were 107 members from over 200 groups. The growth can be attributed mostly to holding two assemblies each year instead of one. Service sharing sessions are also held in districts. —*Gordon Matkin*

Arizona: In the last two years, the number of meetings has doubled, and we have seen progress with Indians on reservations. We hosted the Pacific Regional Service Assembly in March, with record attendance. Liaison representations between the area committee and intergroups have eliminated misinformation and misunderstanding associated with personalities, and led to stronger Third Legacy effort. Trusted servants develop ways to involve the maximum number of members in service, without compromising its quality. One part of our responsibility is to find replacements for one another. —*Jim Smith*

California (Mid-Southern): We have 600 groups—possibly over 800, counting groups in clubs—and four H & I committees. Our three central offices received 9,587 calls for help and purchased \$60,000 worth of literature last year. Our 14 districts were subdivided, so each committee member has no more than 12 groups to be responsible for. We hold several one-day service meetings, and over 300 attended a three-day conference last year. At the April assembly, we discussed all Conference agenda topics, and a questionnaire went throughout our area for replies. There is constant turnover among G.S.R.'s; some members feel service work is boring. We'll try to make our D.C.M. meetings and assemblies something the membership *wants* to attend, not *has* to. —*Jerry Frolich*

California (Northern Interior): It began when I asked a leading question and got a leading answer from a visitor who said, "You should have a G.S.R. in this group." I was the secretary; the visitor, an area treasurer. He came to collect money, but he was also after people, and he eventually got me. I became a G.S.R. and a D.C.M. Now that I am a delegate, one thing is sure: I'm learning! Among highlights in our area: establishment of a permanent P.I.-C.P.C. committee, comprising D.C.M.'s; publication of a "Building a Service Structure" pamphlet, with officers' duties and responsibilities and revised election procedures; a well-organized H & I committee, part of our area committee. —*Marge Kemp*

California (San Diego): We have found the greatest stumbling block to the growth of service is abysmal lack of knowledge. At our workshops, the former and current delegates present important facts in short talks. Audiences then are divided into small groups for discussions and questions. A short meeting finishes the workshop, with leaders of the small groups making

short reports. We do one district a month, on a Sunday. Success depends on the job done by the committee member. If he or she turns out the people, things happen! We have asked groups to read the Concepts at one meeting a month. This has been less than enthusiastically received, but we feel the workshops will make members more receptive. —*Cliff Roche*

Delaware: With a small area (110 x 35 miles), I know 90% of our members. About 85% of the 60 groups in our metropolitan area participate in our intergroup. We cover institutions and have a 24-hour answering service. Contributions are received from participating groups. The farming area has 20 groups, and a good intergroup has been started by 13. One area as yet has not been too cooperative. Personalities? —*Bill Cochran*

Georgia: No one has been more amazed than I that I was elected to offices. Often, I wondered: Could they really know what they were doing? The opportunity for personal growth has increased with each office, and for this I am grateful. Those who have elected me are aware of my limitations; I would not have you believe I am anything other than a grateful member who wishes to serve both A.A. and my Higher Power. When I have felt inadequate (as I do now), I remember that God granted me sobriety. I believe He will now give me the necessary wisdom and integrity to fulfill my duties for those I represent and for the good of A.A. as a whole. —*Al Royston*

Idaho: When I was a G.S.R., all that was expected of me was to attend four state assemblies and vote for a state delegate. From then on, I refused to fill any office in my group or state. I was satisfied just being a member and attending meetings. About two and a half years ago, I finally decided I should do more. District Six made me their committee member. I've attended four assemblies, two Pacific Region service assemblies, plus the last Utah Skyline Conference. At our last assembly, my name was put up for delegate, and pulled out of the hat. —*"Swede" Engstrom*

Illinois (Northern): We continue to create more interest in service by holding service workshops. We hope to make G.S.R. work more attractive through a better understanding of what being a G.S.R. means, and how important it is to get group-conscience feelings to our Conference. In July, a state program for detoxifying persons involved in public drunkenness will be handled by law-enforcement agencies. We have set up an institutions committee to explain our position, work with the agencies involved, and maintain strict adherence to our Traditions. —*Earle McNutt*

Indiana (Southern): Several 24 hours ago, I got completely down and couldn't go to work. My doctor had to come to my home and treat me for alcoholism. Here, I think, is where I really met my Higher Power, God. The doctor mentioned A.A., and after meeting you wonderful people, I have had a wonderful life. After reading "The Third Legacy Manual," I decided to get involved. I have had the privilege of starting two groups, as well as serving as treasurer, G.S.R., D.C.M., and chairman of the Indianapolis Intergroup. —*Maurice Haase*

Kansas: I came into A.A. the year Kansas increased the number of districts in the area to 22. I have served as G.S.R., D.C.M., and area treasurer. The highlight of this period in Kansas A.A. has been growth through better communication. Our area newsletter has grown from one page to five pages. More districts are now having monthly meetings of G.S.R.'s. Contribu-

tions have increased, so we are now able to budget funds for public information and institutions committees. Many older members are now interested in more service work.

—*Jerry Sullivan*

Kentucky: We recently redistricted, from ten districts to 13, to serve more than 200 groups. Most districts hold monthly G.S.R. meetings on Traditions, sponsorship, and ways to encourage participation. Some districts also have quarterly meetings with dinner and a speaker. In 1975, we held our first general service mini-conference, attended by about 200. We had workshops, presentations on duties of area committee officers, Ask-It Basket, and two films, "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and "Bill's Own Story." We are making plans for another mini-conference. —*Percy Rogers*

Maine: We are a large area, sparsely populated, and physical communication is nearly impossible during extreme weather. We get together semiannually; for some, that involves up to five hours of one-way driving. Each district is starting to establish its own service structures, including P.I. and C.P.C. committees. Three districts have means of reaching A.A. by phone at some location other than a member's home. Local radio and TV outlets have been most cooperative and generous with public-service time. Facilities funded by the Federal government have brought many into initial contact with A.A., and often hire A.A. members for their staffs. Getting these A.A.'s to observe the Guidelines seems impossible. —*Hank Cleaveland*

Manitoba: Since I came to this program, almost 15 years ago, I have worked extensively with women alcoholics. I was the chairperson for our annual three-day conference, have served as G.S.R. several times, and was railroaded into being a D.C.M. Groups in our area have become very service-minded, studying our "A.A. Service Manual" and really learning what service is all about. I will always be grateful to my sponsor for getting me interested in service work, as I had been going through a bad time in my life, when I felt my sobriety was being jeopardized. —*Marg Fuller*

Maryland: I joined a group so I could serve in many activities. At the start, I only qualified to empty ashtrays, but soon progressed to coffee maker and was trusted with my very own key. My sponsor was active in general service, and I became G.S.R., D.C.M., secretary of the area assembly, then area chairman. Our area has about 340 groups, and in five years our area convention has grown to over 600 people. In 1975, we published the first state meeting directory. At last year's convention, we presented a Twelve Traditions play and received many favorable comments. —*Paul Wright*

Massachusetts (Western): Our area doesn't have districts as yet, but we are very close. I began my service work with a P.I. talk given in a high school. After the meeting, a student came to tell me about her mother's drinking problem. The girl was grateful and hopeful because of the talk. I realized the need for P.I. and joined the P.I. committee. At P.I.C. meetings, we go over the pamphlets we want to give out, and discuss the Traditions or one Tradition at each meeting. As chairman of the P.I.C., I was present at all service committee meetings, to learn what was going on. My new assignment is C.P.C. —*Colette Ross*

Michigan (Western): Speaking to high-school students in the last three years, I have had to allow more time for questions — up to 40 minutes. I believe this can be attributed to lowered

age limits for drinking, increased news coverage on alcohol abuse, and the A.A. P.I. programs on radio and TV. In many schools, when I have been asked to come back, the principals have the entire school assembled, even the teachers, and up to two hours is given. This is the time of life when many of us had our first experiences with alcohol. Had I been aware then that help was available, perhaps I would not have had to suffer 25 years. —*Jim Rouse*

Minnesota (Northern): When I joined A.A., our group — like most in the area — did not have a G.S.R. The first assembly I attended had about 25 people, including A.A. visitors and Al-Anons. Time was spent on issues that should have been resolved at the group level. All A.A.'s attending voted. So some groups got more than one vote each. Many times, we didn't have back-ground information to make decisions. Our last assembly had 62 voting members. Every district has a committee member who has shown interest in our Third Legacy. Out of 180 requests sent to the groups for group information, we received about 150 answers. —*Vern Radke*

Mississippi: The greatest concerns in my area are intergroup visits and communication. Regular contact and sharing between groups give the same strength and stability to groups that interpersonal sharing does to individuals. Several halfway houses have been established in our area during the past five years. Alcoholic rehabilitation programs offer services not found in A.A., such as medical, job placement, and welfare referral. It is our feeling that we A.A.'s should cooperate. Dealing with a killer, we have no time for petty jealousy of other agencies. Alcoholics need all the help they can get. —*Don Shipp*

Montana: Through P.I. work, we got new members to help us stay sober, and then had to start more groups. I have served as G.S.R., secretary and treasurer, and member of steering and P.I. committees. We had our first work assembly in Montana last year, and will continue. In Missoula, we have an alkathon every Christmas. In Helena, we have an annual Thanksgiving dinner that is very successful. At the state rehabilitation center, we hold open meetings every week. We also have a good group of A.A. meetings in our state prison. —*Cecil Williams*

Nebraska: I attended meetings almost three years before becoming desperate and humble enough to ask help from my Higher Power. Sobriety was almost immediate. About four months later, I was named G.S.R. My group began to ask questions, making it necessary for me to study a lot of A.A. literature to provide answers. During six years on the state committee, I participated in several state reunions and met people from all over. I pushed for more participation by G.S.R.'s at both their home-group meetings and state committee meetings. I am proud to be their delegate. —*Marvin Karmann*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Our area has about 1,300 members in 100 groups. It is about 500 miles long, and when you toss in a 45-minute ferry trip, you have a substantial deterrent to successful assemblies. We have tried reducing the number of assemblies from four to two and replacing the others with mini-assemblies or roundups. My personal introduction to service began at the end of a mop handle. Slowly, I learned that one's personal problems seem to fade when one is active helping others. From then on, a personal must was: Try never to say no to a request to do something for A.A. But when my name was drawn from the hat as delegate, I immediately resolved never to say yes again. —*Ken Dunphy*

New Hampshire: Our area is growing fast: 36 groups a few years ago; over 100 today. We now have nine districts, each having a monthly meeting. One has a workshop on "The A.A. Service Manual" and the Concepts, with a visual aid. A couple of districts have monthly Sunday breakfasts. Two have started an answering service. We have an active institutions committee and outside G.S.R.'s for groups in three institutions. One member writes an article for a statewide newspaper twice a year, with an up-to-date list of meetings. —*Mary Jane LeBlanc*

New Jersey (Southern): After I was asked to speak at the public level, I became very interested in P.I. and C.P.C. work. I sense a vast need for us to cooperate with detox centers, inpatient and outpatient facilities, and halfway houses. A few years ago, I looked into the Traditions—much more important in the A.A. way of life than I had ever realized. The Traditions should be talked about and understood at group level, so that when we sponsor, we know what A.A. does and does not do. The Concepts are revealing themselves slowly to me; the mystery unravels as I get deeper into Conference work. —*Maggi Bolton*

New Mexico: Several public meetings were held and were well received, with good media coverage. Some redistricting was done, and we saw benefits immediately. Each district has its own institutions and P.I. chairman, with a small working fund, supported by the groups, for public meetings, travel, correspondence, and literature. Some districts have a C.P.C. committee, while others let the central office handle this. Districts and C.O. do such an outstanding job, we have found no need for an area C.P.C. committee. Some groups have started contributing, after expenses, 60% to C.O., 30% to G.S.O., and 10% to area. —*Larry Kloeppel*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): After 23 years, our area decided to start assembling in districts. In six years, we have grown from 60 groups to 135. In the past year and a half, district meetings have been inspiring G.S.R.'s to take an active part in group and district functions. Three years ago, we adopted a pocket-size-booklet form of meeting schedule, convenient and readily usable. The supply has grown from 6,000 to the 1976 printing of 16,000, showing 180 meetings per week. —*Charles Wysocki*

New York (Western): The chairman of our C.P.C. committee is elected by the assembly, is preferably a past delegate (I was not), and has a free choice of whom he would like to serve on the committee. I chose the current delegate and two past delegates, and we finished with ten members, most of them experienced on committees in every related field. Wherever alcoholics are held or treated, A.A. groups closest to the facility set up meetings in rotation. From this participation comes sponsorship. Some facilities have a large number of alcoholics, who can overwhelm an "outside" meeting. Meetings at the facilities take the pressure off. —*Jim McCullough*

North Dakota: When I was nominated for group chairman, I thought, "This must be quite an honor." I recognize now that the biggest problem is to get someone to accept the job and do it! After being elected delegate, I said to my wife, "I wonder how many really important A.A.'s there are in North Dakota." "One less than you might think!" she said. In the past six years, our area has worked at getting greater participation from groups, in attendance at G.S.R. or D.C.M. meetings and in contributions. We have had improvement, but it's a never-ending battle; while we get new groups participating,

others drop away. Closer, more frequent contact with individual groups is one answer. —*Bud Grondahl*

Ohio (Northwestern)/Michigan (Southeastern): I asked what could be done to create a better understanding of unity. I got help in information from G.S.O., past delegates, and many G.S.R.'s. First, it was important to tell G.S.R.'s what was going to happen, so a letter was sent to them. We then began to share in monthly sessions the subjects to be talked about. What is G.S.O.? What is a G.S.R.? How is sponsorship changing? What about clubs? And Guidelines? (Many G.S.R.'s were not aware of Guidelines, so we made them available. I suggest that Conference kits include all Guidelines.) —*Bill Tarjanyi*

Ohio (Southwestern)/Kentucky (Northern): Serving as G.S.R., D.C.M., area treasurer, and area chairman, I have seen much progress through our efforts to get the area more service-minded. We have had successful banquets and boat rides, sending nice contributions to G.S.O. as a result. Our committee and assembly meetings are well attended and interesting. We also cooperate closely with A.A. intergroups. After reading the book "A.A. Comes of Age," I could really see the importance of our Third Legacy and Twelve Traditions. What better way to express gratitude than that of service? —*Dick Foster*

Ontario (Western): As G.S.R., I passed everything on to my group I thought they should know, and carried the group conscience with me. As committee member, I held district meetings bimonthly and kept in touch with the delegate. No person in our area is kept from service by the expense involved. G.S.R.'s go to group treasurers; D.C.M.'s, to the district treasurer; area officers, to the area treasurer; alternate and delegate, to the Ontario general service secretary. If we would rather pay our own way, and can afford to, we can put it back in the collection plate. We are all able to be active in service work under this setup. —*John Rose*

Oregon: My service work started with the usual group "initiations" during the first year, and I went on from there. I have felt inadequate, but have also felt a strong responsibility toward A.A. as a whole, for all it has given me. Since we inaugurated quarterly mini-assemblies, we are attracting more G.S.R.'s and general A.A. attendance. We have workshops and sharing sessions concerning all phases of service. The interest shown is a great stride toward a more fully informed Fellowship. —*Leonard Truitt*

Puerto Rico: We have an area committee of 14 members. Each of five districts is composed of about 12 groups. Four committees serve the area. Our P.I.C. has inserted spots in the three local newspapers of highest circulation and obtained time on the two most important radio networks and on two TV networks. Our bulletin committee puts out 1,000 copies of an eight-page paper. Our literature committee now has available all types of Conference-approved literature published in Spanish. Our Twelfth Step committee, recently appointed, receives all communications asking for help, and distributes them to groups. —*Jeronimo Reyes Jr.*

Quebec (Northwestern): On my first encounter with A.A., at 22, I was given the feeling that I could not be an alcoholic because of my youth, although I had achieved skid-row level. After seven years of hell, I was given another chance. This time, it was different. I became a member of a young people's group, where I had the feeling of being accepted. Our area covers

5,000 square miles. We have meetings every two months attended by D.C.M.'s, delegate, and alternate. We find information at the district level of great importance. —*George McKerral*

Quebec (Southwestern): Curious by nature, I became involved in A.A. very quickly. One word out of thousands struck me: "continuity." So I kept on being available and responsible. Working for a year and a half with our delegate, we started to structure our region as suggested in "The A.A. Service Manual." Today, we have 16 districts for over 320 groups. We have monthly meetings, with information on structure, Traditions, groups, and sponsorship. D.C.M.'s are already active in committees, so G.S.R.'s are more interested in our services. With love, service, and faith, we are today preparing for tomorrow. —*Jean-Luc Bergevin*

Rhode Island: During the past two years, our area committee has reorganized. We are secure in the knowledge that our problems can be solved by using our Steps, Traditions, Concepts, and Conference service structure. Four local answering services now handle alcoholics' calls for help. Area P.I. and C.P.C. committees have been established, functioning according to G.S.O. Guidelines. Service structure "schools" are being initiated on a district level. Some of our concerns: disunity and inactivity in some areas; lack of group sponsorship; inactive older members; insufficient service-minded members; lack of active group members, in spite of numerous meetings. —*Jim Jones*

Saskatchewan: Our area sponsors an annual G.S.R. and D.C.M. two-day workshop. This year, the highlight is a mini-conference dealing with the same topics as our agenda here. Because of an enthusiastic P.I.C., A.A. information is now channeled over our entire area. Two new committees starting are: Grapevine and cooperation with the professional community. We regularly invite business and professional people to luncheons. This lets us carry the message and repay our debt of gratitude to many nonalcoholic friends of A.A. —*Stan Cameron*

South Carolina: In 1970, our delegate began to bring our structure more into line with "The A.A. Service Manual," sometimes over strong opposition. New bylaws were adopted; the office of chairman was established; weekend area meetings were set up. Five district organizations are in their second year of function. Much still needs to be done in the definition of duties and fuller utilization of D.C.M.'s. Our chairman held the first G.S.R. workshop at our January meeting, with over 80 people present. At the assembly, 56 groups were represented; more than 200 people were registered for the weekend meeting. At the September assembly, when new officers were elected, 65 groups were represented. —*Joe Kirby*

South Dakota: My sponsor was a delegate and pushed me into service. I am also a director of our county drug and alcohol information and referral center, operated by A.A. volunteer workers with no Federal or state money. We have 70 groups with membership over 1,830. We have a spring and a fall conference and two midterm meetings, where much state business is discussed. If important, it is put on the agenda to be voted on at the next conference. At veterans and state hospitals, volunteer groups put on weekly meetings. —*Joan Ullom*

Tennessee: We changed from six to 20 districts and broke the metropolitan areas into subdistricts. This gives a workable area size, gives more people a share in service work, and gives the state a larger selection of people from whom to pick the dele-

gate. In 1974, an assembly was called in Nashville. There was much worry over getting 40 people — what the motel had to have guaranteed. It far exceeded that number. At successive meetings in other parts of the state, there were more people, greater participation, and many new faces. Over 200 registered for our January assembly. A committee is working on a state directory. —*Joe Kraus Jr.*

Texas (Northwestern): We had our assembly in February, with a good turnout and lots of discussion on sponsorship. Everyone likes the idea of getting back to basics. The fact that many members do not have a home group may come from lack of sponsorship. Our area is spread over 600 miles, and it is difficult to get a true feeling of group conscience. Our next assembly will be in the summer, then one in October. —*John Gillespie*

Texas (Southwestern): This year, we have redistricted our 230,000-square-mile area from eight to 14 districts, with about nine and a half groups for each committee member. Mini-workshops acquaint incoming D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s with their responsibilities. A very active P.I.C. operates in cooperation with the central office, sending speakers almost daily to high schools, colleges, luncheon and other civic organizations, and churches. For many years, we have held a workshop before each General Service Conference. Attended by D.C.M.'s, G.S.R.'s, past delegates, and others, these workshops help develop a group conscience about agenda subjects. For months, I have been holding discussion and speaker meetings on using the Traditions for personal recovery. —*Gene Daniel*

Vermont: I began my service experience with the coffeepot. I discovered the great value of rotation, and the detrimental effect on a group that does not use it. I joined another group and found myself a new coffeepot. Here, I discovered the rewards in personal growth that come with group responsibility. In 1971, I was elected secretary and treasurer. I may have achieved this position because I was the only member not making car payments at the time. Mutual trust comes slowly in our Green Mountains. District structure also is painfully slow in becoming a living reality. This has hampered our developing good public information and institutions committees. —*Nancy Thomas*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Michigan (Upper): I came into a small group (four members), which included a delegate and an active Grapevine contributor (now editor of its "Once Over Lightly"). So I saw that if sobriety was going to be the game, service was going to be the playing field. These people did not glorify their service, but passed the torch. They did not tell me—they showed me. My election as G.S.R. and later delegate says very little of me, but shows our future members what sponsorship can do. Our area conferences always have 75% or more attendance by past delegates. Our G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s are active in area affairs. We have open communication among all levels of service. —*Leonard DeWitt*

Wyoming: In 1965, I was elected group secretary-treasurer; in 1967, G.S.R.; in 1969, state committee member; in 1971, state secretary-treasurer; in 1975, alternate delegate. The secretary-treasurer of the state left Wyoming in 1975, so I was asked to finish her term. In January of the same year, our delegate passed away. That left to me the jobs of delegate, alternate delegate, and secretary-treasurer. I was serving in those jobs when I attended the Conference last year. In the fall of 1975, I was elected delegate, and through the help of A.A. and the grace of God, here I am again. —*"Turk" Lassiter*

Hospitals, Concepts, A.A. Basics Discussed

A.A. in hospitals

Workshops on hospitals produce information

For the workshop on Tuesday evening, there were seven questions to be answered by each section. Answers revealed in the workshop report-back given by Edith Campbell (North Carolina) displayed a wide range of varied information about different ways the A.A. message is carried into hospitals.

- 1 Most areas have an institutions committee in which most districts participate, some through intergroups, others by means of groups or individuals. In some areas, a hospitals or institutions committee is autonomous.
- 2 Institutions committees serve prisons, as well as hospitals and rehabs, in most areas. How this is done varies a bit according to local needs and the views of institutions officials.
- 3 In almost all areas, A.A.'s go back to participate in meetings in hospitals and rehabs after leaving these facilities, and this is considered helpful.
- 4 In a few areas, A.A.'s employed by hospitals and rehabs do conduct meetings in these facilities (especially county and private institutions), but this is not usually the case. It was suggested that A.A.'s employed in such places review the Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.
- 5 A.A. literature in most areas is furnished free for hospitals and rehabs by an institutions or district committee, an intergroup, or an A.A. group; but in a few cases, facilities purchase literature for their patients. Many areas do not take advantage of G.S.O.'s discount packages for hospitals, and some did not know about the packages.
- 6 Arrangements for patients to attend A.A. meetings after discharge include: liaison persons within groups; contacts through counselors; arrangements by facilities; simple referral by hospitals; and temporary sponsors.
- 7 A.A.'s can become more available for twelfth-stepping in these facilities by use of workshops, sharing sessions, bulletins, one-day institutions conferences, and education at the group level. Oldtimers could also take newer members to visit in hospitals and rehabs.

Advisory Actions related to A.A. in hospitals: 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29 (p. 43)

Unstructured workshops

Delegates share views and area experiences in wide-open talk sessions

Among topics discussed at ten unstructured workshops Wednesday evening were: increasing group support of G.S.O., A.A.-Al-Anon cooperation, delegates' reports, use of A.A. directories, intergroup services, cooperation with professionals, sponsorship for service work, A.A. meetings in industrial plants, abuse of nonalcoholic mood-changers, the Regular Contribution Plan, Grapevine articles, objectionable language at A.A. meetings,

building service structures, and rotation (especially of long-time group "officers").

These were informal sessions, with a wide range of experiences shared. No formal report-back was made to the full Conference, but written reports on all Conference workshops were mailed to Conference members in May.

Before Lois, widow of A.A. co-founder Bill W., made the closing talk Friday afternoon (see p. 6), three discussion topics were gone into by six Conference members.

The Twelve Concepts

For use anywhere in A.A., the Twelve Concepts are both practical and spiritual

At this point in our A.A. experience, we are ready to feel and utilize that final gift our founders left us, the Twelve Concepts for world service. They are a beautifully simple design for the functioning of our service structure. We have a responsibility to become comfortable enough with the Concepts to visualize the whole pattern and recognize the sound principles within them — principles that can be applied, not only to every part of our service structure, but also to our *own* thinking and efforts.

The First Concept tells us that the final responsibility and authority for A.A. rest with the whole Fellowship's collective conscience—the voice of every single A.A. member as it is expressed through participation in his or her own A.A. group. Wouldn't it be wonderful if we could help a newcomer realize the far-reaching influence of a single voice?

In the Second Concept, the groups give the Conference authority for the active maintenance of world services. In our areas, delegation of authority is also applied, as G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s act for the groups. But to operate effectively, the principle of trust must be applied.

Servants must be trusted to make decisions. Our Third Concept talks about this "Right of Decision." To have clear working relationships among all service elements, and thus assure effective leadership, we must endow each element of world service with a Right of Decision. When we return to our areas, we can bring this Concept to the attention of groups that withhold trust from their service representatives.

Concept Four tells us that each group of our world servants (including those in our central offices) has a right to participate in the decision-making.

The Fifth Concept gives each individual in A.A. the "Right of Appeal," assuring that minority opinion will always be heard, and that personal grievances will always be considered. Often, we have reacted with anger to someone expressing a loud minority opinion locally. We have a real responsibility to make our areas aware of the valuable service this minority performs. It makes us stop and think carefully. Its pressure forces the majority to become an *informed* majority.

The next three Concepts describe further delegation of responsibility and authority by this body (the Conference) to trust-

ee members of this Conference, who assume *active* responsibility. The board maintains custodial oversight, but it delegates day-by-day management to committees and others equipped to carry out these responsibilities. The board holds legal responsibility for world services, but at the same time, the Conference Charter, the Traditions, and the power of the A.A. purse strings make an effective system of checks and balances. These same checks operate in our areas: District and area committees must function effectively to retain the financial support of groups.

Discussing Concept Nine, about good service leaders, Bill says, "No matter how carefully we design our service structure . . . no matter how well we apportion authority and responsibility, the operating results of our structure can be no better than the personal performance of those who must man it and make it work." Almost every area problem could be avoided with the selection of good service leadership. The success of our whole service structure rests on every G.S.R. and D.C.M. They are the *primary* representatives of the A.A. group conscience.

If we have observed the Ninth in choice of good leaders, it will be easy to apply the next two Concepts. They tell us each service responsibility should be matched by equal service authority.

The Six Warranties, stated in Article 12 of the Conference Charter, are restated in our Twelfth Concept because they have a permanent importance to A.A.'s general welfare. They tell us that we should never become money- or power-conscious; that we are all equals; that decisions should be made, if possible, only when we are substantially agreed; that our actions should never be judgmental; and that we should act at all times as trusted servants only. The Warranties are guides for the relationship of the Conference to all of A.A.; but they are also guides by which any group of A.A.'s, anywhere, can work effectively together to keep our Fellowship safe for those yet to come.

Not only are lines of communication clearly drawn in our Twelve Concepts, but we are also given methods for communicating that are full of A.A. love and respect for the dignity of each individual. Indeed, our Twelve Concepts are the *spiritual foundation* for all of A.A.'s world services.

Margaret J. Carlson, general service trustee — U.S.

How the Concepts are applied locally

I am sure that when Bill wrote the Concepts, he realized they would not be generally known. Too few really understand the Traditions, let alone the Concepts.

However, I believe the Concepts, like the Steps and the Traditions, were divinely inspired. When I read Bill's biography, this became more apparent than ever before. The main reason Bill wrote these Concepts was to aid future workers in world service, so that we could avoid repetition of earlier mistakes. He wanted to preserve principles that had become traditional—such as the Rights of Decision, Participation, and Appeal. He said the Concepts "provide a ready means of safe return to an operating balance" if we make mistakes.

If the Concepts are limited in application to A.A.W.S., the board, and the Conference, then we are not utilizing them to their fullest. They should help us solve area problems. The Concepts can apply on this level everywhere. It's up to trusted ser-

vants to help educate areas on use of the Concepts locally. We could urge D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s to study the Concepts; we could encourage workshops and discussions on their application at all service levels.

Just as Tradition Two explains that the group conscience is the ultimate authority for group problems, the First Concept defines the ultimate authority on the service level. Groups in an area provide the collective conscience of A.A. in that area regarding problems unique to it. Many service problems are limited in scope to an area or even a district, and the Concepts can be applied at each level.

Concept Two delegates to our Conference complete authority for active maintenance of world services; but area conferences are an arm of *this* Conference, and the principle of this Concept filters down, subject, of course, to the autonomy Tradition. We should impress on D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s that they are a part of this Conference. They have authority over local service problems, and the manner in which they use this authority can greatly influence A.A. services. The area conference is the conscience of A.A. in local service areas.

The Right of Decision (Third Concept) is as effective on the local level as at the Conference level. Committee members and G.S.R.'s should have the Right of Decision without binding instructions. As Bill says, a trusted servant "who cannot act on his own conscience . . . is not a trusted servant at all . . . just a messenger." We should encourage the use of the Right of Decision at our area and district levels. "Our entire program rests upon the principle of mutual trust."

The Right of Participation (Concept Four) should be accorded to our world servants at all responsible levels of A.A. If serious problems arise in our areas or districts, we can point to this Concept to help solve them. We should not refuse to hear the voice of any duly elected committee member or G.S.R. who wishes to express himself or herself. Decisions should not be made arbitrarily without the participation of trusted servants at each level. Bill said, "All of us desire to belong. We want an A.A. relation of brotherly partnership."

In our areas, it is important for each group G.S.R. and each committee member to recognize that he or she has somewhere to go to express dissatisfaction with group, district, or area service activities. This is recognized in the Right of Appeal (Concept Five). It should be exercised only when the minority believes an issue could affect A.A. as a whole. Bill said any person in our service structure can carry a complaint directly to the board, but it is best to exercise this right on the area level first. If every complaint came directly to the board, the trustees would have time for little else.

Concept Six recognizes that area conferences have the final decision on local matters of policy and finance. Seven points out that our source of area authority is not legal, but traditional, and we must rely on group finances for area conference effectiveness.

Concept Eight appears to apply to the board, but if we substitute area service officers for trustees, we see how this can be used in policy and finance matters in our areas.

Each area conference can decide what method is best in choosing service leaders. In applying Concept Nine locally, we must

encourage the best available people, to preserve future effectiveness of the Conference and board. From our areas will come our future delegates and A.A. trustees.

Concept Ten defines some principles involved in "ultimate authority." A thorough understanding of this enables each service worker to better understand his or her own responsibility and authority.

I suppose everyone understands the importance of putting competent people in responsible jobs (Concept Eleven). If we are not conscious of length of sobriety, dedication, sincerity, and intelligence when we form committees in our areas, we will not function well.

Concept Twelve is unique. It contains the Six Warranties, each of which is constantly being used locally. Our Traditions are almost rewritten in the Warranties. How often I hear these principles in group and area discussions! — avoid wealth except for an ample reserve; no one is the boss; discussion and vote; no punitive actions or public controversy; no government. All of these are often discussed locally.

Some day, we can say, "Isn't it great how well understood our Concepts have become?" A start in this direction would be for each delegate here to stress the Concepts on a local level. Let's try!

Samuel E. Smith (Southern Florida)

Advisory Action related to Concepts: 55 (p. 45)

Back to basics

We must not make judgments

Are we getting away from our A.A. basics in the content of our meetings? I believe we are. Have we gotten a little complacent and smug? People today are coming to Alcoholics Anonymous in far better shape than most of us did. We need to show them how we learned to stay sober. If our meetings consist mostly of drinking experiences, we are not doing our jobs.

Dr. Bob said our program is love and service. I suspect we are still good at service. But have we forgotten to be first of all loving? Our meetings should first of all show people we care. We must not make judgments about why they are there or where they came from. We need to show *all* these people we love them as we were loved, and we have a way of life we wish to share. If our meetings are nothing but drunkalogs, we are not showing people "how it works."

When a person comes to us after 30 days in a rehabilitation center, he or she needs to know how we are staying sober. Many of our meetings are not really covering this heavy responsibility, though we do have some Big Book meetings, discussion meetings, and Grapevine discussion meetings.

To me, it is vital to share our fears and frustrations before *and* after our last drink. If we don't let new people know that they can stay sober in bad times as well as good, where will they hear it?

Are we stressing the real value of the Big Book? You can go to meetings in my area where you can't even *find* a Big Book. Do we forget to tell newcomers that what is in this book can save their lives? Our program is in the Big Book. Shouldn't we be telling people that?

We hear such ridiculous things as "There are no musts." My book reads different. People say it is an individual program. Dr. Bob said, "There is no such thing as an individual interpretation of the Twelve Steps." These Steps were written by Bill and our oldtimers from their experiences. If we are not honest with the new people and do not tell them how important each Step is, who will tell them? People seem to feel the Steps are a necessary evil, instead of a lifesaving prescription for happiness.

We rarely hear about our Traditions. The fact that these came about because of our mistakes is almost a secret. When I first wanted to get a copy of the "Twelve and Twelve," a G.S.R. told me the Traditions pamphlet had all I needed. Thank God, I didn't listen to him.

Each year, I look at the sales figures of the Big Book against those of the "Twelve and Twelve," and I wonder why they are not closer to being the same. It is my judgment that we have never convinced the Fellowship of the value of our Traditions.

In 1965, at Maple Leaf Gardens in Toronto, most of us stood up with Bill and said, "I am responsible." Having been there is the reason I am standing here now. We are the guardians of this Fellowship, and maybe we need to do a better job of sharing what it is all about. Are we still responsible?

Robert Bacon (Northeastern Ohio)

Do we forget that this is a spiritual program?

Somewhere out there is a woman as sick, helpless, and miserable as I was one night in 1966. Should there be within that agonized body a mere spark of wanting, maybe—God willing—help will come through Alcoholics Anonymous. Help for her could come from other programs. Some alcoholism facilities are having good results, or they wouldn't exist long. But in the years since Bill discovered the key—helping another alcoholic—we have found through the A.A. program much more than dryness. We have a way of life.

I am concerned that we may still try to incorporate different or experimental ideas of others into our program. At meetings, we often hear about our "addiction" to the "drug" alcohol. These terms have come from the medical profession. Our Big Book refers to our malady as a "disease" or an "illness." We may soon be but a step away from identifying ourselves as "drug addicts." Let us not take that step! Our disease concept may seem old-fashioned, but it has worked. I understood "disease" because it compared somewhat to diabetes, while "addiction" and "drug" seem related to heroin. Let us keep our basics unchanged. This also applies where we try to incorporate religious, self-improvement, or group-therapy ideas. We lose, in the process, the simple program that has proved itself over and over again.

I am convinced A.A. contains all the ingredients for a complete, satisfying way of life. Constant searchers for "more" to enhance their program seem always to end up drunk. Could there be a lesson for us there, when we tend to wander away from our

basics? Do we forget that this is a spiritual program? Talking to the newcomer, we soften or eliminate the words about God, in effect saying God had nothing to do with the newcomer's being there. Then we are actually denying the validity of our Twelve Steps.

In other ways, we drift from basics. In a recent pamphlet, an opening paragraph asks, "Do you want to do more about helping alcoholics than simply doing A.A.'s primary job of carrying the message?" [Note: In the latest printing of the pamphlet referred to, "How A.A. Members Cooperate," this sentence was deleted.] *Simply?* We must have forgotten that this was the very essence of our beginnings, when Bill made his wondrous discovery. The question encourages us to help outside agencies, but it might have had more merit if it had referred to doing A.A. service work. We seem to constantly need more twelfth-steppers and service workers.

Within our meetings, are we telling newcomers exactly what A.A. is? We read from books that may be good, but are not A.A. We include prayers with religious connotations. We promote club functions, but skip reading the Twelve Traditions. We see people come to A.A. alone, without a sponsor, and remain without one. Because members are arriving from other sources, we dismiss our obligation. If the Twelfth Step is weakened, the other eleven will also be in jeopardy. If the Twelve Steps were gone, the heartbeat of A.A. would slowly stop, because then God would have been written out of our program!

We are growing steadily, and with growth there does have to be change in accommodating our larger numbers. This is why we have to put more emphasis on A.A. service structure. Our administrative needs may change, but not the program.

Henrietta Seiberling, who was a part of Dr. Bob's and Bill's first meeting, said, "The last A.A. dinners I went to, there were two witnesses, and you would have thought they were giving you a description of psychiatrists' work on them. Their progress was always on the level of psychology. There was no spirituality there, or talk of what God had done in their lives. They were giving their views, not news of what God had done."

Bill said to her, "I know, but so many people need this, and they don't want to send them away."

We can all start getting back to basics by revitalizing the spirituality of our God-given program.

Joan A. Barclay (Nevada)

The role of the general service delegate

A sense of responsibility

After coming to A.A., getting sober, working the program, getting active in all areas (Recovery, Unity, and Service) for a period of several years, you show you have some sense of responsibility. Then you get nominated for delegate, then elected, and the golden assignment begins.

If you have been given some words of wisdom by your predecessor, these are a real inspiration. At the same time, you have the

sinking feeling that you will probably goof everything up. You look forward to seeing G.S.O. You carry the group conscience of your fellow members, are aware of what is expected of you, and are full of enthusiasm.

Traveling to New York, you review "The A.A. Service Manual," and in Chapter V, "The Delegate," you reread the 15 primary duties. Again, you ask yourself, "Am I qualified?" At this point, the Serenity Prayer pops into your mind; your "conscious contact" becomes workable, and you remember you are just another drunk given life through this wonderful Fellowship.

Your fellow delegates have the same problems you do. Theirs may be termed differently, but you can give your opinion on how a problem is being handled in your area, and in return you will derive good ideas to carry home with you. You learn how to share with the A.A.'s who entrusted you with this job the many things you will be hearing, even though they hate to hear reports. You learn how to remedy situations that from time to time cause friction. By listening closely, you find how to listen to both sides, without taking sides — disagree without being disagreeable. You learn how to cooperate with G.S.O., how many hats you have to wear, how many roads you must travel, and how to stay humble with it all.

You learn how to be absent from your family a great deal, and pray a lot for their understanding. You also learn how to smile a lot.

You learn there are many ways for you to continue to serve. This is not the ultimate step. In our area, we use the past delegate as a committee chairperson.

You learn that the qualification required of you most in this position is responsibility.

Marvin Spooner (Southern Minnesota)

Kitty cans at meetings remind members of A.A. service beyond the group level

I came into one of the best A.A. groups in our area; but then, as unfortunately is still the case, practically all emphasis was placed on recovery only. My sponsor had no knowledge of structure or service, so I received nothing along these lines. You can't carry a message you don't have. Most members sponsoring today are no more knowledgeable concerning the broader program of A.A.

At the tender age of six months, I was thrown into service work — made treasurer of our central office, simply because I am an accountant. I made many mistakes, but I learned, and loved every minute of it. I attended assembly meetings as an observer and began to notice the lack of knowledge caused by poor communication.

As secretary-treasurer of the assembly, I began to do a few small things toward improving communications: a financial statement listing all groups' contributions, showing where the money was spent; an occasional letter regarding something of interest to most; the chairman's agenda for the next meeting — anything to keep service in their minds. When I became chairman, we continued, with each officer getting out three or four communications a year. We instituted workshops with all assembly meetings, using "The A.A. Service Manual" as the text, and we all visited different districts whenever possible.

Since becoming delegate, I have visited groups, intergroups, anniversary parties, conventions—anywhere they would have me. I have tried to work my report in with my story — any way at all to get the message across.

We have separated assemblies from conventions and made them weekend affairs, with workshops on Saturday and business meetings on Sunday. We encourage groups to help pay the expenses of their G.S.R.'s, explaining that the ability to pay should not be a requisite for a G.S.R., only a desire to serve. We use past delegates a lot to help teach us.

We have placed kitty cans in groups wherever possible, each showing a structure chart of A.A. This has helped us financially and also serves as a reminder to members that there is a responsibility beyond the group level. We encourage study meetings on the Traditions and structure, as well as on the Steps.

Our assembly got much more financial support in 1975, and contributions to G.S.O. increased almost 30% over 1974. We attribute this to more education through communication. We now have a monthly newsletter underwritten by our assembly, hoping to reach groups that do not now participate, and to help those that do. We are not what we want to be, but we are moving.

As delegate, I feel A.A. as a whole comes first. This must be ever-present in my mind, particularly at this Conference. I must listen to the views of other areas and share mine, which may not always be in agreement with my area's thinking. I must act, not just as a messenger instructed how to vote, but rather as a trusted servant, with the right and responsibility of deciding with the guidance of my own conscience.

Dede Hoffmann (Louisiana)

Facts or Opinions Sought Through Ask-It Basket

Unsigned questions placed in the padlocked Ask-It Basket in the main meeting room sought information, opinions of Conference members, and general consensus on highly varied topics. As many questions as possible, within the time allotted, were answered on the Conference floor. Answers to the remaining queries are the result of a sharing session held by the G.S.O. staff.

A.A. directories

Q. Could we subdivide the U.S. and Canadian directories by area?

A. This question will be included in the directory presentation at the 1977 Conference.

Q. In updating our group information cards and directories, has any thought been given to eliminating the alternate name? Most cities, towns, etc. today have more than one group. It appears that time and money could be saved without sacrificing service.

A. Experience has shown that a second contact is very helpful, and only the name and telephone number are given.

Finances

Q. Has any thought been given to a personal cardboard bank labeled "A Penny a Day for Sobriety"? They could be available with our literature—approximate size of an envelope. If we all had one at home and put even just the pennies from our change in, then exchanged them for a money order to A.A. World Services, we would not have to worry about A.A. being self-supporting. Without the convenience of the one I have at home, I would not do it.

A. None to date. This will be referred to A.A.W.S. for consideration.

Q. If an intergroup office accepts a \$5.00 donation from an A.A. member and designates \$3.50 as a donation to the General Fund and \$2.50 to the literature fund, does this violate our guidelines?

A. The Conference members were considerably amused at the above addition. Each A.A. member contributes to A.A. as he or she sees fit.

General Service Conference

Q. Why do you use this hotel for the Conference? How about a Conference Site Committee?

A. Over the years, the Conference has been held at three other hotels. The choice has been mostly a matter of economics and convenience. The World Service Meeting will be held at the Statler Hilton in October. A sense of the meeting indicated general satisfaction with the Hotel Roosevelt.

Q. Are our sessions being taped?

A. All sessions are taped except the delegates' meeting.

Q. May we have a sense of the meeting on whether printed presentations should be distributed before or after the oral presentations?

A. It was the consensus that the printed presentations should be distributed beforehand.

Q. At the Conference in 1975, sketches were made by an artist. These appeared in the *Conference Report*. Why none this year?

A. This was a "special" for the report on the 25th Conference. This year, a sketch appeared on the first page of the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*.

Q. Can G.S.O. distribute agenda items in November (Traditions month), to allow for increased time for group discussion?

A. The agenda topics are approved at the trustees' Conference

Committee meeting the last week of October. We will try to include them with the delegates' monthly letter in November.

Q. Should delegates withhold information from their areas for any reason?

A. Most agreed that such action would not be within the spirit of A.A.

Q. How old was the youngest delegate—in chronological age—the General Service Conference ever had? In sobriety?

A. There is no record of this at G.S.O.

Q. Cannot members' spouses who are A.A. and those who are not be given different-colored name tags?

A. For the sake of unity among the spouses, we have not done this.

Advisory Actions related to the Conference: pp. 41, 43

General Service Office

Q. Is it true New York is exploring the possibility of moving G.S.O. to another part of the country? If so, where?

A. The trustee from the East Central Region informed the Conference in detail what had been done to date.

Advisory Action related to the above question: 8, p. 41

Q. It seems to me that it would be more feasible that we own the physical structure of G.S.O., rather than rent. We might need the equity that can come from ownership.

A. This could be considered under a sale-leaseback arrangement that would be in keeping with the A.A. tradition of non-ownership; the question would be a part of the study previously referred to.

Q. Is it possible to speed up orders for literature from G.S.O.? Deliveries are taking up to six weeks.

A. G.S.O. is making many changes in organization and procedures in the Shipping Department to improve services. Shipments are now going out within a few days after they are processed by the Accounting Department.

Q. Can a structure chart be reinstated in the Group Handbook?

A. Yes.

Q. Can all pieces of literature be included in the package of literature sent to areas for conventions?

A. Samples of most pamphlets, booklets, and book jackets are included in convention literature packages.

Q. Is it, or could it be, possible to get new covers for our "Twelve and Twelve," Big Book, and "As Bill Sees It"?

A. G.S.O. has extra jackets for all books.

Q. Could we have a sense of the Conference on the advisability of making prints in 8 mm. of the two G.S.O. films ["Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions"]?

A. This will be considered.

Q. Should our members be aware of A.A. monies paid to special workers?

A. We are not sure what is meant by "special workers." Ex-

penses are categorized in the G.S.O. income statement (p. 46). For specific information, write G.S.O.

Q. Who is paying the staff (if there is a specially assigned staff) for distribution of "Bill W."? Who authorized distribution of "Bill W."?

A. There is no special employee at G.S.O. in charge of the distribution of "Bill W." It is handled by the Accounting and Shipping Departments along with other literature orders. Distribution of "Bill W." was authorized by the General Service Board (see 1972 *Conference Report*, p. 25).

Grapevine

Q. Why is 50% of the "About Alcoholism" portion of the Grapevine from the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario?

A. Because *The Journal*, published by this foundation, has much information on alcoholism.

Group affairs

Q. What can be done about the use of four-letter words by our group?

A. Our program clearly states that if you live the program in every area of your life, every area of your life will improve.

Q. Is A.A. getting too organized?

A. There was general laughter at this point, and the next question was taken up.

Q. Why do we say the Lord's Prayer after meetings?

A. It is not the universal format, but many A.A. groups close their meetings with the Lord's Prayer. This custom "just grew," having been handed down from the Oxford Group to the early A.A. members. In some other countries (e.g., England), it is *not* general practice.

Q. What does your assembly do with A.A. groups that are unwilling to join the area assembly?

A. A member of the area committee goes to the group and sees what the problem is. Share with them, and have patience and hope. Have service meetings at the district level, and invite the G.S.R. of the group. Wait, and keep them informed of the assembly meetings.

Q. Has anyone had trouble with interpreters coming to closed meetings to interpret for the deaf and later breaking anonymity of members of A.A.?

A. At G.S.O., we are not aware of anyone's anonymity having been broken through attending meetings of deaf groups.

Q. How do you feel about the film "Chalk Talk" being shown at an A.A. meeting?

A. Each group is autonomous, and it would be up to the group to decide.

Q. What about gay A.A. groups—are they here to stay? If someone wants to start one in my area, do I give them the okay? What if they get very active in Twelfth Step work and sponsorship? One person has questioned me on starting a heterosexual group—later said he wasn't seriously concerned.

A. Gay groups are listed in the A.A. directories published by G.S.O., as well as in those published by many central offices.

Q. What can be done about the person who has been around for years, not sober over three months at a time, knows the Big Book by heart, denies he has slipped, continues to take over meetings, and tries to run groups?
A. This should be discussed by the group's steering committee, bearing in mind the First Tradition.

Q. What can individual members do about keeping meetings to basics?

A. See "Back to Basics," p. 22.

Q. If a group of alcoholics meets regularly in an open meeting attended regularly by nonalcoholics (not Al-Anons) and members of N.A. [Neurotics Anonymous or Narcotics Anonymous—question did not specify], is it considered an A.A. group?

A. Anyone is welcome to *attend* an A.A. *open meeting*. Only alcoholics are *members* of an A.A. *group*.

Q. Does your area have a problem with religious groups who are also alcoholics taking over meetings and disrupting them? How do you handle this?

A. This creates an unpleasant situation, but can be handled with tact.

Q. Since the truckers have a C.B. Channel 19, how about A.A.'s using C.B. Channel 12? Carry suggestion in Grapevine.

A. Citizen Band radio is licensed by the government (Federal Communications Commission). If A.A. C.B. users were to organize as a group, the General Service Office and the Grapevine would be happy to recognize them. (In the October 1974 Grapevine, the "Around A.A." section included an item about such a group in Canada.)

Q. If an A.A. member takes marijuana, does this constitute a slip in terms of sobriety?

A. Some said that there was no relationship between alcohol and marijuana, but that marijuana was dangerous for an alcoholic, because it could lead to a slip.

Q. Could we have an expression of the Conference's attitude toward standing ovations for A.A. speakers?

Trustee Bruce Wight arose to answer. He said, "I'm against them. I never got one," and sat down.

Instantly, all 132 other Conference members jumped to their feet, applauding and cheering, to give Bruce one of the least earned, most enjoyed, most good-natured, and most raucous standing ovations in A.A. history.

International Conventions

Q. Why does A.A. need an International Convention every five years unless there is something in the way of a specific issue to be brought before the membership? This money could be spent on regional mini-conferences or some other important project.

A. The Convention is just a get-together of A.A. members from all over the world. No actions are taken. It does not cost the

Fellowship any money; for those who wish to attend, there is a registration fee that covers the expenses.

Q. At the International Convention in Denver, there were several rows of seats roped off for the night show (entertainment). I feel that this exceeded the amount necessary. Can this number be lessened?

A. This will be referred to the International Convention Committee. Most of the staff and those directly involved with the Convention are under a very tight schedule and cannot be present until the last moment.

Literature

Q. In the pamphlet "The A.A. Group," should the In Memoriam method of contributing to G.S.O. be included?

A. This is now included in the "money" pamphlet and in "The A.A. Service Manual" (p. 109), but the suggestion will be considered by the Literature Committee.

Q. Inasmuch as Hazelden's "Twenty-Four Hours a Day" is ever so widely used as a daily tool, could not the Conference somehow give the nod of approval to this book as a "kissin' cousin"? For example, using its entries on the slogans (September 5, 6, 7, 8) makes such a good, meaty, closed-meeting springboard. But oh, the screaming: "It's not Conference-approved!"

A. It was the consensus that A.A.'s should stick to Conference-approved literature, as it represents the broadest possible sharing and not just the opinion of one individual, area, or region.

Q. Due to the ever-increasing use of "the 24-hour book" as a source of topics for meetings in lieu of A.A.-approved literature, my group requests a look into the feasibility of an A.A. publication of similar nature.

A. "As Bill Sees It" serves this purpose. Its pages were not dated, so as not to seem to compete with Hazelden's publication.

Q. On p. 24 of the Hazelden literature catalog, the symbol for A.A.-approved literature appears with the notation that this identifies A.A.-approved literature. Is this use of our symbol approved by the board?

A. This was approved by the directors of A.A.W.S., as it serves to identify A.A. Conference-approved literature purchased from us and sold by Hazelden.

Q. Please explain the procedures and requirements when permission is granted for other fellowships (such as Overeaters Anonymous and Narcotics Anonymous) to use our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

A. All requests for permission to reprint are considered by the A.A.W.S. board of directors on an individual basis.

Q. Can "primary purpose" be replaced with "primary spiritual aim" in the Group Handbook and other literature?

A. This is part of the original wording of Tradition Five, and to change it would require written approval by at least 75% of A.A. groups worldwide.

Q. The binding on the Big Book appears to be of inferior quality in some cases. Because of personal notations made in the books, it is undesirable to return them to G.S.O. for replacement. Can we have a better binding without too much additional charge?

A. On the third edition of the Big Book, we are using Smythe-Sewn binding.

Q. Could we have the short-form Twelve Concepts put in all our literature?

A. This will be referred to the Literature Committee for consideration. The Twelve Concepts, short form, are included in "The A.A. Service Manual," p. 113.

Q. Request a feasibility study be made re an A.A. Big Book concordance along the format and lines of any Bible concordance. Example: In the back of Hazelden's "little red book" is a listing by page and line of instances when the word "must" appears in our A.A. Big Book. Cannot this concept be applied for the entire book? This would be an easy reference and companion book for newcomers and all the rest of us.

A. A Big Book concordance is being prepared and is being checked for accuracy. It will be available at a later date.

Q. Some women in our area have asked if something could be written for the woman alcoholic who is not a housewife, but rather one in the business world. The women who have asked this do not feel they can identify with what's been written so far.

A. In the present edition of the Big Book, there are six stories geared specifically to professional women. The pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" also has several stories.

Q. There has been much controversy over the alleged misuse of the word "suggested" in reference to the Twelve Steps. Please give *all* examples of literature changes in wording since the 1975 Conference—changes allegedly made only to insure uniformity in reference to the Twelve Steps, "which are suggested as a program of recovery."

A. In the listing of the Twelve Steps, the word "suggested" was removed from 14 pamphlets. In three pamphlets, it has not been removed. For further information, contact Conference secretary.

Public information

Q. In my area, A.A. has been invited to set up a booth at a health fair. Would this be considered promotion or P.I. work? There is also a possibility of TV coverage.

A. In many areas, the public information committees are responsible for carrying the A.A. message to the public at health fairs, and G.S.O. has a table-top display available (price: \$1.00) for this purpose, titled "A.A.—a Community Resource." When there is TV coverage, it is suggested that A.A. members be careful to avoid the camera.

Q. Does the Conference feel it is okay to use local A.A. members at advertised public meetings?

A. In some areas, they bring in outside speakers instead of using local A.A. members. In others, local A.A. members speak at public meetings, but always within the A.A. Traditions.

Q. In the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," the wording has been changed in the 1975 pamphlet from "use only first name" (1972) to "use full name if you wish." Please explain.

A. Several of Bill's writings indicate he favored members' speaking at public meetings provided anonymity is maintained by the

press and other media. This question will be reviewed by the trustees' P.I. Committee.

Traditions

Q. At this Conference, all delegates are identified by full name, panel, and area. At a regional meeting of past and present delegates only, wouldn't similar identification be not only within the Tradition of anonymity, but more truly within its spirit?

A. Yes. There is no break of the anonymity Tradition when full names are used within the Fellowship.

Q. Can a retreat be classified as an A.A. retreat or should the reference be "a retreat for alcoholics"?

A. It should be referred to as "a retreat for alcoholics." There is no such thing as an A.A. retreat.

Q. Through the tradition of cooperation but not affiliation, can meetings held in recovery homes, halfway houses, and other agencies grow into groups if such a group becomes self-supporting through its own contributions? And as a group, can it become part of the service structure, with a G.S.R., etc.?

A. A self-supporting A.A. group that meets in a halfway house or other facility is the same as any other A.A. group. It is suggested, however, that the group not have the same name as the facility.

Who makes up the Conference?

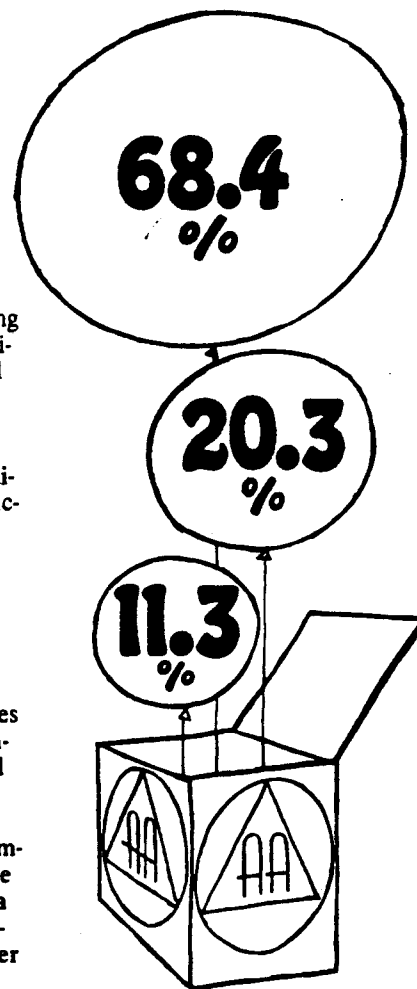
91 delegates — 68.4%.

Function: represent A.A. groups in fulfilling their ultimate responsibility for A.A.'s world services.

27 trustees, A.A.W.S. directors, Grapevine directors — 20.3%. Function: responsible for policy and implementation.

15 General Service Office and Grapevine staff — 11.3%. Function: carry out policies of, and report to, General Service Board and Conference.

Every Conference member has not only a vote but a voice; not only a right but a responsibility to express his or her views.



Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees

General Service Board

Trustee chairman reports membership at one million

Trustees' report: Bill W. used to dream of the day when a hundred thousand drunks might flock to A.A. in a single year. Well, that day has come. The Fellowship is growing by more than 100,000 new members per year. This year, for the first time, we conservatively estimate membership at over a million. A.A.'s growth has accelerated greatly since Bill's death in 1971. In 1970, U.S. and Canadian groups registered at G.S.O. numbered 12,900. At the end of 1975, the U.S.-Canada figure was 20,700 (almost 28,000 worldwide). In 1970, we distributed 54,700 copies of the Big Book; in 1975, 176,300 copies!

In 1975, literature sales, Grapevine circulation, contributions, and numbers of A.A. groups all reached record high levels. Your board believes this growth has been healthy and the Fellowship is sound and vital. I base this on my experience at the two experimental mini-conferences, in Denver, and in other countries around the world in 1974 and 1975, also on reports to the board by regional trustees and by members of the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs attending A.A. get-togethers from Newfoundland to San Diego, Edmonton to El Paso.

In spite of growth — and some problems growth has brought, to be discussed at this Conference — we have not lost sight of our primary purpose.

I wish everyone could observe the quarterly meetings of the board. On these board weekends, the 21 members (14 alcoholic, seven nonalcoholic), plus committee members and staff, begin work right after lunch on Saturday. Meetings continue through Saturday evening, Sunday, and Sunday evening. The full board meets on Monday morning.

Let me review some activities of the board during the past 12 months. A year ago, we enlarged the A.A. World Services board to nine members by adding two regional trustees. This has worked out extremely well, bringing closer grass-roots thinking to A.A.W.S. and providing even better liaison with the G.S. Board. Since a majority of the A.A.W.S. board now consists of trustees (two general service, two regional, and one Class A), it holds four of its monthly meetings during board weekends.

Working through the Southeastern and West Central regional trustees, the board put on two regional mini-conferences [see p. 38]. From the trustees' viewpoint, they gave us wide-open communication with local people and invaluable firsthand feeling for A.A. concerns in different parts of the U.S. I was impressed by the gratitude expressed by G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s for the opportunity to meet the trustees and G.S.O. staff and talk freely with them.

All trustees took active parts in the 40th Anniversary International Convention. At the board meeting in Denver, they passed two resolutions of thanks: to the Denver Host Committee and to the G.S.O. staff.

Michael Alexander, partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander and Saskor, P.C., has been nominated to replace Dr. Vincent P. Dole, retiring from the board this year. Mike followed

Bern Smith of the same firm as A.A.'s attorney, and brings this in-depth experience to the board.

The board, like the Conference, acts primarily through its committees. Trustees try to be aware of all developments that might affect our Fellowship, and to devote themselves to long-range planning, so that A.A. will be here for generations of alcoholics as yet unborn.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairman

A.A.W.S.

1975 report shows 50% spurt in literature sales

Directors' report: Sales of \$1,928,600 of A.A. literature in 1975 compared favorably with the \$1,250,000 of 1974 — an increase of more than 50%. To help defray costs of services that contributions could not meet, A.A.W.S. donated \$300,000 to the General Fund.

In 1975, the distribution of books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items reached 5,639,000 units. Free literature for groups and to inform the general public about A.A. amounted to 329,600 individual pieces (inventory value, \$13,125.00).

After reviewing bulk orders processed, probable effects on orders through intergroups, and possible difficulties in handling similar orders versus bulk orders, a committee on discount structure recommended that the present basis of discount be continued. It was recommended that discount *packages* be studied in relation to the quantity discount structure.

A committee has been appointed to look into the possibility that G.S.O. might profitably move out of New York City to some other part of the country after our lease expires in five years. Although this would appear to be a remote possibility, this subject should be given careful consideration.

The *Accounting Department* is made up of a supervisor, two bookkeepers, and eight clerks.

An average of 1,000 letters a week are marked and processed by three people in the *Files Department*. This year, new equipment was installed, saving floor space, but affording more room in which to file correspondence.

In the *Records Department*, two supervisors with six clerks compile all information that appears in our directories and maintain G.S.O.'s mailing lists.

The *Shipping Department* has two supervisors and 17 other full-time employees. This year, a mail unit was instituted to process all incoming and outgoing mail, mimeographing, and maintenance of the Scriptomatic file. Orders, free literature, service material, reports, and quarterly inventories are handled in Shipping.

Fifteen women make up the *Stenographic and Clerical Department*. All staff correspondence and bulletins are typed here. A receptionist, a switchboard operator, and a purchasing clerk are also included.

A.A. World Services, Inc., is a membership corporation, controlled by the trustees, who are members. Its directors are elected by the members (trustees) at their annual meeting. A.A.W.S. is, in effect, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. At monthly directors' meetings, reports are given on various General Service Office activities, and prices are established on new literature and other material. The directors approve or disapprove requests by outsiders and A.A. members for permission to reprint copyrighted literature. Also, matters pertaining to publishing and G.S.O. administration are considered. Others attending these meetings are G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, the general manager, the controller, and the departmental coordinator.

There are now nine A.A.W.S. directors, including two regional trustees and one nonalcoholic trustee. Four monthly meetings of A.A.W.S. coincide with the regular meetings of the General Service Board.

Walter Murphy, chairman

Literature distributed—1975

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	176,274
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	90,063
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	25,585
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	18,303
As Bill Sees It	26,668
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish edition	2,760
Total	339,653

Booklets

Living Sober (new)	56,680
Came to Believe	21,594
Total	78,274

Pamphlets

This Is A.A.	311,900
A.A. — 44 Questions and Answers	269,000
Is A.A. for You?	664,400
Young People and A.A.	193,600
A.A. for the Woman	151,700
Three Talks to Medical Societies — by Bill W.	74,800
The Alcoholic Husband	206,300
The Alcoholic Wife	185,400
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	38,700
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	197,900
The Jack Alexander Article	95,900
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	116,700
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	132,100
What Happened to Joe	94,400
It Happened to Alice	95,100
The A.A. Group	70,700
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	47,500
Inside A.A.	62,900
The G.S.R.	49,800
A.A. and the Armed Services	201,700
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	185,200

The A.A. Service Manual	9,800
Twelve Traditions Illustrated	58,300
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	22,700
The Co-Founders of A.A.	50,900
Understanding Anonymity	94,700
A.A. and the Medical Profession	49,300
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	65,500
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	53,900
A.A. in Prisons	32,000
A.A. in Hospitals	36,100
If You Are a Professional	68,300
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem	60,100
The Fellowship of A.A. (discontinued)	127,000
A.A. in Your Community	125,300
Profile of an A.A. Meeting (discontinued)	71,000
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,400
How It Works	165,300
The Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders (new)	10,600
A.A. — a Community Resource (new)	25,000
How A.A. Members Cooperate (new)	56,500
Twelve Concepts for World Service	2,700
A Member's-Eye View of Alcoholics Anonymous	102,200
Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous (discontinued)	34,000
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	28,700
Problems Other Than Alcohol	89,800
Foreign Translations	119,200
Total	5,018,000

Miscellaneous

Tapes of A.A. talks	309
Wallet Cards — two-fold	600,900
Wallet Cards — I Am Responsible	84,100
Wallet Cards — Anonymity	42,900
Parchment — scrolls	4,694
Plaques	1,990
Beginners Meeting Kit	1,670
Group Handbook	3,512
Wire Racks	958
Cassettes	125
A.A. Public Information Manual	2,750

Archives

Opening ceremony held; classification recommended

G.S.O. report: For the variety of A.A. material — tapes, cassettes, letters, magazines, clippings, pictures, etc. — that has arrived in such abundance over the last 12 months from so many members and groups, we are indeed very grateful. These additions to our archives were made:

- **Oral history:** about 45 tapes (25 recorded in Denver) from early members throughout the county.

- **State histories:** Several are in progress, and many have already been received.

- **Memorabilia:** For example, we received good copies of the first printing (1939) of the Big Book and a prepublication multilith copy. Dr. Bob's son contributed pictures of his parents and memorial letters written by A.A. members and families on the occasion of his mother's death. Lois Wilson contributed generously from her own files, especially a set of diaries from 1937 through 1948.

- **Microfilming:** The files of the old Alcoholic Foundation and "headquarters" office (forerunners of the General Service Board and Office, 1937-53) have just gone to the microfilmer,

completing the three basic categories to be so filmed (Bill's and Dr. Bob's material, the earliest groups here and abroad, and headquarters office records). Still to be microfilmed is a separate history section (including written accounts, transcripts of old recordings made years ago, Rockefeller letters, beginnings of the Internationalists, etc.).

- **Compatible taping:** Selected cassettes of the Denver Convention were taped. In process: early-timers' stories recorded by Bill in 1953-54 at the first A.A. centers. Still to be done are Conference and Convention tapes and Bill W.'s tapes.

- **Permanent storage:** We are presently preparing to box and transfer priceless material to Leahy Business Archives, in New Jersey.

Nell Wing, archivist

Trustees' committee: The formal opening of the archives suite was held November 3, 1975. Dr. Norris, Lois Wilson, and Tom Sharpe, past trustee and chairman of the archives committee at large, participated.

The committee agreed that:

- The Archives Committee is the custodian under whose jurisdiction the use of this material falls. Trustees, directors, and staff members may have access to archival material without specific committee permission. Any A.A. member may view the originals of any material that has been previously printed or published. Group histories are available to members of the group. A.A. members may read the subject files that are on microfilms if the request is "reasonable and modest."
- Any A.A. entity may have copies of photos if it makes the copies. Copies of archives pictures will not be available to A.A.'s; we have no duplicates.

- Two classifications of sensitive material were set up:

1 **Personal – classified** consists of highly personal documents, tapes, and material. They may be released if requests are brought to the committee.

2 **Personal – confidential** consists of letters between Bill and Lois and other confidential correspondence on Bill's interests outside A.A. This category should not be released at present under any circumstances, and a time limit of up to 25 years was suggested.

George Gordon, chairman

Conference

Members work all year on one-week Conference

Staff report: The General Service Conference has the responsibility of leadership once carried by the founders of A.A. It is also a policy-making body, expressing the group conscience of the Fellowship.

The Conference secretary corresponds with 133 Conference members, past delegates, and all those on the general service

committees in the U.S. and Canada. As of December 1975, G.S.O. also had the following 2,500-plus on the mailing list: 590 past delegates, 1,702 D.C.M.'s, 88 area committee chairmen, 79 secretaries, 75 treasurers, plus alternates and many others. Area secretaries share with us through minutes of assemblies and committee meetings.

Any A.A. member may send in suggestions for the Conference agenda, usually through the delegate. Suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference and Conference Agenda Committees. Afterwards, they are shared in the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda (mailed in January).

The Conference secretary assumes responsibility for: collection of items for the Conference theme and agenda; writing monthly letters to delegates all year; working with others at G.S.O. in planning the Conference; scheduling and routing of all reports (material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird edition of Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*); preparation of Conference Advisory Actions and summaries of Ask-It Basket questions; reviewing all communications from area committees and D.C.M.'s.

She is also secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the Conference.

Mary Ellen Welsh

Trustees' committee: We reviewed suggested Conference themes and recommended three from which the Agenda Committee chose this year's theme. We discussed proposed agenda subjects and approved presentation, workshop, and discussion topics.

After reviewing suggestions from delegates and 1975 Conference evaluation questionnaires, the committee made the following recommendations: (a) that a Conference roll call be taken at the opening session; (b) that the 1976 Conference have a flow chart showing how the Conference committee system works; (c) that the word "Area" be added to "Service Highlights"; (d) that trustees and staff rotate at workshops so delegates have a chance to meet all of them; (e) that Conference committee reports be given to delegates and trustees Thursday evening; (f) that workshop questions be distributed in early February.

We also finalized questions for three structured workshops – "Sponsorship," "A.A. in Hospitals," and "Public Information" – and recommended that there be orientation for workshop moderators before the Conference.

In response to 1975 Conference members' request, we recommend that trustees, directors, and staff take part more fully in floor discussions and rotate their seating arrangements during Conference business sessions.

Margaret Carlson, chairman

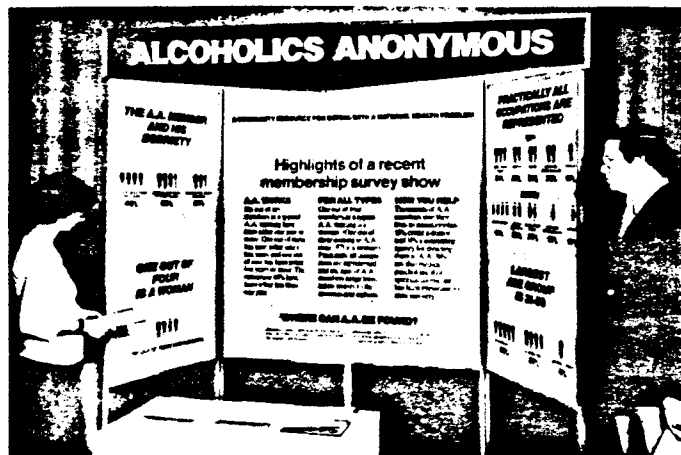
Average length of sobriety among area delegates to the 1976 Conference was 12.2 years. Average age was 51.8 years, ranging from 36 to 70.

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Professional gatherings kept aware of A.A.

Staff report: Over the past year, the C.P.C. Committee and the staff have tried to further A.A.'s primary purpose through sharing information about A.A. with professionals who have contact with alcoholics.

We participated in 11 professional events: annual conference of the National Council on Alcoholism; Summer School of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers; training for field directors of the Regional Alcoholism Information Program; dinner in honor of Dr. Selden Bacon; 26th annual meeting of Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America; two meetings of the National Advisory Council on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism; National Conference of Social Workers; Alcohol, Drug Abuse, Mental Health Administration Regional Conference; Women and Alcohol Conference; first National Women's Forum on our nation's drinking problem.



Our Professional Exhibit was shown at these 15 national professional meetings: N.C.A. Annual Conference; National Conference on Social Welfare; National League for Nursing; American Medical Association; National Education Association; American Correctional Association; Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America; National Rehabilitation Association; American Public Health Association; Association of Trial Lawyers of America; American Association of School Administrators; American Orthopsychiatric Association; National Drug Abuse Conference; American Personnel and Guidance Association; National Catholic Educational Association.

As a result, we received 1,377 requests for literature from the first 11 (other returns not in yet).

The bimonthly *P.I. Bulletin* is now the quarterly *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, directed to local P.I. and C.P.C. committees.

We have established permanent liaison among the trustees' C.P.C., P.I., and Institutions Committees.

Revisions in "Helpful Hints to Volunteers on Manning A.A.

Exhibit" and "Suggestions and Information for the Chairman" (Professional Exhibit) further point up the strictly confidential nature of our directories. In addition, a separate sheet will be attached to each directory reminding workers *not* to display directories.

The armed services groups list has been updated. The great majority of current chairmen agreed to have their names given when requests are received at G.S.O. from armed services personnel for A.A. contacts on bases.

Guidelines describing the formation and function of a C.P.C. committee will be presented to the joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees.

After the fourth edition of our newsletter *About A.A.*, we received many requests for additional copies, and the mailing list is now approaching 3,500.

Phyllis Masback

Trustees' committee: Our Convention in Denver hosted over 20 professional people working with alcoholics. Examples of how to carry the message to the professional, and through the professional, were presented in many panels.

The chairman attended workshops for A.A. members employed in the alcoholism field in Massachusetts, New Hampshire, and Rhode Island. They provide fine forums for these A.A. members. At the Virginia State Convention, the delegate and convention chairman put on a workshop in which a local judge, an agency director, a counselor who was an A.A. member, and a state senator participated. At the first regional mini-conference in Atlanta, there was considerable discussion about cooperation with the professional community. It was generally agreed that even though this relationship can be fraught with difficulties, it does present us with a viable way of carrying the A.A. message.

A.A. participation in the N.C.A. annual meeting this May will be integrated into specific programs of the forum — i.e., women, minorities, industrial programs, institutions, community services (cooperation of A.A. intergroups and N.C.A. affiliates). It is hoped more professionals who may be unaware of what A.A. has to offer will be reached this way. There will also be a workshop for A.A. members employed in the field of alcoholism.

Robert Macpherson, chairman

Finance

Wider participation needed

Trustees' committee: G.S.O. financial operations in 1975 presented a somewhat unusual picture for these times. While other business operations generally continued to flounder, or slowly recover, our financial position continued to improve. Contributions from groups and A.A. members totaled \$807,300 for the year, \$19,700 more than forecast, \$57,500 more than received in 1974. However, the percentage of U.S. and Canadian groups contributing fell from 56.9% to 55.6%. In order to reverse this trend, it would seem prudent to emphasize participation more than ever and to strengthen communications.

Net literature sales increased by \$678,900 over 1974. Of this increase, \$346,000 (or more than 50%) was received in the first four months of this year, while the old prices were still in effect. This was obviously due not only to A.A. growth, but also to "filling of the pipelines" before the prices of literature went up, on May 1. The balance of the increase in sales income (\$332,900) was accumulated over the last eight months of the year and was attributed to additional sales income resulting from the price increase, a favorable response to the new booklet "Living Sober," and additional sales volume.

Total G.S.O. income—i.e., publishing gross profit, contributions, interest income, and \$83,000 in net proceeds from Convention operations—was over 1974 by \$543,800 and \$376,200 more than budgeted. Total G.S.O. expenses were in excess of 1974 by \$293,900 and 4% over the budget. Some of this increase was caused by spiraling costs related to general economic conditions, but most of it was brought about by the continual growth of the Fellowship. To sum up: The net expense of the General Fund of G.S.O., \$203,200, was offset by A.A.W.S. publishing net income, \$578,800. This resulted in a net 1975 income of \$375,500, compared to \$125,600 for 1974.

The 1976 G.S.O. budget has been reviewed and approved by the trustees' Finance Committee. It is a prudent one and allows for increases in both income and expense. Total income (contributions, gross profit from publishing, and interest earned) is budgeted 10.5% higher than 1975 actual income. Total expenses are budgeted 10.4% higher than 1975, allowing for: increase in postal rates; increased publishing activity; implementation of electronic data-processing equipment and systems; a filmstrip on the service structure; four scheduled mini-conferences [now called regional forums]; and other increases caused by further A.A. growth and higher business costs. Net income from all G.S.O. operations is expected to total \$417,500.

Sound financing is vitally important to the Fellowship of A.A., since we are completely committed to the principle of self-support. So it becomes imperative that all A.A. groups and members continue to carry their full share of the cost of worldwide services.

Arthur Miles, chairman

Group services coordinator

G.S.O.'s key service to groups is communicating

Staff report: Primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communicative services to the whole Fellowship. She supervises all service materials, Guidelines, listings, films, literature displays, Group Handbooks, and other A.A. material.

With the Communications Committee, she discusses how to communicate in the best possible way. She works in a team with staff members on literature and on Loners/Internationalists.

The group services coordinator conducts a monthly meeting on the service assignment of each staff member. Suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered.

Three Group Handbooks now available are for new "regular" groups, prison groups, and hospital groups. Each new group in the U.S. or Canada receives a new Group Handbook (older groups may purchase one) and complimentary literature. Groups receive Box 4-5-9 and the appropriate A.A. directory. (Groups in foreign countries are serviced by their own G.S.O.'s.)

Four A.A. directories are published annually: Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, and International. They are listed on the order form and may be purchased by A.A.'s for 75¢ each. Institutions directories, prepared in 1975, will be issued again in 1977.

As the need arises, our 13 Guidelines are updated. They cover: Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers; Armed Services; Central or Intergroup Offices; Clubs; Conferences and Conventions; Co-operating with Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs; Institutional Committees; Public Information; Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon; On Industry Programs; A.A. Cooperation With Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities; For Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field; Current Usage of A.A. Directories. [New Guidelines: See C.P.C. report, p. 31.]

Two 16 mm color films available are "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions." These are rented to regular A.A. and Al-Anon groups (1974 Conference action) at \$35 per week, and distributed free to institutions groups.

A new G.S.O. filmstrip is now available.

We have a list of A.A. members who like to exchange tapes or wish to correspond. We also have listings of Loners, Internationalists, armed services groups, etc.

Literature kits for special purposes are sent either free or in response to orders. The coordinator keeps them up-to-date.

Our Conference-approved literature is copyrighted. Permission for it to be used or quoted must be granted by A.A. World Services, Inc.

Waneta New



In "P.O. Box 459," new G.S.O. filmstrip (shown at the Conference), a fictional brother and sister write seeking help for their mother.

Assistant group services

Books, booklets, pamphlets, bulletins share experience

Staff report: The overall responsibility is to help keep communication channels open to many segments of the Fellow-

ship. This involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of many publications, always in coordination with other staff members.

Among regular assignments are the following:

1 *G.S.O. bulletins* — We sent out over 260,000 bulletins and reports in 1975. Eight bulletins have new title designs. They are:

	Mailing list	Issues per yr.
Box 4-5-9 (English)	38,571	6
Box 4-5-9 (French)	1,225	6
Box 4-5-9 (Spanish)	5,287	6
Loners-Internationalists Meeting	1,836	6
P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin	1,501	4
Institutions Bulletin	3,315	3
Quarterly Report	3,327	3*
About A.A.	3,475	1

*The *Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

2 *Pamphlets and leaflets* — updating old pamphlets, preparing new ones.

3 *Books, booklets* — new projects, updating for new printings, revisions.

4 *Special projects* — (a) a new filmstrip about G.S.O.; (b) 11 display boards on services, for regional meetings; (c) posters, such as "Inside A.A.," for conferences and conventions.

The assistant on group services is also secretary of the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and the World Service Meeting Literature/Publishing Committee; serves on the Communications Committee and at *Box 4-5-9* editorial meetings.

Susan Daly

Institutions

300 new hospital groups, 100 new prison groups

Staff report: This desk provides services to institutions groups and committees, and acts as liaison among them. As of January 1, we had 1,351 hospital and rehabilitation-center groups and 1,133 prison groups. Hospital groups have increased by approximately 300 since January 1, 1975, while prison groups have increased by about 100. Growth in national and local alcoholism agencies and treatment centers is primarily responsible for this increase, we believe. Over 130 institutions committees serve hospitals and prisons.

To help carry the message to those who are confined, G.S.O. offers correspondence with the institutions staff member and through the Institutions Correspondence Service (now including about 100 "outside" A.A.'s). We list new groups, and send each the Group Handbook and complimentary literature. We provide prison and hospital groups with updated directories (the latest, in August 1975). Each institutions group receives copies of *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly.

A discount package of A.A. literature is available to "inside"

groups and institutions committees, and tapes and films can be loaned without charge to institutions groups. We send new institutions committees kits containing Guidelines and pamphlets.

Sarah Pierce

Trustees' committee: To get a clearer picture of how A.A. functions in institutions, the chairman asked wardens and superintendents of correctional institutions in the New England and North Atlantic states about A.A. programs, those attending, outside sponsorship, and other points. Results, being tabulated and analyzed, will be reported later.

Two suggestions were made for timing approach to administrators to introduce A.A. or to aid existing A.A. groups: (1) Make sure the institutions committee can meet the responsibilities of getting groups started and providing *continuing* support; (2) find a way to educate correctional officers at all levels about A.A.'s purposes. A letter to institutions committees asking them for their experiences in regard to these two suggestions brought very little response.

There was discussion about revising the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic," or printing a supplement. The consensus was to postpone revisions for the present. But it was decided that a new prison pamphlet, comprising inmates' stories, should be written. The committee decided that the next printing of "A.A. in Prisons" should include updated and signed testimony from prison authorities. Testimony loses value when the authors and their institutions are not identified.

The chairman suggested that A.A. membership figures in the 1975 correctional directory are incomplete, because some institutions fail to report. He and the G.S.O. staff member on the directory assignment will try to improve the cooperation of state correctional departments and institutions, to obtain accurate figures.

To communicate with and interest more A.A. members in institutions work, it was suggested that: (1) News items about institutions be periodically printed in *Box 4-5-9*; (2) we ask the delegates to help carry to A.A. groups the message that we need more institutions workers; (3) institutions committee members meet regionally as well as locally to exchange ideas; (4) a one-page flyer with helpful institutions sharing be sent to institutions committees. Such flyers could be reproduced by the institutions committees and passed on to others.

Austin MacCormick, chairman

1980 International Convention

Addition of Al-Anon to Site Committee urged

Trustees' committee: Roughly 10% of those registered in Denver filled out the Convention questionnaire. Of those, 63% felt the Convention was "excellent"; 30%, "satisfactory." Many good suggestions for improving our next Convention, received on questionnaires and in letters, will be given serious consideration.

The committee recommended to the board that Ted Driscoll, a convention consultant who worked with us on Denver, be

retained to work with us for 1980 — beginning in a non-voting, advisory capacity on the Site Committee

Invitations to bid on the 45th Anniversary International Convention (1980) were sent to all delegates and committee chairmen. Interested cities were asked to submit bids by January 10, 1976. The guarantee fund previously required from the host city is no longer necessary, in the opinion of this committee. We did not request hotel rate information, since it will be useless four years from now.

Bids were received from Anaheim, Calif., Atlanta, Ga., Atlantic City, N.J., Chicago, Ill., Detroit, Mich., Edmonton, Alta., Houston, Tex., Kansas City, Mo., Las Vegas, Nev., Los Angeles, Calif., Minneapolis/St. Paul, Minn., Montreal, Que., New Orleans, La., New York, N.Y., Salt Lake City, Utah, San Francisco, Calif., and Seattle, Wash. We recommended that both Las Vegas and Chicago be disqualified, since they could not host the Convention on the July Fourth weekend in 1980.

A request was received from one convention and visitors' bureau for names and addresses of Site Committee members. We recommended that any such request be denied, but said any promotional material provided would be forwarded.

We received a suggestion that Al-Anon have representation on the Site Committee, and recommended that Al-Anon be invited to seat one voting member.

The committee recommended the following ground rules for the Site Committee meeting at the Conference: (1) 15 minutes for each bid presentation, used by the delegate from the area including each bidding city in any way he or she chooses; (2) questions and answers following each bid for as long as necessary; (3) after all presentations and questions, each committee member to write down first, second, and third choices; the three cities with the most votes will be put to the Conference.

Final selection of the site is made by the General Service Board, following an inspection trip by the Convention Planning Committee.

Terrance Penton, chairman

Internationalists

540 carry message on seas

Staff report: About 540 participate in our Internationalists Service. Seagoing A.A.'s carry the A.A. message around the world. Eight groups hold meetings aboard ships.

This service helps A.A.'s at sea keep in touch with one another and G.S.O. Every year, we send an updated list of Internationalists to seagoing A.A.'s. Beginning this year, the list is also sent to Loners, making it possible for all to correspond with one another.

Thirty-two Internationalists who no longer go to sea serve as port contacts in various parts of the world. They extend the hand of A.A. to Internationalists coming into port, and some have started A.A. groups.

Six times a year, the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* (re-

placing the *Round Robin* newsletter) is sent to Internationalists, port contacts, and Internationalists groups. On alternate months, *Box 4-5-9* is sent. They also receive A.A. directories.

The service started in 1948 when a seagoing A.A. left the Big Book in three Far Eastern ports.

Yolanda Lazo

Literature

Big Book #3, 'Living Sober,' 'Different' among projects

Trustees' committee: Completed literature projects include "Living Sober," the new booklet, which appears to be quite popular; the revision of "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"; reprints of "A.A. for the Woman" and "Young People and A.A.," which now include special questions for those groups; and "The Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders."

Current literature projects include:

- "*So You Think You're Different*" — completed draft circulated for final suggestions.
- "*Do You Live With an Alcoholic?*" (combining "The Alcoholic Wife" and "The Alcoholic Husband") — a third draft, incorporating suggestions from both Literature Committees, is being submitted.
- "*Alcoholics Anonymous*" — the third edition of the Big Book goes to print soon; no changes from pages xxii to 312; in parts II and III, seven stories deleted and 13 new stories added.
- *Teenage cartoon pamphlet* — a script on teenaged alcoholics, called "Teenagers Rap About Drinking," has been sent to both Literature Committees for comments. A copy was also sent to the International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A. for suggestions.

Among other actions, the committee considered and tabled a suggestion for a service pamphlet, to be discussed later. Under exploration is a pamphlet for agnostics. Updating "Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age" will be discussed at our August meeting.

We recommend that action on pamphlets directed to special groups be deferred until after the publication of "So You Think You're Different."

The committee agreed that "Young People and A.A." meets the needs of teenaged A.A.'s for the present time. Two of the stories are about teenagers, and another teenage pamphlet is in the works.

We discussed the word "suggested" when referring to the Twelve Steps. The sense of the meeting was that present terminology is consistent with that used in the Big Book, the "Twelve and Twelve," and other A.A. literature.

We decided against, at this time: a pamphlet on "First Aid for Twelfth-Steppers"; a reprint of a Grapevine article on the Washingtonians; an illustrated pamphlet on the Twelve Con-

cepts; a questionnaire for senior citizens; and a reprint of the Big Book's fifth chapter with a guide to the Twelve Steps.

George Gordon, chairman

Loners

G.S.O. serves about 380 Loners; many start groups

Staff report: Approximately 400 Loners are currently listed at G.S.O. In about 80 countries besides English-speaking, Spanish, French, German, and many other nationalities are represented, including two Czechoslovakians and two Hungarians.

Lone Members, as the name implies, are A.A.'s unable to attend meetings, usually because no A.A. group is available. We give them a complimentary package of literature and mimeographed sheets of ideas drawn from the experience of other Loners on how to stay sober through correspondence.

The appropriate directory is sent to all Loners, as well as the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* and *Box 4-5-9*.

We encourage the Lone Member to seek another alcoholic who wants help, and form an A.A. group. We have seen the birth of many groups in such places as: Abdu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates; Laona, Wisconsin; and Vaduthala, Cochin, India.

An important contribution to this service is the participation of Loner Sponsors, listed with us from around the world.

Yolanda Lazo

Nominating

Regional changes, Class A trustees, Mexico considered

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed Alaska's 1975 request for a change of region (subsequently withdrawn). To avoid similar occurrences in the future, the committee recommended to the Conference Committee on Trustees the following additional procedures for requesting a region change:

1 That G.S.R.'s in the area be informed by the area committee of all necessary facts, both advantages and disadvantages, in order to make a sound decision before requesting a change; that a simple majority (one-half plus one) of G.S.R.'s be present (or respond to a mail poll) and two-thirds of the majority present or responding by mail agree before an area petitions for a change of region.

2 That a form filled in by the delegate indicate:

a That all G.S.R.'s were informed of all pertinent facts in advance of the assembly (or mail poll);

b Total number of groups in area and number of G.S.R.'s present at the assembly or responding by mail;

c Number of G.S.R.'s in favor and opposed.

3 Change of region should become effective at the *end* of the Conference at which it was approved. For the duration of the Conference, the area remains a part of the region it has requested to leave, and votes with that region if a regional trustee election is held.

The committee reviewed the new procedure for reducing the number of candidates for election as general service trustee — U.S./Canada, as recommended by the 1975 General Service Conference, and proposed to the Conference Committee on Trustees this addition to the procedure (to appear as item 3e — see p. 46 in the 1975 *Conference Report*):

e Prior to the election meeting, each region will caucus during the regional lunches at the General Service Conference. (1) The regional trustee will act as chairman of the session. (2) Using Third Legacy procedure, the number of candidates from the region will be reduced to one for each region in the U.S. and two for each region in Canada. (3) Names of candidates will be given to the secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee following the regional lunches.

The committee discussed a suggested Conference agenda subject — that the General Service Board consist entirely of A.A. trustees. The delegate making the suggestion emphasized that all A.A.'s appreciate the love and dedication of the nonalcoholic trustees, but questioned why, after 40 years of existence, with a membership of over 800,000, we do not consider replacing (as they resign or retire from the board) nonalcoholic with alcoholic trustees.

The trustees' Nominating Committee pointed out that among the many good reasons for nonalcoholic trustees are:

1 They provide the valuable and irreplaceable service of being able to speak with authority for A.A. at the public level.

2 The boards of most corporations have representatives from other industries and/or professions in order to gain outside expertise and fresh ideas. In the same way, A.A. needs and benefits from the points of view of interested and knowledgeable nonalcoholics.

The committee referred this to the Conference Committee on Trustees for consideration during the 1976 Conference, so that committee can make its recommendations to the entire Conference. The Nominating Committee is convinced that nonalcoholic trustees perform a vital and necessary function, and their voluntary contributions to the Fellowship are immeasurable and invaluable.

The committee approved the résumés of John Ryall and Fred J. Sengstacke, submitted by the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and recommended their election as directors of the Grapevine.

The committee approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustee from the West Central and Western Canada Regions.

The committee approved the résumé of Edward Small for general service trustee (New York), to be presented for election (effective August 3, replacing George Gordon) at the annual meeting of the board in April, following presentation to the Conference for disapproval, if any.

The committee approved the résumé of Michael Alexander as a Class A trustee, to be elected at the annual meeting of the board, following presentation to the Conference for disapproval, if any.

The committee recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the board, following presentation to the 1976 Conference:

Class A

John L. Norris, M.D.	Arthur Miles
John D. Bealer, M.D.	Gordon M. Patrick
Austin MacCormick	(one vacancy)
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.	

Class B

N. M. Cheater	Walter J. Murphy
Margaret J. Carlson	Mike Rainbolt
David T. Cooke	John E. Waterfield
*George N. Gordon, Ph.D.	Peter A. G. Watters
Charles H. Hanson	R. Bruce Wight
Robert Macpherson	Stanley R. Wilsey
Two regional trustees: W. Cent. U.S., W. Canada	

The committee reviewed the following slate of officers for election at the 1976 annual meeting of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairman</i>	John L. Norris, M.D.
<i>First vice-chairman</i>	Austin MacCormick
<i>Second vice-chairman</i>	Stanley R. Wilsey
<i>Secretary</i>	Peter A. G. Watters
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur Miles
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Beth Kuhlmann
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Dennis Manders

The committee recommended that the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1976 Conference:

John D. Bealer, M.D.	Martin Le Boutillier
David T. Cooke	Robert Macpherson
Jerry Danzig	Walter J. Murphy
Robert E. Hitchins	R. Bruce Wight
Beth Kuhlmann	

The committee recommended that the following directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be presented to the 1976 Conference:

Paula Carpenter	Jack Morley
*George N. Gordon, Ph.D.	John E. Ryall
Charles H. Hanson	Fred J. Sengstacke
Polly Marsh	Edward Small
Austin MacCormick	

The committee recommends to the Conference Committee on Trustees consideration of the following revisions in "The A.A. Service Manual":

1 That the section of "The A.A. Service Manual" (p. 100, 1975 edition) which outlines the procedure for election of Class B general service trustees (New York) explain in more detail the reasons for this method of election.

2 No candidate should be eligible for election as both regional trustee and general service trustee — U.S./Canada simultaneously.

*Serves through August board meeting. His replacement takes office following the August board meeting.

The committee recommended that the board consider forming a study committee to investigate the possibility of including Mexico in the General Service Conference — U.S./Canada.

Charles Hanson, chairman

Overseas

Overseas A.A. has 65 new groups, 19,000 new members

Staff report: Group membership overseas — 126,455; number of groups — 6,153. Since last year, 65 new groups have started, and membership has increased more than 19,000.

Outside U.S. and Canada, literature distribution centers in these countries provide their new groups with complimentary literature: Argentina, Australia, Belgium (Flemish and French), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Finland, France, Germany, Guatemala, Holland, Ireland, Mexico, Norway, South and Southwest Africa, Sweden, Switzerland (French and German).

Argentina publishes more than 18 pamphlets and the Big Book.

Australian A.A.'s incorporated their General Service Board this year. They supply literature to Indonesia, Malaysia, Singapore, and New Zealand.

Brazil is forming a General Service Board. We have invited Brazil to participate in the Fourth World Service Meeting.

Colombia has added "Living Sober" to their publications list. They have also arranged new terms with the central office in Caracas, Venezuela, to encourage A.A.'s growth there.

The El Salvador board prints 20 of our pamphlets, the Big Book, and "As Bill Sees It." Their A.A. population is the highest of the Spanish-speaking countries — 670 groups, remarkable for a country of that size.

Finland has added "Living Sober," "Twelve Concepts for World Service," "A.A. Comes of Age," and the Traditions half of the "Twelve and Twelve" to their list. They're bidding to host the 1978 World Service Meeting.

France has had a General Service Board for several years. They have been getting literature from Montreal, but are now requesting permission to reprint some in France. We have received a similar request from French-speaking Belgium.

Germany's literature sales are increasing tremendously. Their directory will include Austria and German-speaking Switzerland for the first time. Letters asking for A.A. help received at their G.S.O. are now being answered by their central offices, to reach the suffering alcoholic sooner.

This year, Mexico obtained permission to translate "A.A. Comes of Age," and wants to dub in Spanish the film "Bill's Own Story." Their first national convention is being held in April 1976.

South Africa has about 6,000 active A.A.'s. Their board is examining the possibility of hiring a paid G.S.O. worker.

A.A. in Great Britain ended 1975 with 838 groups, a 14% increase, compared with 10% or 12% in previous years. They've requested permission to reprint "Living Sober," which has been enthusiastically received there.

Many A.A. publications around the world are similar to our Grapevine or *Box 4-5-9*.

In the past year, we've seen a lot of A.A. progress in Trinidad, Saudi Arabia, Sri Lanka, and India.

Betty Liddle, Yolanda Lazo

Policy

Confidential A.A. material, 'special' pamphlets discussed

Trustees' committee: Voting members of the committee (not to exceed 18) are eight regional trustees, two general service trustees from outside the New York area, two G.S.O. staff members, a Grapevine director (who is also a trustee), the president and a director of A.A.W.S., and two additional trustees designated by the chairman of the board. The committee is responsible for problems or projects involving A.A. policy and Traditions.

Highlights of the two Policy Committee meetings held since the 1975 Conference are:

- The question of release of confidential A.A. information has come up because G.S.O. has received requests from outside and inside the Fellowship for certain information — such as the breakdown of the 1974 survey or a copy of a *Conference Report*. It was the sense of the meeting that there are no secrets in A.A., and that each request should be handled individually.
- A subcommittee was appointed to study the question of distribution of A.A. directories requested by non-A.A. agencies.
- The growing pressure to publish pamphlets on different subjects for every level of society was discussed. The trustees' Literature Committee chairman reported that many requests for pamphlets for "special" alcoholics have been received in the past few years, and that the committee has now declared a provisional moratorium on new pamphlets, until "So You Think You're Different" is available.
- The present policy of originating new pamphlets was approved.
- Dr. Paul McDonough, La Hacienda Treatment Center, Hunt, Tex., told of his first contact with A.A. in Wiesbaden, Germany. He felt that without the help of A.A., the Air Force program would not have survived. To establish a better working relationship between A.A. and the professional community, he asked: "Should A.A. be a part of the program, or merely an adjunct? Should meetings be held on the facilities' premises? Should patients be required to attend A.A. meetings?" Interesting discussion followed.

The C.P.C. Committee will review the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate."

Jim Griffin, chairman

Public Information

Over 10,000 queries, 5,200 A.A. stories processed

Staff report: Through the media (newspapers, magazines, radio, and TV), we make an effort to reach the active alcoholic. We also try to reach those in a position to help the alcoholic — wife, husband, clergyman, doctor, employer, and many others.

During 1975, we answered 10,158 requests for information about A.A. and processed 5,219 press clippings. An article about A.A. published in a Russian newspaper (sent by a member in Finland) has been translated and placed in our archives.

Color TV spots: 165 were distributed. Radio spots: 118 were distributed. One-Way Displays: 25 were sent to county and state meetings, with pamphlets.

We have 229 local P.I. committees and 541 P.I. contacts. For all these, we provide: (1) the P.I. Kit, which includes background editorial material, radio-TV material, and the A.A. Fact File; (2) the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, issued quarterly; (3) radio and TV spots; (4) Guidelines on Public Information.

There were 143 anonymity breaks. The annual anonymity letter was mailed in November to approximately 500 dailies.

Material was supplied for 41 writers and six major radio and TV programs. Information was made available to many educational and community service organizations. We filled hundreds of requests for copies of Dr. Norris's talk on results of our 1974 membership survey.

June Russell

Trustees' committee: The following projects were completed in 1975.

- The major effort of the year was in connection with the International Convention. Media coverage was worldwide. There were six A.P. stories, three U.P.I. stories, three Reuters dispatches, one Religious News Service story, and one A.P. photo. Stories published: 2,562. Total circulation: 128,355,570. A 362-page clipping report was turned over to the archives.
- The "Profile of an A.A. Meeting" pamphlet and the One-Way Display were revised to reflect the 1974 membership survey. The new title is "A.A. — a Community Resource for Coping With a National Health Problem."
- The annual anonymity letter, updated to reflect 1974 membership figures, was mailed to the press.
- Letters were sent to approximately 100 hospitals, rehabs, and intergroups asking whether they would like to have the One-Way Display. We would enclose the "Community Resource" pamphlet. If response is positive, we will ask A.A.W.S. for approval.

New projects in progress include:

- General committee objectives for 1976, such as writing a human-interest story describing A.A.'s self-support and anonymity.

ity concepts, to give the public a clearer understanding of our Fellowship; identifying A.A.'s role in the field of alcoholism more clearly; making a greater effort to reach minority groups; updating radio spots to include a black alcoholic and an English-speaking alcoholic with a Spanish accent; exploring new methods for distributing TV spots to local P.I. committees; producing radio spots geared to the young alcoholic; improving communication with the medical profession and the industrial community.

- In the January Grapevine there was a nine-page symposium on doctors. We plan to send about 500 copies, with a buck slip, to medical directors, medical science writers, large newspapers, and A.P., U.P.I., and other news syndicates.
- We will gather news stories and editorials that praise our Fellowship and distribute them with a future *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, to bring them to the attention of local committees.
- We will send the column "An Alcoholic, Anonymous" (written by an A.A. in Idaho and published weekly in a local newspaper) to local committees. We'll emphasize that this column may be reprinted in any newspaper and needs no credit line.
- The P.I. background editorial material (ten stories about A.A.) has been updated.
- We will write local committees asking whether they would like us to send TV spots directly to stations in their area, or would prefer distributing the spots there themselves.
- We will recommend to A.A.W.S. that we distribute our 30- and 60-second TV spots to stations without charge.

Walter Murphy, chairman

Regional mini-conferences

Trial mini-conferences held

Staff report: Two regional mini-conferences were held on an experimental basis — the first in the Southeast in December and the second in the West Central Region in March.

The coordinator plans meetings with the regional trustee and the G.S.O. general manager, works with the regional host committee, handles arrangements with the hotel in the host city, makes travel and hotel plans for trustees and G.S.O. staff.

The agenda is planned with the regional trustee and current delegates in the region. Regional mailings go to current delegates, G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past and present delegates, past and present trustees, and central offices.

The coordinator is also responsible for mini-conference boards, sample literature, and the report on the mini-conference, mailed to all participants, trustees, and current delegates.

All sessions except workshops are taped. Workshops are summarized in written form.

Cora Louise Belford, coordinator

Chairman, General Service Board: Last year, I spoke about try-

ing a series of regional get-togethers attended by service personnel in each region, plus perhaps ten or so people representing the board and G.S.O. In Denver last July, we met with delegates from each region and regional trustees. We felt we should try a couple of these get-togethers on an experimental basis.

Now we have held two regional mini-conferences. Both fully met our hopes. The sharing that took place was invaluable for the members of the board and staff.

Mini-conferences are intended simply as a way of providing communication between A.A. service workers and their board and G.S.O. We think of these as sharing sessions, where no actions or recommendations take place. The Conference is our policy- and decision-making body, and recommendations to the Conference should be made through the Conference structure (through the G.S.R. or D.C.M. to the assembly, so the delegate can submit the group conscience of his area to the group conscience of the entire Conference).

Since some *areas* call their pre-Conference assembly meetings "mini-conferences," there is some confusion between these and the *regional* mini-conferences. So if we continue to hold *regional* mini-conferences, we shall consider calling them "A.A. regional forums," rather than mini-conferences. We would like to know what you think of that idea.

John L. Norris, M.D.

Southeastern regional trustee: The first regional mini-conference was highly successful. Free, open, and honest discussion took place at all sessions. Participants from the board and G.S.O. included Dr. Norris, Dave Cooke, George Gordon, Margaret Carlson, Bob Hitchins, Phyllis Masback, and Cora Louise Belford. Each of us made brief introductory remarks at the opening session.

Saturday morning, the 12 current delegates from the Southeastern Region spoke on matters of concern in their particular areas: (1) growing pains due to the influx of alcoholics from funded programs; (2) growth in service structure; (3) the need to educate members on sponsorship; and (4) the need to make members aware of all Three Legacies, not just one. Delegates suggested that we grow out of problems when we accept them as challenges. One delegate felt we may have personalities rather than problems, and stressed the need for A.A. Traditions. Another expressed concern about the Big Book price, the cost of doing business in New York City, and limiting the years of employment of G.S.O. staff members.

In the afternoon, there were five workshops, followed by an Ask-It Basket session. Saturday evening, we held an open forum for more questions and answers and discussion.

All of the Southeastern Region, except Puerto Rico, was represented. We had visitors from Washington, California, Oklahoma, Nebraska, and Missouri. There were 292 service workers present: 146 G.S.R.'s, 47 D.C.M.'s, 26 area committee officers, 35 delegates and past delegates, 8 trustees and past trustees, 3 central office secretaries, 27 A.A. group members.

At an evaluation session, response to all questions was positive, agreeing that mini-conferences can improve communication.

Dave Cooke

West Central regional trustee: The second regional mini-conference was a rewarding and gratifying experience for all participants — people from the region and members of the G.S. Board and G.S.O. staff. I had also attended, as an observer, the South-eastern Regional Mini-Conference in Atlanta. You really couldn't say one was more successful than the other, because people seemed to feel that they got what they wanted and needed from both. Certainly, the West Central people were grateful for the opportunity to visit with so many members of the board and staff, who in turn felt they got a much better understanding of A.A. in the region.

Participants included: Dr. Norris; regional trustees Jim Griffin, Terry Penton, and Bruce Wight; Jack Morley, Grapevine staff; Bob Pearson and Cora Louise Belford, G.S.O. Each of us made brief talks, covering the Grapevine board and office, A.A. World Services, Inc., G.S.O., the Conference structure, building a service structure in an area and a region, and the function of the board and its committees.

Eight West Central delegates spoke on matters of concern in their particular areas: the falling-off of sponsorship and low interest in the Second and Third Legacies; growth in teenage membership and senior citizens' groups; public information and institutions work; A.A. growth; the small percentage of A.A. groups that make contributions; club problems; drug addiction; the possibility of redistributing; improvements in service work and communication.

One delegate expressed concern that, of the approximately 15,000 individuals who will be treated for alcoholism in his state, the 85% who will be referred to A.A. will be oriented toward the treatment center, where they will serve as volunteers, rather than toward A.A. service work.

There were open floor discussions, five unstructured workshops, and an Ask-It Basket session. We saw the film "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" — the first opportunity many had had to see it.

All states in the region were represented, with 275 in attendance: 110 G.S.R.'s, 32 D.C.M.'s, 17 area committee officers, 27 past and present delegates, 5 past and present trustees, 84 A.A. group members.

The last morning, we held an evaluation session; the response to all questions was enthusiastic approval. All agreed the size and length of the mini-conference were about right.

The session was closed with brief talks by Don Farrell, former West Central trustee, and Dr. Norris. Dr. Jack told his A.A. service story and encouraged us to share with interested people outside the Fellowship.

Jim Griffin

Staff coordinator

20,000 letters answered by G.S.O. staff in 1975

Staff report: Each of the ten G.S.O. staff members has a specific service assignment. Some assignments also carry responsibility for a certain bulletin, and staff members also act as secretaries

to board and Conference committees. Work is apportioned as follows:

Staff coordinator

Group services coordinator

Assistant group services

Conference

Regional mini-conferences

Cooperation with the professional community

Public information

Overseas, World Service Meeting,
International Convention
(1980)

Institutions

Loners, Internationalists,
Spanish correspondence

Quarterly Report; assistant secretary to board of trustees; secretary to the trustees' Policy Committee and Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions
secretary to the board of A.A. World Services, Inc.; secretary of Conference Report and Charter Committee
Box 4-5-9 (English and French); secretary of trustees' and Conference Literature Committees
secretary to Conference Agenda Committee and trustees' Conference Committee
secretary to Conference Committee on Trustees and trustees' Nominating Committee
About A.A.; *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*; secretary to trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees
P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin; secretary to trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees
secretary to World Service Meeting Committee; secretary to trustees' and Conference Convention Committees
Institutions Bulletin; secretary to trustees' and Conference Institutions Committees
Loners-Internationalists Meeting; *Box 4-5-9* (Spanish)

One basic responsibility of the staff is answering correspondence — in 1975, over 20,000 letters were answered by staff members. The staff coordinator sees that the mail gets out rapidly during vacations, sickness, or absences or when a staff member has a special project requiring full-time work. Otherwise, each staff member handles the mail from a specifically assigned area. The staff coordinator keeps a calendar of vacations, trips scheduled, and days off.

A rewarding aspect of staff work is the invitations received yearly from A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and state and provincial get-togethers. During trips to local areas, the staff has an opportunity to acquaint A.A.'s there with the services provided by G.S.O., and the trips also help the staff obtain facts on local problems and activities, to help us serve groups better.

In 1975, more than 1,000 visitors from all over the world visited G.S.O. and toured G.S.O. and Grapevine offices, the archives, and the Shipping Department. Each staff member meets each visitor to chat about A.A. in the visitor's area.

The staff coordinator represents the staff at weekly meetings of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee.

Weekly folders of answers to correspondence are circulated to G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, and publications and P.I. newspaper clippings mentioning A.A. are also circulated.

Staff meetings are held three times a month. The staff coordinator keeps minutes, which are circulated to all concerned — including the general manager and all department heads.

The staff coordinator also serves as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Beth Kuhlmann

World Service Meeting

17—no, 18!—delegations to fourth A.A. world meeting

Staff report: The Fourth World Service Meeting will be held in New York October 7-9, 1976. Countries participating are: Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Central America (Northern Zone), Central America (Southern Zone), Colombia, Finland, France, Germany, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, Sweden, United Kingdom, and U.S./Canada. We're hoping Brazil will be able to participate.*

The theme will be "Working With Others." A preliminary

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine

Over 84,000 magazine buyers read about tools of sobriety

Editors' report: The year since the 1975 Conference has been a year of Grapevine growth. Circulation is now (as of April 1) over 84,000.

Our stock of 25,000 calendars for 1976 was sold out, so the print order for 1977 has been substantially increased.

The Grapevine tries to be a tool for living sober. In the past 12 issues, we published 59 articles on the A.A. way of coping with problems of sober living: depression, resentments, ego and pride, guilt, self-pity, and others, including such daily traumas as a broken shoelace. Eleven articles were on spiritual experience; 13, on the Twelve Steps; 12, on the disease of alcoholism; 12, on carrying the message and sponsorship.

We have had 11 pieces by psychiatrists and other doctors, and seven dealing with alcoholism agencies other than A.A. and with A.A.'s employed in outside agencies.

We covered the Denver Convention. We had articles on structure and service work, group experience, problems of retired persons, newcomers, young people, oldtimers, and just about everything from social drinking to panhandling, from sex to insomnia. Every month's issue carried a piece on the Traditions. We have now scheduled a new 12-month series on them.

We have reports that groups hold Grapevine discussion meetings based on our "Closed Meeting Topics" in each issue. Many good A.A. members still do not know the Grapevine. We pray that you will carry with you the message of the Grapevine, one of our best tools for finding and maintaining sobriety.

Jack Morley, Paula Carpenter

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., tries to "keep it

agenda has been based on recommendations from the last meeting, correspondence, and accumulated experience.

Workshop and discussion topics include: how A.A. works in institutions around the world; special-interest groups; service bulletins; Central America's solutions and progress with literature distribution problems; building a service structure worldwide; site of the Fifth World Service Meeting; review of language requirement for delegates; reporting on and using the World Service Meeting at home.

Following close of the meeting, the delegates will be our guests at the annual New York Intergroup banquet. Some will be guest speakers. Delegates will visit Lois at Stepping Stones on October 10.

Betty Liddle

*Soon after this report was turned in, Brazilian representation was assured.

simple." The editorial staff consists of an editor, a managing editor, and a part-time copy-editor and proofreader, all A.A. members, assisted by one editorial secretary. Six people handle circulation, distribution, and bookkeeping.

We are now in a transition stage in production of the magazine. Our managing editor is retiring in August of this year. The editor and circulation manager will retire in a few years. To insure continuity, new people are being trained.

Our managing editor, Paula Carpenter, has been with the Grapevine more than 14 years. Her identification with the GV is so total, it is nearly impossible to quantify her contribution or to measure the qualifications of a successor to one so dedicated.

The Grapevine board of directors consists of nine people. The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is a separate, nonprofit corporation wholly owned by the General Service Board.

The Grapevine board meets every three months to conduct the business of the corporation, oversee publication, insure adherence to the Traditions, and plan the budget. Board members are available to the Grapevine staff on any business day.

An editorial board meets bimonthly to advise the editors, to help originate editorial ideas, and to carry out specific assignments. It has ten members, each with specific professional talents.

In December 1975, the Grapevine reached an all-time high paid circulation of 83,000. At our estimated pass-along rate of three readers per copy, this means more than 250,000 people read the Grapevine every month.

Income increased last year, so directors voted a contribution of \$25,000 to the General Service Board.

Charles Hanson, chairman

Consensus Reached on Fellowship Concerns

The group conscience of our Fellowship as a whole in 1976 was expressed largely in the eight following "Advisory [to the board] Actions" which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference.

Floor Actions

1 That Al-Anon be allowed one vote on the Convention Site Committee for the 1980 International Convention.

2 That we keep the Big Book, "Alcoholics Anonymous," as it is at this time and not publish a paperback edition.

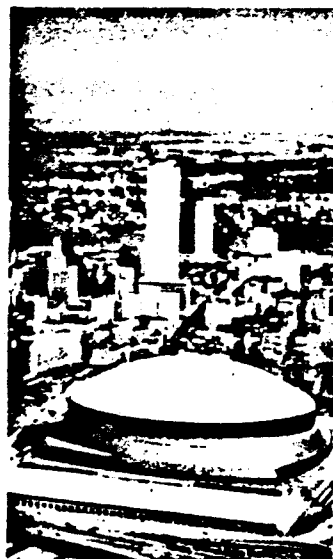
3 That a study be made of the feasibility of publishing a limited edition of the first edition of the Big Book, and report back at next year's Conference.

4 That G.S.O. discontinue distribution of the "Bill W." book [the biography published by Harper & Row], dispose of the present supply in the most feasible manner, and notify the Fellowship through Box 4-5-9 when the "Bill W." book is no longer available through G.S.O. Sense of the meeting was taken that the deletion of the listing in the catalog should be handled by overprinting or other method as G.S.O. sees fit.

5 That we go forward with mini-conferences and provide them as often as possible, and that these be held at the request of the region. The sense of the meeting was that for the time being the regional meetings be known as A.A. regional forums.

6 That the following Class B regional trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board: (a) Don Nicolson, West Central U.S. (four years); (b) Cecil Corrigan, Western Canada (four years).

7 The Convention Site Committee reported its selection as follows: (1) New Orleans, (2) Houston, (3) Seattle.



Tourists head for the French Quarter in New Orleans; convention-goers flock to the new Superdome complex.

8 That up to \$5,000 be authorized for a professional study of the feasibility of relocating G.S.O.; the result of this study to be reported at the 1977 Conference.

Presentation related to Floor Actions 2 and 3: pp. 12-13

Conference committee reports approved by the Conference also constitute Advisory Actions. Here are summaries of the reports as approved:

Agenda

Chairman—Fran Adams (Chicago)

9 That the A.A. meeting at the opening dinner be retained, and the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs be presented for talks every other year with one delegate speaker. On alternate years, that there be delegate speakers with a delegate chairman, and that this format be reviewed every year by the Agenda Committee.

10 That the following suggestions for the 1977 General Service Conference be considered:

a The 1975 General Service Conference recommended a two-year moratorium be placed on the discussion of special-purpose groups. The 1976 Agenda Committee, after much discussion, recommended that at this time there is no need for further discussion of this subject.

b Presentations followed by a workshop on the importance of rotation throughout the Fellowship.

c Cooperation and communication among all levels of service.

d A report on the A.A. directories.

e The word "Reports" be added to "Area Service Highlights."

f A roll call of the Conference members be taken at the opening session of the Conference.

g A presentation followed by a workshop on the Conference Charter and Warranties.

h The importance of the role of the alternate in service.

11 Suggestions for possible themes for the 1977 Conference:

The 1977 Conference theme should be built around the A.A. group. The following are suggestions for possible themes: (a) "The A.A. Group — the Heart of Our Fellowship"; (b) "The A.A. Group — Foundation of Service"; (c) "The A.A. Group — Where It Begins"; (d) "Service — Our Assurance of Survival"; (e) "Our Group — Our Service — Our Life"; (f) "Group Responsibility"; (g) "Our Responsibility to the Group"; (h) "Group Leadership."

12 That the delegates make every effort to send to G.S.O., no later than October 1, their suggestions for the 1977 Conference agenda and those of their G.S.R.'s and area committee members for consideration.

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Chairman—Jim Shaw (Southern California)

13 That more effort be directed toward utilizing the service structure we have available to implement our recommendations.

14 That we, as A.A. members, give to A.A. members interested in working or volunteering in the alcoholism field the following suggestions:

- a** Take advantage of the literature already in existence.
- b** Get adequate training.
- c** Have three to five years of good stable sobriety.
- d** Get and keep a sponsor who does *not* work in the alcoholism field.
- e** Be thoroughly familiar with "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions." Carefully consider whether or not you are suited to work in the field of alcoholism.

15 To alleviate some of the problems involved in sponsoring people coming to A.A. from treatment centers, court-A.S.A.P. programs, etc., we should:

- a** Establish greater communication between the referral sources and local A.A. groups.
- b** Recognize the necessity of meeting the new member where he presently is; listen to him; try to determine what he really knows about the A.A. program.
- c** See that specific programs are set up for sponsoring people from treatment centers into local A.A. groups.

16 That G.S.O. prepare a paper, consolidating existing information, for prospective members sent to us by the courts and other referral agencies, explaining our position on signing forms and describing the different types of A.A. meetings available, and that this paper should be directed particularly to the courts and other referral agency personnel, and to the new member, so that all concerned will know what A.A. can do and what A.A. cannot do.

17 In order to improve communication between A.A. and the professional community, we encourage A.A. members to become active on C.P.C. committees. Where there are existing P.I. and institutions committees, encourage cooperation among members of all committees, keeping always in mind that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Specific suggestions: (a) Sponsor your doctor; (b) sponsor your clergyman; (c) sponsor your employer; (d) communicate with the academic world; (e) hold workshops at all service levels.

Finance

Chairman—George Dorsey (Northern Coastal California)

18 That the Finance Committee of the General Service Board examine and restate the meaning of a "prudent reserve" as it relates to the G.S.O. structure, for possible consideration at a future Conference.

19 That the General Service Board and A.A. World Services board of directors consider reducing the net income from the sales of literature by appropriate means, such as:

- a** Special consideration be given to a substantial reduction in the price of the Big Book.
- b** Liberalizing the discount structure.
- c** The distribution of gratis or low-cost literature to P.I. committees, institutions committees, or new groups.

Delegates should emphasize that this recommendation is made in anticipation of increased group participation and that further efforts to control literature costs to the Fellowship, the Conference structure, and A.A. unity depend upon a solid base of group support.

A minority report accompanied this recommendation: "That the General Service Board and A.A. World Services board of directors reduce the price of the Big Book by at least \$.75" (not accepted by the Conference).

Grapevine

Chairman—Don Burow (Colorado)

20 We, the members of the Grapevine Committee of Panels 25 and 26, reaffirm the recommendation that areas be encouraged to invite the Grapevine staff to visit state and provincial conferences, with the suggestion that the invitation be made to the Grapevine staff directly. The committee feels that personal contact between Grapevine staff and A.A. members will stimulate interest in the Grapevine.

21 That groups or individuals send Grapevine subscriptions to local libraries.

22 That groups be encouraged to increase their subscriptions as their membership increases.

23 The Grapevine Committee would like to express its deep appreciation to a retiring member of the Grapevine staff—Paula Carpenter. Some time in August, Paula will close her desk for the last time, concluding more than 14 years of service as managing editor of our international magazine. Paula and her associates have steadily steered the Grapevine on a course that has won the approval of the Fellowship as A.A.'s primary source of communicating what co-founder Bill W. called "the language of the heart." Such editorial guidance requires great sensitivity to the pulsebeat of our membership, steadfast adherence to A.A. principles, and a capacity to co-operate with staff members and the Corporate Board. Paula

has done all this, not only with professional competence, but with love and dedication. On this, her 15th participation in a General Service Conference, members of this committee want to say, "Thank you, Paula."

Institutions

Chairman—Ike Bowers (Utah)

24 Whether we agree or disagree with a hospital's or a correctional facility's policy, we carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic when feasible, following the rules of the facility and cooperating the best we can within the A.A. Traditions.

25 It is suggested that A.A. members on the staff of a hospital or facility should not control A.A. meetings, but cooperate with institutions committees or responsible A.A. members who are carrying the message to that facility; also, refer to A.A. Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.

26 An excellent format for a hospital meeting was outlined in one of the editions of the A.A. Guidelines: "A.A. members not only tell briefly their own story, but also tell something about how A.A. works. A.A. members' experience says it is very important never to be argumentative, nor critical of anything. This seems to work best when the speakers . . . are very tolerant and good-natured; when, in other words, they make the A.A. way of life seem attractive."

It was felt that outside A.A. members taking meetings to institutions are more effective than meetings of inside A.A. members only.

27 That taking a collection at a hospital A.A. meeting be left to the discretion of the institutions committee.

28 That next year the 1977 Conference Institutions Committee add to its agenda the following: Define what a rehabilitation facility is and how the institutions committee can handle it.

29 That the trustees' and Conference Institutions Committees be divided into two subcommittees each: (a) Correctional Institutions; (b) Hospitals and Rehabilitation Centers.

Literature

Chairman — Bill Syms (Northeast Ontario)

30 Current literature projects

a Big Book, "Alcoholics Anonymous"—third edition: that delegates take back to their areas a statement to the effect that the Big Book, "Alcoholics Anonymous," has not been changed in preparing the third edition—that only the stories have been updated and some new ones added.

b Working title "So You Think You're Different": that the pamphlet have a new title, "Do You Think You're Different?" The agnostic story, "My Name Is Jan," is to be added, and the Spanish story, "My Name Is Maria," is to be deleted.

c Working title "Do You Live With an Alcoholic?" (pamphlet combining "The Alcoholic Wife" and "The Alcoholic Husband"): that a new title be employed, "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?," with a subtitle, "A.A.'s message of hope." The third draft was accepted as is.

d Teenage cartoon pamphlet: that the title for the teenage cartoon pamphlet be "Teenagers and A.A." The manuscript was unanimously accepted.

31 That action on pamphlets directed to special groups of alcoholics be deferred until after the publication of "Do You Think You're Different?"

32 Present terminology used regarding the word "suggested" when referring to the Twelve Steps is consistent with that employed in the Big Book, the "Twelve and Twelve," and other A.A. literature and should remain as is.

33 That the trustees' Literature Committee look into reproducing "How It Works" on wallet-size cards.

34 That the trustees' Literature Committee study the Conference keynote address in 1972, about our Third Legacy, to be considered for a future service pamphlet.

Presentations on literature: pp. 11-13

Conference Policy/Admissions

Chairman—Duane Harder (Central Michigan)

35 That the current agenda format be approved for 1977.

36 The 1976 Conference questionnaire was approved with the following questions added for 1977:

a Do you feel there is enough time for discussion of committee and trustee reports?

b Do you feel "Area Service Highlights" are valuable to the Conference as a whole?

37 Question 9 of the questionnaire to read as follows: "Please list suggestions for improving or 'changing' the Conference."

38 The members of the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions feel that there is insufficient time allotted at the Conference for adequate discussion of committee reports before the vote is called for upon each report.

The committee also feels that the committee meetings should be concluded earlier in the week, so that the reports, with discussion thereon, could be had on Thursday, with the final discussion and vote on Friday.

Therefore, the committee recommends that a study be made by the appropriate trustees' committee of the feasibility of accomplishing this result by eliminating or shortening the following sessions: (a) "Area Service Highlights"; (b) presentations/discussions; (c) workshops.

The committee further recommends that a feasibility report be

made at the 1977 General Service Conference for further action by the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions.

Public Information

Chairman—Warren Russell (Connecticut)

39 At the present time, we do not need more specialized literature for special categories of people to carry the A.A. message to the public.

40 That, before speaking to a non-A.A. audience, A.A. members read the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."

It was further recommended that A.A. members speaking at non-A.A. meetings refrain from getting involved in a discussion regarding mood-changing drugs.

41 We are not falling short on public information at the public level; but there should be more understanding about P.I. within our groups.

42 There is good cooperation among P.I., C.P.C., and institutions committees in most areas.

43 That the new pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" be included in the P.I. Kit.

44 That the P.I. Kit be sent to all members of the Conference P.I. Committee.

45 That for communication purposes, consideration be given to a joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions.

Presentations on public information: pp. 13-15

Committee on Trustees

Chairman—F. P. Ryan (Western Missouri)

46 That the following persons be elected as trustees of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 36; the Conference approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; and that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 36; slate of officers also approved].

47 That Michael Alexander be elected as a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

48 That Edward Small be elected Class B general service trustee (New York) at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

49 That there be no change in the structure of the General Service Board: seven nonalcoholic and 14 alcoholic trustees.

50 That the revised description of the general service trustee (New York), with procedure for election and reasons for it,



Upon the approval of the 1976 Conference, Michael Alexander was elected to the General Service Board as a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee. See p. 53 for a brief summary of Mike's background.

replace paragraph 1 of "How A.A. Chooses Its General Service Trustees" in "The A.A. Service Manual," 1975 edition, page 100, and that the recommendation be forwarded to the Conference Report and Charter Committee.

51 That no person be eligible simultaneously as a candidate for both regional trustee and general service trustee — U.S./Canada.

52 That the following revisions be made in the procedure for areas requesting a change of region ("A.A. Service Manual," page 97, 1975 edition). (Forwarded to Conference Report and Charter Committee.)

a That the G.S.R.'s in the area be informed in advance by the area committee of the necessary facts—both advantages and disadvantages—in order to make a sound decision in requesting a change of region; that a simple majority (one-half plus one) of G.S.R.'s be present (or respond to a mail poll) and that two-thirds of the majority present or responding by mail agree before an area petitions for a change of region.

b Upon notification by the delegate of the plan to change regions, G.S.O. will provide a form to be filled in by the delegate indicating that the conditions outlined have been fulfilled.

c The delegate from the area requesting a change of region will write, on behalf of the assembly, to the secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, stating the request and enclosing the completed form. The delegate will also send copies of the letter and form to the trustees in the two regions involved.

d The delegate will ask the General Service Office to send a letter to all of the area delegates in the two regions involved, requesting that they obtain the group conscience of their respective areas on the proposed change of region, and that they indicate approval/disapproval on an enclosed card.

e Approval by two-thirds of the delegates from each region involved is *required* before the proposal is presented to the General Service Conference for its action. A change of region will become effective at the *end* of the Conference at which it was approved.

53 That the following suggestions for the preelection caucus be added to the procedure to reduce the number of candidates in the election of general service trustee — U.S./Canada. (Forwarded to the Conference Report and Charter Committee.)

Prior to the election meeting, each region will caucus (possibly at regional lunches) during the General Service Conference, with the regional trustee acting as chairman of the session. Using Third Legacy procedure, the number of candidates from

the region will be reduced to one for each region in the U.S. and two for each region in Canada. A maximum of six candidates for general service trustee—U.S. and a maximum of four for general service trustee—Canada will be presented to the voting members of the Conference. The names of the candidates will be given to the secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee following the caucuses.

54 In the résumé for Class B regional trustee, the presence of a separate category on "Employment in the Field of Alcoholism" seems to suggest that such employment is an important recommendation. In its present form, this category seems to have too much weight, and the committee suggests that information about employment in the field of alcoholism be included instead in "Business Experience," with a question such as "Are you a salaried employee in the field of alcoholism?"

Conference Report and Charter

Chairman—Joan Barclay (Nevada)

55 That the "Rights of Appeal and Petition" not be added to the Conference Charter at this time, but that a footnote be added to page 113 of "The A.A. Service Manual" (1975 edition) where the short form of the Twelve Concepts appears, stating, "The Twelve Concepts for world service (long form) should be studied in detail."

56 Resolution: It is resolved by the 1976 General Service Conference that those instruments requiring consent of three-quarters of the responding groups for change or amendment would include the Twelve Steps of A.A. should any such change or amendment ever be proposed.

57 That, in case a change is needed in the Twelve Traditions, the Twelve Steps, or the Six Warranties of Article 12, wherever the words "registered A.A. groups of the world," "registered groups," or "directory-listed groups" appear in "The A.A.

Service Manual" and "Twelve Concepts for World Service," a bracketed sentence be inserted to state, "This would include all A.A. groups known to the general service offices around the world."

58 That all groups be encouraged to subscribe to *Box 4-5-9*. A further suggestion: Include in "The Bulletin Board" of *Box 4-5-9* a subscription form carrying information on the rate per copy and bulk rate.

59 The committee received from the Conference Committee on Trustees and approved a number of changes to be made in "The A.A. Service Manual."

Meeting during the Conference, each committee elected a new chairman and alternate chairman from among its Panel 26 members, as follows:

Committee	Chairman	Alternate chairman
Agenda	Jerry Frolich (Mid-S. Calif.)	Jerry Sullivan (Kans.)
Conference Report and Charter	Gene Daniel (S.W. Tex.)	Paul Wright (Md.)
Finance	Joe Kraus Jr. (Tenn.)	Larry Kloepfel (N.M.)
Grapevine	Bud Grondahl (N.Dak.)	John Rose (W. Ont.)
Institutions	"Turk" Lassiter (Wyo.)	Hank Cleaveland (Me.)
Literature	Joe Fuller (Alsk.)	Kenneth Dunphy (N.B./P.E.I.)
Conference Policy/ Admissions	Margaret Kemp (N. Int. Calif.)	Donald Shipp (Miss.)
Public Information	Cliff Roche (San Diego)	Marg Fuller (Man.)
Cooperation with the Professional Community	James Jones (R.I.)	Gordon Matkin (Alta.)
On Trustees	Stanley Cameron (Sask.)	Colette Ross (W. Mass.)

Delegates' Meeting

At the meeting on Thursday evening, Byron Barnes (Eastern Missouri), elected delegate chairman in 1975, presided over a discussion that led to the following conclusions.

1 Sense of the meeting: Bring G.S.O.'s attention to area needs and concerns related to the widespread problem with mailings and records; ask G.S.O. to tell delegates exactly what they might do to cooperate with G.S.O. and what G.S.O. might do to cooperate with them.

2 Sense of the meeting: Go on record as strongly urging the format of the Conference be changed so that the Conference committee reports will be in Conference members' hands Thursday morning or Thursday afternoon, in ample time to discuss them before voting on Friday morning.

3 It was the sense of the meeting that in the delegates' meeting there be no restrictions on any subject the delegates want to discuss.

4 It was the sense of the meeting that at the regional luncheons next year, one person be picked out of each region and that person be its nominee for delegate chairman, Panel 27.

5 The delegates wished to put in the minutes a note of appreciation to their chairman for the fine job he had done.

6 The delegates wished to put in the minutes their appreciation for the fine job that Mary Ellen Welsh, as Conference secretary, and other members of the General Service Office staff had done in putting on this Conference.

7 The Panel 26 delegates wished to put in the minutes their vote of appreciation for the Panel 25 delegates' cooperation and help.

8 Fred Forbes (District of Columbia) made a report outlining the methods used and the steps taken by his area to reach its goal of 100% (all groups) in contributing to G.S.O.

9 Jim Smith (Arizona) was elected area delegate chairman; Stanley Cameron (Saskatchewan), alternate chairman.

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1975

INCOME	1975	1974
Net sales, after book discounts waived of \$132,095 in 1975 and \$102,141 in 1974	\$1,923,612	\$1,244,684
Less: Cost of printing	570,833	368,168
Royalties	224,651	148,348
Gross profit from literature	1,128,128	728,168
Contributions – A.A. groups and members	807,287	749,804
Interest income	11,373	8,044
40th Anniversary Convention	82,991	—
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>2,029,779</u>	<u>1,486,016</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	858,220	709,620
Rent	92,615	82,094
Office construction costs	2,819	10,108
Box 4-5-9	40,777	38,186
A.A. directories—prepublication expenses (1974)	58,136	4,755
Other General Service Office printing	47,874	31,852
Shipping and mailing	176,450	150,044
Other office expenses	147,732	119,328
Insurance and taxes	82,929	64,930
Professional services	22,716	24,580
Board, committee, staff meetings	26,151	24,194
1974 World Service Meeting	—	17,106
Writing, research	6,169	9,188
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	21,323	18,879
General Service Conference	53,932	50,299
Chairman's world service trip	8,392	—
Mini-conference and other expenses	7,999	5,213
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>1,654,234</u>	<u>1,360,376</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>375,545</u>	<u>125,640</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 578,767	\$ 260,584
General Fund – General Service Board	(203,222)	(134,944)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1975

	Reserve	Pension	Convention Guaranty
Balance, January 1, 1975	\$331,321	\$ 106,574	\$ 15,791
Book discounts		132,095	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500	
Investment income	23,386	7,503	
Less: Current funding costs		(64,674)	
Actuary fee		(4,918)	
Deposits and interest returned			(15,791)
Balance, December 31, 1975	<u>354,707</u>	<u>180,080</u>	<u>—0—</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1975

Note A—Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 by transfer from the GENERAL FUND of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the board of trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1975

Financial statements

	1975	1974
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$417,067</u>	<u>\$333,821</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	\$57,043	\$47,380
Printing	95,822	81,721
Mailing – Service	22,486	28,492
– Postage	12,640	10,807
Other printing costs	3,336	4,781
Calendar costs	15,528	13,506
Best Cartoons	2,949	751
Rent	9,149	8,958
Telephone	1,147	1,337
Office supplies and expenses	2,838	2,063
Other editorial expenses	4,379	3,783
Office cleaning	<u>2,030</u>	<u>1,772</u>
<u>Total</u>	229,347	205,351
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	59,422	54,413
Data processing costs	17,478	17,520
Stationery and supplies	3,056	2,610
Rent	9,148	8,958
Telephone	1,147	1,340
Other office expense	1,923	1,781
Selling expense	17,151	13,541
Postage	7,811	9,059
Office cleaning	2,030	1,772
Bad debts	<u>1,373</u>	<u>1,198</u>
<u>Total</u>	120,539	112,192
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	3,700	2,958
Legal and accounting	5,400	3,741
Taxes	6,862	5,676
Meetings and conferences	557	1,061
Furniture and equipment	1,498	45
Contribution to Retirement Plan	<u>3,500</u>	<u>3,500</u>
<u>Total</u>	21,517	16,981
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>371,403</u>	<u>334,524</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	45,664	(703)
Interest earned	<u>17,556</u>	<u>12,819</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>63,220</u>	<u>12,116</u>

(continued)

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the benefit of the employees of A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., prior to transfer to the trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY and OPERATING FUNDS were established in prior years to: (1) segregate funds set aside from the GENERAL FUND and by other subscribers to underwrite a possible deficit of the 40th Anniversary Convention held in Denver in July 1975, and (2) to record income and expenses of the Convention. Both accounts were closed in 1975 by refunding the guaranty deposits and transferring the net Convention income of \$82,991 to the General Fund.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1975

Financial statements

	December 31, 1975		December 31, 1974	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash	\$ 488,710	\$111,020	\$202,308	\$105,850
Savings accounts and certificates	171,222	190,766	15,463	47,771
Marketable securities	—	125,144	—	145,291
Accounts receivable	80,481	5,646	85,320	6,915
Due from Convention Operating Fund	—	—	22,275	—
Due from Grapevine	25,000	—	5,000	—
Inventories	440,700	4,894	458,400	5,140
Prepaid expenses	34,109	17,894	22,413	9,526
Total Assets	1,240,222	455,364	811,179	320,493
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	143,595	35,901	121,726	15,398
Due Pension Fund	7,117	—	6,988	—
Prepaid subscriptions, unearned income	—	301,505	—	225,357
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	—	7,000	—	7,000
Total Liabilities	150,712	344,406	128,714	247,755
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	682,465	72,738	551,825	65,622
Net income for year (Exhibits A and B)	375,545	63,220	125,640	12,116
Contribution received (paid)	25,000	(25,000)	5,000	(5,000)
Transfer from Convention Guaranty Fund	6,500	—	—	—
Total Net Worth	1,089,510	110,958	682,465	72,738
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$ 940,731		\$661,964	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	148,779		20,501	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,089,510		682,465	
Reserve Fund	354,707		331,321	
Deferred Pension Fund	180,080		106,574	
Convention Guaranty Fund	—		15,791	
Total Net Worth	1,624,297		1,136,151	
RESERVE AND DEFERRED PENSION FUNDS				
	Reserve		Deferred Pension	
Cash	\$ —		\$ —	
Savings accounts and certificates	7,862		172,963	
Due from A.A.W.S.	—		7,117	
U.S. Treasury obligations	199,955		—	
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	140,129		—	
Accrued interest	6,761		—	
Balance, December 31	354,707		180,080	

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

Note B — After transfers of \$300,000 in 1975 and \$100,000 in 1974 from Publishing to General Fund.

The financial statements and foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountants.

1976 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$2,222,000. This is 15% higher than 1975 and allows for additional income generated by an increase in retail prices for a full year (less the cost of bulk discounts) and, of course, by Fellowship growth. Sales income is based on the sale of 195,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 99,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" — regular edition, 28,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" — pocket edition, 20,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 29,000 "As Bill Sees It," 90,000 booklets, and 6,500,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$855,500 — the cost of producing the literature and the royalties paid on book sales — the gross profit from sales is estimated at \$1,366,500.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$661,900, an increase of 21% over 1975. This increase provides for expected higher costs related to an increase in publishing activity, higher postal rates, and the cost of implementing electronic data-processing equipment and systems. Net publishing income after operating expenses is expected to be \$704,600.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Against the cost of servicing groups, we have budgeted contributions to be \$864,200. This is 7% higher than 1975 actual and is considered a conservative increase, because of the prevailing economic conditions that are affecting both the U.S. and Canada.

Expenses: Total expenses that represent the cost of group services, and are charged against group contributions, are expected to be \$1,047,700. Included in this portion of the expense budget is the cost of the General Service Conference — \$59,600. Service expenses are budgeted to be \$182,900 greater than contribution income. This deficit will be funded out of the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$107,700 less interest earned on cash flow. These expenses represent the cost of quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Public Information Committee and the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, the cost of four mini-conferences, the 1976 World Service Meeting, legal and auditing expenses, plus other special board projects. This net expense, totaling \$104,200, will also be paid for out of the income from the publishing operation.

After contributing \$287,100 toward the budgeted deficits, the total net income for the General Service Office is anticipated to be \$417,500.

1976 Grapevine Budget

Total income is budgeted at \$489,500, an increase of 17% over 1975 actual. This increase reflects subscriptions which are still at the rate of \$3.50 and will be renewed at the current \$5.00, plus a 5,000 additional order of 1977 Calendars at \$2.00 to individuals and less to groups.

Total expenses are budgeted at \$456,800, an increase of 23% over 1975 actual. This increase includes a separate sum of \$50,000 under administration to cover an orderly transition from the present staff.

Income from operations is budgeted at \$32,700, and **net income** (which includes interest), at \$51,700, a decrease of 21% from 1975 actual.

1976 G.S.O. Budget

Budgets

The budget for 1976 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$2,222,000*
Less: Cost of products	855,500
Gross profit from sales	1,366,500

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	704,600
----------------------------	---------

*Based upon the sale of:

195,000 books — "Alcoholics Anonymous"	
99,000 books — "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (Reg.)	
28,000 books — "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (Pocket)	
20,000 books — "A.A. Comes of Age"	
29,000 books — "As Bill Sees It"	
and	
Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items	

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$ 864,200
---------------	------------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	(182,900)
----------------------------	-----------

**Includes cost of General Service Conference — \$59,600

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 3,500
----------	----------

TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	(104,200)
----------------------------	-----------

***Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, World Service Meeting, mini-conferences, special projects

The publishing activity will contribute \$287,100 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1976 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$489,500
Estimated expense	456,800

Net income from operations	32,700
Interest from investments	19,000

Net income	51,700
----------------------	--------

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alabama	109	66	60.6%	16	24.2%	\$ 4,141.45	1,700	\$2.43
Alaska	50	31	62.0	1	3.2	2,203.50	549	4.01
Arizona	238	128	53.7	18	14.0	8,112.92	3,103	2.61
Arkansas	109	68	62.3	9	13.2	4,873.31	1,676	2.90
California	2,225	1,204	54.1	498	41.3	84,022.17	62,222	1.35
Colorado	238	161	67.6	43	26.7	12,212.38	3,369	3.62
Connecticut	437	133	30.4	36	27.0	17,069.80	7,682	2.22
Delaware	64	40	62.5	7	17.5	2,804.10	958	2.92
Dist. of Columbia	80	46	57.5	20	43.5	5,535.03	1,896	2.91
Florida	599	361	60.2	84	23.2	38,259.17	9,011	4.24
Georgia	237	160	67.5	55	34.3	10,909.08	4,010	2.72
Hawaii	67	40	59.7	10	25.0	5,753.83	1,255	4.58
Idaho	61	29	47.5	6	20.6	1,442.94	551	2.61
Illinois	1,141	416	36.4	124	29.8	27,859.65	19,820	1.40
Indiana	315	204	64.7	50	24.5	17,534.13	4,786	3.66
Iowa	181	109	60.2	13	11.9	7,739.17	3,488	2.21
Kansas	161	113	70.1	22	19.4	8,383.65	2,968	2.82
Kentucky	183	79	43.1	14	17.7	6,912.40	2,289	3.02
Louisiana	149	97	65.1	20	20.6	5,460.60	2,502	2.18
Maine	95	66	69.4	10	15.1	3,146.17	1,270	2.47
Maryland	386	241	62.4	66	27.4	17,567.37	5,358	3.27
Massachusetts	512	251	49.0	79	31.4	20,059.88	11,777	1.70
Michigan	558	326	58.4	97	29.7	31,246.42	12,015	2.60
Minnesota	484	279	57.6	54	19.3	23,692.61	14,191	1.67
Mississippi	81	43	53.0	10	23.3	2,292.80	1,157	1.98
Missouri	311	189	60.0	36	19.0	11,718.37	4,401	2.66
Montana	96	65	67.7	5	7.7	3,218.33	1,202	2.67
Nebraska	168	108	64.2	25	23.1	7,622.24	2,649	2.87
Nevada	74	43	58.1	15	34.9	2,715.70	1,227	2.21
New Hampshire	91	46	50.5	29	63.0	2,591.00	1,487	1.74
New Jersey	489	222	45.4	81	36.5	26,066.61	8,234	3.17
New Mexico	87	67	77.0	11	16.4	4,120.92	1,171	3.51
New York	1,017	583	57.3	223	38.3	52,521.80	20,838	2.52
North Carolina	252	97	38.4	40	41.2	13,083.05	3,852	3.39
North Dakota	90	59	65.5	2	3.4	3,462.72	1,316	2.63
Ohio	678	366	53.9	54	14.8	25,760.03	12,626	2.04
Oklahoma	167	140	83.8	78	55.7	11,270.30	2,277	4.95
Oregon	151	99	65.5	29	29.3	6,834.50	1,847	3.70
Pennsylvania	561	364	64.8	114	31.3	34,050.63	9,698	3.51
Rhode Island	65	40	61.5	14	35.0	3,413.15	1,030	3.31
South Carolina	106	68	64.1	16	23.5	5,949.89	1,637	3.63
South Dakota	74	48	64.8	2	4.2	4,331.09	1,250	3.46
Tennessee	155	87	56.1	8	9.2	4,287.73	2,173	1.97
Texas	519	318	61.2	87	27.4	27,209.37	14,426	1.88
Utah	85	49	57.6	16	32.7	3,553.60	1,138	3.12
Vermont	54	37	68.5	3	8.1	2,250.35	630	3.57
Virginia	280	205	73.2	58	28.3	16,453.09	4,387	3.75
Washington	357	229	64.1	103	45.0	19,011.31	5,093	3.73
West Virginia	87	54	62.0	16	29.6	3,979.95	962	4.13
Wisconsin	413	236	57.1	40	16.9	13,444.17	5,842	2.30
Wyoming	44	27	61.3	2	7.4	1,384.31	433	3.19
Commonwealth of P.R.	63	42	66.6	10	23.8	2,690.19	1,073	2.50
Canal Zone	3	2	66.6	-0-	-0-	729.11	66	11.04
Bahama Islands	7	-0-	-0-	-0-	-0-	-0-	62	-0-
Virgin Islands of U.S.	4	2	50.0	2	100.0	200.00	16	12.50
TOTAL for U.S.	15,308	8,583	56.1%	2,481	28.9%	\$683,158.04	292,646	\$2.33

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alberta	206	96	46.6%	5	5.2%	\$ 6,238.97	2,172	\$2.87
Atlantic Provinces								
New Brunswick	83	34	40.9	4	11.8	2,067.82	947	2.18
Nfld. & Lab.	29	12	41.4	1	8.3	836.01	326	2.56
Nova Scotia	92	53	57.6	1	1.9	2,936.88	1,019	2.88
Prince Ed. Island	29	17	58.6	-0-	-0-	1,166.88	430	2.71
British Columbia	317	190	59.9	26	13.7	17,466.78	4,115	4.24
Manitoba	98	56	57.1	4	7.1	5,989.97	2,211	2.70
N.W. Territories	8	1	12.5	-0-	-0-	63.52	54	1.17
Ontario	709	402	56.7	100	24.9	50,168.06	10,296	4.87
Quebec	779	373	47.8	82	22.0	16,420.53	20,204	.81
Saskatchewan	159	92	57.8	5	5.4	8,641.95	2,073	4.16
Yukon Terr.	2	1	50.0	-0-	-0-	47.50	56	.84
TOTAL for CANADA	2,511	1,327	52.8%	228	17.2%	\$112,044.87	43,903	\$2.55
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	17,819	9,910	55.6%	2,709	27.3%	\$795,202.91	336,549	\$2.36

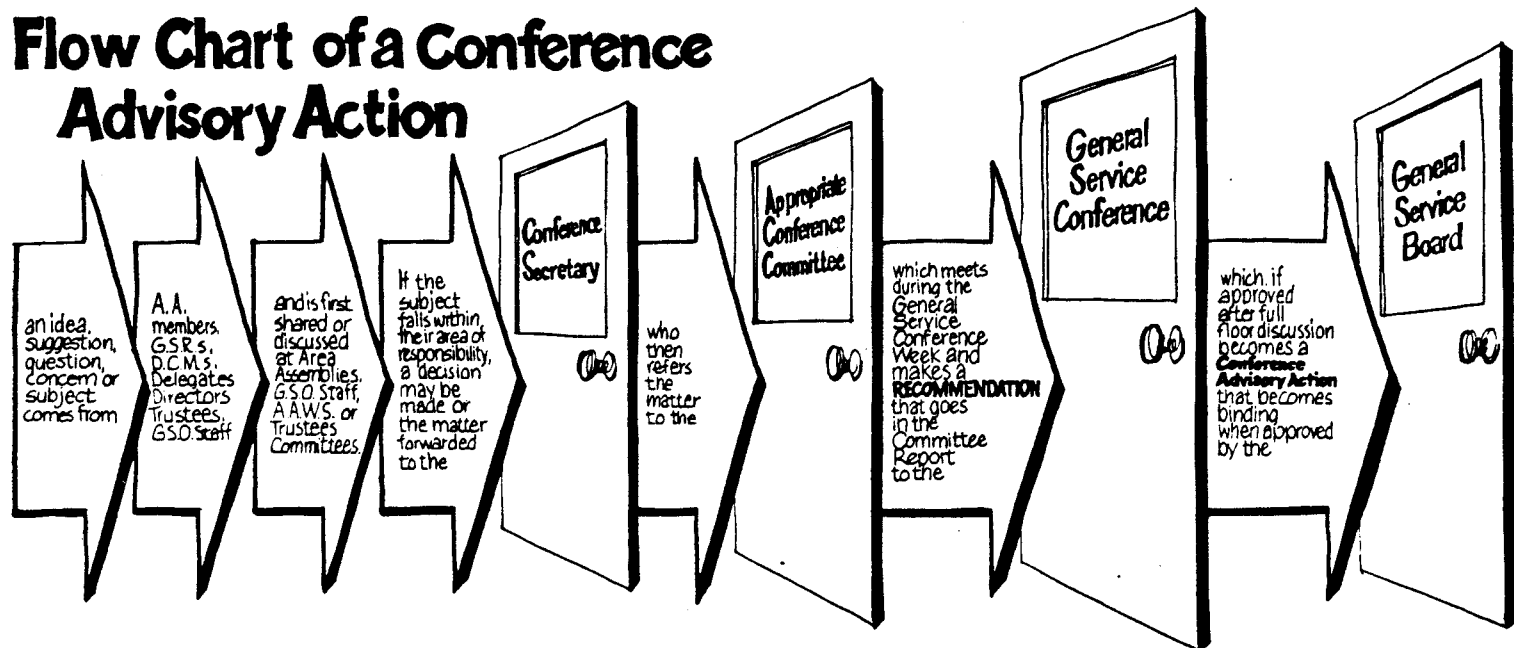
FOREIGN AND OTHER

Foreign	4,222.35
International Doctors in A.A.	250.00
Hospital groups	5,801.17
Prison groups	263.88
Internationalists	750.03
Internationalist groups	1,023.50
GRAND TOTAL	\$807,513.84

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 1975-1974

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. 1975	15,308	8,583	56.1%	2,481	28.9%	\$683,158.04	292,646	\$2.33
U.S. 1974	14,448	8,225	56.9	3,540	43.0	629,816.99	287,863	2.18
Increase								
(Decrease)	860	358	(.8%)(1,059)	(14.1%)		\$ 53,341.05	4,783	\$.15
Canada 1975	2,511	1,327	52.8%	228	17.2%	\$112,044.87	43,903	\$2.55
Canada 1974	2,427	1,377	56.7	488	35.4	110,957.17	42,922	2.59
Increase								
(Decrease)	84	(50)	(3.9%)(260)	(18.2%)		\$ 1,087.70	981	(\$.04)
U.S. and Canada 1975	17,819	9,910	55.6%	2,709	27.3%	\$795,202.91	336,549	\$2.36
U.S. and Canada 1974	16,875	9,602	56.9	4,028	42.0	740,774.16	330,785	2.23
Increase								
(Decrease)	944	308	(1.3%)(1,319)	(14.7%)		\$ 54,428.75	5,764	\$.13

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence, the committees' importance has grown even more." ("The A.A. Service Manual," p. 72)

1976 Trustees' Committees

Archives

George N. Gordon, Ph.D., *chairman*
Lee Belford, Ph.D.
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Nell Wing, *archivist/librarian*
Midge McFadden, *secretary*

Conference

Margaret J. Carlson, *chairman*
James G. Griffin
John E. Waterfield
Peter A. G. Watters
Mary Ellen Welsh, *secretary*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Robert Macpherson, *chairman*
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.,
co-chairman
Andrew W. Abrahams, M.D.
John D. Bealer, M.D.
Thomas P. Carpenter
David T. Cooke
Barry Leach
Gordon M. Patrick
Mike Rainbolt
Ross Von Wiegand
Peter A. G. Watters
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Arthur J. Miles, *chairman*
Michael Alexander
George N. Gordon, Ph.D.
Martin Le Boutillier
Robert Macpherson
Stephen Owen Sr.
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.,
consultant
Robert E. Hitchins, *secretary*

Finance and Budgetary

Arthur J. Miles, *chairman*
Thomas P. Carpenter,
co-chairman
Michael Alexander
John D. Bealer, M.D.
N. M. ("Mac") Cheater
George N. Gordon, Ph.D.
Martin Le Boutillier
Robert Macpherson
R. Bruce Wight
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.,
consultant
Dennis I. Manders, *secretary*

Institutions

Austin MacCormick, *chairman*
Edward Small, *co-chairman*
N. M. ("Mac") Cheater
Vincent P. Dole, M.D.
William S. Dunkin
Joseph Huber Jr.
John McLeon
Jeanette Spencer
Sarah Pierce, *secretary*

International Convention

Terrance Penton, *chairman*
David T. Cooke
Robert Pearson
Stanley R. Wilsey
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Literature

George N. Gordon, Ph.D.,
chairman
Margaret Carlson, *co-chairman*
Paula Carpenter
Fan Content
James G. Griffin
Polly Marsh
Gordon M. Patrick
John E. Ryall
Edward Small
Janet Graves, *consultant*
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Susan Daly, *secretary*

Nominating

Charles H. Hanson, *chairman*
Terrance Penton, *co-chairman*
Austin MacCormick
Walter J. Murphy
John L. Norris, M.D.
John E. Waterfield
R. Bruce Wight
Stanley R. Wilsey
Cora Louise Belford, *secretary*

Policy

James G. Griffin, *chairman*
Margaret Carlson, *co-chairman*
John D. Bealer, M.D.
N. M. ("Mac") Cheater
David T. Cooke
Vincent P. Dole, M.D.
Charles H. Hanson
Robert Macpherson
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Walter J. Murphy
Waneta New
Terrance Penton
Mike Rainbolt
John E. Waterfield
Peter A. G. Watters
Mary Ellen Welsh
R. Bruce Wight
Stanley R. Wilsey
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

Public Information

Walter J. Murphy, *chairman*
Jerry Danzig, *co-chairman*
David Black
John Bragg
Janet Graves
Charles H. Hanson
Virginia Mailman
Jack Morley
Fay Stanley Shulman
Dee Powell, *consultant*
June Russell, *secretary*

Robert E. Hitchins, John L. Norris, M.D., and Robert Pearson are ex-officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

1976 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

- ** Fran Adams, Chicago
- Earl Homuth, E. Ont.
- Clark McCall, Okla.
- *** Jim Wright, Ala./N.W. Fla.

Jerry Frolich, Mid-S. Calif.
George McKerral, N.W. Que.
James Rouse, W. Mich.
Jerry Sullivan, Kans.
Cecil Williams, Mont.

Secretary: Mary Ellen Welsh

Conference Report & Charter

- ** Joan Barclay, Nev.
- *** Fran Green, E. Pa.
- Dede Hoffman, La.
- John Neal, S. Ill.
- Marvin Spooner, S. Minn.

Eugene Daniel, S.W. Tex.
Alvin Engstrom, Idaho
Richard Foster, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
Paul Wright, Md.

Secretary: Waneta New

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Edith Campbell, N.C.
- Buck Raulerson, N. Fla.
- *** Natalie Schwanke, Wash.
- ** Jim Shaw, S. Calif.

William Cochran, Del.
Leonard DeWitt, N. Wis./Upper Mich.
John Gillespie, N.W. Tex.
James Jones, R.I.
Gordon Matkin, Alta.

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Finance

- ** George Dorsey, N. Coastal Calif.
- Raymond Houle, S.E. Que.
- Gus Jowers, Ark.
- Larry Sebastian, W.Va.
- *** Ray Sullivan, E. Mass.

Marvin Karmann, Nebr.
Larry Kloepfel, N.M.
Joe Kraus Jr., Tenn.
William Tarjanyi, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

- ** Don Burow, Colo.
- Fred Forbes, Washington, D.C.
- *** Retha Gresham, S.E. Ohio
- Bernard Scarseth, S. Wis.
- Al Weston, Iowa

Bud Grondahl, N.Dak.
James McCullough, W. N.Y.
John Rose, W. Ont.
Allen Royston, Ga.

Secretary: Paula Carpenter

Institutions

- ** Ike Bowers, Utah
- John Henderson, N.E. Tex.
- Charles McCarthy, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
- *** Ann Nuckols, Va.
- Jim Riley, N. N.J.

Henry F. Cleaveland, Me.
Larry Lassiter, Wyo.
Jeronimo Reyes, P.R.
Jim Smith, Ariz.
Charles Wysocki, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire

Secretary: Sarah Pierce

Literature

- * Jane Allen, W. Pa.
- Joe Holman, N. Ind.
- *** Olga Morris, S.E. Tex.
- ** Bill Syms, N.E. Ont.

Kenneth Dunphy, N.B./P.E.I.
Joe Fuller, Alsk.
Mary Jane LeBlanc, N.H.
Percy Rogers, Ky.
Joan Ullom, S.Dak.

Secretary: Susan Daly

Conference Policy/Admissions

- Byron Barnes, E. Mo.
- Jack Davis, N.W. Ont.
- ** Duane Harder, Cent. Mich.
- * Robert Wall, Cent. N.Y.
- *** Sam Smith, S. Fla.

Maurice Haase, S. Ind.
Margaret Kemp, N. Int. Calif.
Donald Shipp, Miss.
Nancy Thomas, Vt.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann

Public Information

- * Len Jordan, S.E. N.Y.
- Andy Quaid, S.E. Mich.
- ** Warren Russell, Conn.
- *** Abe Wiebe, B.C./Yukon

Jean-Luc Bergevin, S.W. Que.
Maggi Bolton, S. N.J.
Marg Fuller, Man.
Joe Kirby, S.C.
Cliff Roche, San Diego

Secretary: June Russell

Committee on Trustees

- *** Bob Bacon, N.E. Ohio
- Harry Lake, Haw.
- * Jerry Lapointe, N.E. Que.
- ** F. P. Ryan, W. Mo.

Stanley Cameron, Sask.
Earle McNutt, N. Ill.
Vern Radke, N. Minn.
Colette Ross, W. Mass.
Leonard Truitt, Oreg.

Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

1980 International Convention Site Committee

Fran Adams, Chicago
Fran Green, E. Pa.
Clark McCall, Okla.
Charles McCarthy, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
John Neal, S. Ill.
Al Weston, Iowa
Abe Wiebe, B.C./Yukon

Richard Foster, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
Joseph Fuller, Alsk.
Percy Rogers, Ky.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

-
- * Alternate delegate
 - ** Chairman
 - *** Alternate chairman

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

John L. Norris, M.D. (Box 251, New London, N.H. 03257), is chairman of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. He is also a member of the Nominating Committee and was elected to the board in January 1951. Before his retirement, "Dr. Jack" was associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co., Rochester, N.Y. He is former chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and former president of the Industrial Medicine Association and the American Academy of Occupational Medicine.

***Michael Alexander** (150 East 69th St., New York, N.Y. 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., Mike was long an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in the history of A.A. (see "A.A. Comes of Age"). Graduated from the University of Pittsburgh and Harvard Law School, Mike was a captain in the U.S. Army. He is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, past president of the Consular Law Society, a trustee of the Foundation for International Child Health, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry.

John D. Bealer, M.D. (3639 Emerson Circle, Bethlehem, Pa. 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John serves on the Policy and Finance Committees and on the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and is a director of A.A.W.S.

****Vincent P. Dole, M.D.** (Rockefeller University, 66th St. and York Ave., New York, N.Y. 10021), was elected to the board in April 1965. He is a professor and senior physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the Policy and Institutions Committees.

Austin H. MacCormick (Osborne Association, 114 E. 30th St., New York, N.Y. 10016) is first vice-chairman of the General Service Board; was elected to the board in April 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the board previously from October 1949 to April 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a member of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate and Editorial Boards, chairman of the Institutions Committee, and a member of the Nominating Committee.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (86 Mitchell Ave., Piscataway, N.J. 08854), was elected to the board in April 1971. Before his retirement in 1975, he was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A. He serves on the Policy and Archives Committees and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Arthur J. Miles (Dime Savings Bank of New York, Fifth Ave. and 48th St., New York, N.Y. 10017) was elected to the board in 1970. He is an executive vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and is on the board of trustees of the Brooklyn Institute of Arts and Sciences and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He is chairman of the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees, and treasurer of the G.S. Board.

Gordon M. Patrick (Apt. 410, 60 Underhill Dr., Don Mills, Ont. M3R 2J7, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is manager of the Ontario Government Employee Alcoholism Program. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he is now a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism, and serves the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America as vice-chairman of its Occupational Program Section, which he helped to found. He serves on the Literature Committee and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

Margaret J. Carlson (218 Regency Park Dr., Regency Park Apts., Agawam, Mass. 01001) was elected to the board as a general service trustee, U.S., in April 1973. She has had continuous sobriety since 1959 and has been interested in P.I., institutions, honor court, and general service activities. Margaret is a former delegate (Panel 20) and was area delegate chairman in 1971. She is employed as administrator of the Alcoholism Detoxification Center of Greater Springfield. Margaret is a member of the Policy and Literature Committees and chairman of the Conference Committee.

N. M. ("Mac") Cheater (5 Frost Ave., Winnipeg, Man. R3K 0E1 Canada) was elected general service trustee, Canada, in 1975. He had his last drink in 1956. A Panel 12 delegate, Mac introduced Big Book study sessions in his province. He chaired the first winter conference in Manitoba. Mac is sales manager of a television station, is active in civic clubs, and is married. He serves on the Finance, Institutions, and Policy Committees.

David T. Cooke (229 Dublin Rd., Raleigh, N.C. 27609) was elected in 1974 as Southeastern U.S. regional trustee for a three-year term. Dave had his last drink in 1957, began Third Legacy work as G.S.R., and in 1965 became area committee member and officer. He was Conference delegate in 1967-68 and was delegate chairman. Dave served as chairman of his state committee in 1969-70. Married, he has been a high-school teacher and is now a highway engineer for a state department. Dave is a member of the Policy and International Convention Committees and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and a director of A.A.W.S.

***Cecil ("Cec") E. Corrigan** (655 Boulevard Drive, Prince Albert, Sask., Canada S6V 2L9) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in 1976, with 23 years' sobriety. He was a Panel 8 delegate, has chaired the Prince Albert Gateway Roundup, and is an active P.I. speaker. Cec has had two decades of experience in management of ladies' wear and fur businesses, and is also a real estate dealer.

1976 Conference Members

*** **George N. Gordon, Ph.D.** (110-15 71 Rd., Forest Hills, N.Y. 11375), a director and treasurer of the A.A. Grapevine, was elected general service trustee in 1972. Since his last drink, in 1964, he has served his local group in most offices and the New York Intergroup Association on several committees. He is chairman of the Communications Arts Department at Hofstra University in Hempstead, N.Y., and author or co-author of 15 nonfiction books. George is a member of the Finance Committee in the capacity of Grapevine treasurer, a member of the Policy and Employee Retirement Committees, and chairman of the Archives and Literature Committees.

** **James G. Griffin** (302 S. Jefferson, North Platte, Nebr. 69101) was elected trustee from the West Central Region April 1972. He has been sober over 20 years and has served as G.S.R., committee member, chairman of the state committee, and delegate (Panel 18). He is married, owns and pilots his own plane, and has had a successful career for 18 years in the insurance business. He is a member of the Policy, Literature, and Conference Committees.

Charles H. Hanson (42 Puritan Rd., Fairfield, Conn. 06430) was elected general service trustee in 1975. He is chairman of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Nominating Committee, and serves on the Public Information Committee. Chuck had his last drink in 1966. A frequent Grapevine contributor, he is married and the father of three. He is now president of an advertising agency, after supervisory duties in three of the best-known Madison Avenue firms.

Robert Macpherson (Rocktree Apts., P.O. Box 192, Pleasant Valley, Conn. 06063) was elected to the board in July 1973. He had his last drink in 1947 and has been an active member of the same group since 1949. Bob was a member of the first Connecticut General Service Assembly in 1951 and a Panel 9 delegate. His business life was in office management and accounting. Bob is married and retired, with a small accounting and tax practice. He serves on the Policy, Finance, and Employee Retirement Committees, and is chairman of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Walter J. Murphy (401 E. 81st St., New York, N.Y. 10028) was elected general service trustee in 1973. He has been active in A.A. for 16 years. He is currently chairman of A.A.W.S. and the Public Information Committee and is a member of the Nominating and Policy Committees. He is public relations counsel for N.C.A., its New York City affiliate, and the Smithers Alcoholism Center. He is married and has one son.

* **Don Nicolson** (1015 5th Avenue North — #12, Moorhead, Minn. 56560), elected West Central regional trustee in 1976, had his last drink in 1948. He was a Panel 12 delegate, after years as a D.C.M., and is still active in his home group. He lectures in the alcoholism treatment unit of a hospital, and has co-sponsored an Alateen group. Don is partner in a company holding 25 franchised food stores in eight states.

** **Terrance Penton** (132 28th St., Brandon, Man., Canada), was elected in 1974 to serve the last two years of retiring Matt Newell's unexpired term as a regional trustee for Western Canada. Then sober 14 years, Terry served on roundup and area G.S. committees and as delegate (Panel 20). He owns an estate-planning consulting firm, serves on the Policy, Nominating, and International Convention Committees.

Mike Rainbolt (P.O. Box 248, Cordell, Okla. 73632). When elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in 1975, Mike had 28 years' sobriety. After group and area service, he was a Panel 15 delegate, later chaired his state P.I. committee, and is still active in state A.A. An alumnus of Oklahoma University, Mike has a background in real estate and land titles and is a petroleum landman, operating his own oil and gas exploration firm. He serves on the Policy Committee and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

* **Edward J. Small** (165 Christopher St., New York, N.Y. 10014) had his last drink in 1965, when he joined Brooklyn's Park Slope Group. After stints at all group jobs, including G.S.R., Ed served New York Intergroup and became a regular Grapevine contributor. He is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Literature Committee, and co-chairman of the Institutions Committee. Educated at Brooklyn College and Rutgers University, Ed directs a health program for a large publishing firm and belongs to several professional societies interested in alcoholism. He begins serving as a general service (New York) trustee in August 1976.

John E. Waterfield (2900 Adams Mill Road, Washington, D.C. 20009) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 18 years' sobriety. John was a Panel 23 delegate, having served previously in many group, intergroup, and G.S. area capacities in A.A., as well as on his local alcoholism council. He set up a one-to-one "sponsorship" program for informing medical students about A.A., and originated the mini-conference idea. Married, John has his own creative advertising and marketing business. He serves on the Nominating and Policy Committees.

Peter A.G. Watters (366 Rebecca St., Oakville, Ont., Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1974. Pete has been sober since 1960. He was chairman of Toronto Intergroup 1965-66, Conference delegate 1967-68, and chairman of the Ontario G.S. Committee. He has been on advisory committees to local recovery and addiction-research facilities. Single, Pete is vice-president and owner of an education products distributorship. He serves on the Policy, Nominating, and Conference Committees and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

R. Bruce Wight (2336 North Lewis Ave., Waukegan, Ill. 60085) was elected in 1974 to a three-year term as East Central U.S. regional trustee. Bruce had his last drink in 1951. He was Conference delegate on Panel 14, and is still on his area G.S. committee. He is president of a manufacturing corporation. His wife, Helen, is also in A.A. Bruce is on the Policy, Finance, and Nominating Committees, and is an A.A.W.S. director.

Stanley R. Wilsey (110 Toyon Drive, Fairfax, Calif. 94930) had been sober 23 years when elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1974. Stan has been a Conference delegate and editor of *Good News*, local A.A. newspaper, and was advisory co-chairman of the 1960 International A.A. Convention in Long Beach. He supervises investigation for a state department concerned with registration of vehicles and the licensing of drivers. Stan is a member of the Policy, Nominating, and International Convention Committees.

*New trustee

**Retiring as of April 1976

***Retiring as of August 1976

A.A. World Services directors

Walter Murphy, *chairman*
 Robert Hitchins, *president*
 Jerry Danzig, *first vice-president*
 Beth Kuhlmann, *second vice-president*

Robert Macpherson, *treasurer*
 John D. Bealer, M.D.
 David Cooke
 Martin Le Boutillier
 Bruce Wight

A.A. Grapevine directors

Charles H. Hanson, *chairman, president*
 Paula Carpenter, *vice-president, secretary*
 George Gordon, *treasurer*
 Austin MacCormick

Polly Marsh
 Jack Morley
 John Ryall
 Fred J. Sengstacke
 Edward Small

General Service Office staff

Robert Hitchins, *chairman, General Services*
 Robert Pearson, *general manager*
 Midge McFadden, *assistant to manager*
 Cora Louise Belford
 Susan Daly

Beth Kuhlmann
 Yolanda Lazo
 Betty Liddle
 Phyllis Masback
 Waneta New
 Sarah Pierce
 June Russell
 Mary Ellen Welsh

Grapevine staff

Paula Carpenter, *managing editor*
 Jack Morley, *editor*

Others attending Conference (not as voting members)

Non-A.A.

Donna Berkowitz, *office manager*
 Charles Columbia, *assistant controller*
 Al Cryan, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
 Mary Feeley, *supervisor, Stenographic Department*
 Edward Gordon, *assistant controller*
 Kleina Jones, *departmental coordinator/personnel manager*
 Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
 John Kirwin, *supervisor, Accounting Department*
 Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
 Dennis Manders, *controller*
 Dorothy McGinity, *assistant to the Conference secretary*
 Nell Wing, *archivist*
 Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*

A.A.

Janet Graves, *production, Conference Report*
 Lou Huston, *Grapevine staff*
 Barry Leach, *editor, Conference Report*
 Dee Powell, *literature consultant*
 Ann Warner, *Grapevine staff*
 Two observers from Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community
 Two observers from Finance Committee
 Two observers from Grapevine Editorial Board
 Two observers from Institutions Committee
 Two observers from Literature Committee
 Two observers from Public Information Committee

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 26th Conference includes Panel 25 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 26 (new delegates).

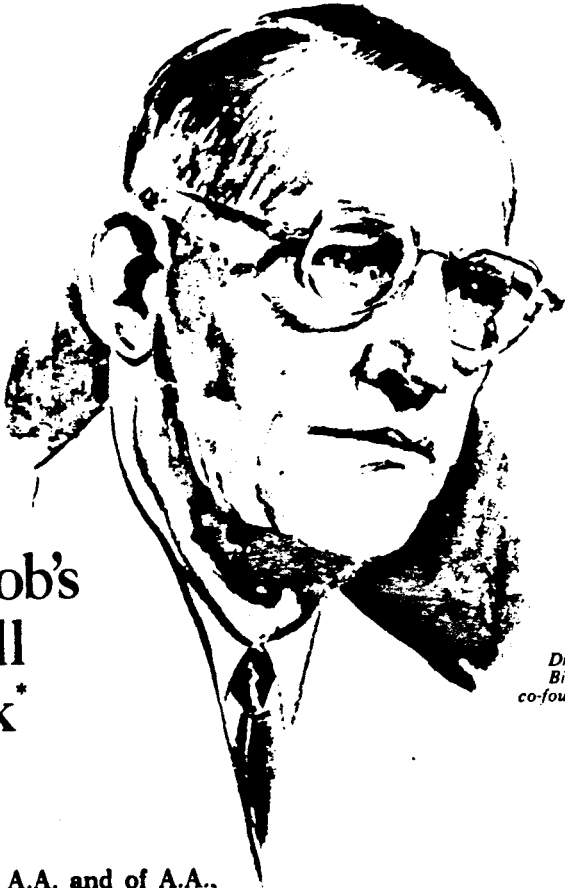
State	Panel
Alabama & N.W. Florida	(25) James E. (Jim) Wright, 406 Woodrow Street, Fort Walton Beach, FL 32548
Alaska	(26) Joseph L. (Joe) Fuller, 1438 Medfra, Anchorage, AK 99501
Arizona	(26) James W. (Jim) Smith, 4461 E. Flower Street, Phoenix, AZ 85018
Arkansas	(25) James A. (Gus) Jowers, 218 Garfield Avenue, Newport, AR 72112
California	(25) Northern Coastal – George Dorsey, 4761 Paradise Drive, Tiburon, CA 94920 (26) Northern Interior – Margaret Kemp, 809 Kagle Avenue, Broderick, CA 95605 (26) San Diego – Cliff Roche, 602 Brooks Street, Oceanside, CA 92054 (26) Mid-Southern – Gerald (Jerry) Frolich, 6472 Weber Circle, Huntington Beach, CA 92647 (25) Southern – Jim Shaw, 8815 Steward Avenue, Los Angeles, CA 90045
Colorado	(25) Don Burow, 412 East 11th Street, Loveland, CO 80537
Connecticut	(25) Warren Russell, 31 Andover Road, East Hartford, CT 06108
Delaware	(26) William A. (Bill) Cochran, 134 East Second Street, New Castle, DE 19720
District of Columbia	(25) Fred Forbes, 5147 Massachusetts Avenue, Bethesda, MD 20016
Florida	(25) Northern – S. A. (Buck) Raulerson, 429 Second Avenue N., Jacksonville Beach, FL 32250 (25) Southern – Samuel E. (Sam) Smith, 820 N.W. 87th Avenue, Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126
Georgia	(26) E. Allen (Al) Royston, 3255 Artesia Drive, Clarkston, GA 30021
Hawaii	(25) Harry Lake, 1303 C. Kipaipai, Pearl City, HI 96782
Idaho	(26) Alvin (Swede) Engstrom, Box 294, Ucon, ID 86454

1976 Conference Members

State	Panel	State	Panel
Illinois	(25) Chicago – Fran Adams, 3310 Grant, Evanston, IL 60201	Nebraska	(26) Marvin L. Karmann, 1550 E. Dodge Street, Fremont, NE 68025
	(26) Northern – Earle McNutt, P.O. Box 380, Chicago, IL 60617	Nevada	(25) Joan A. Barclay, 1520 Arthur Avenue, Las Vegas, NV 89101
	(25) Southern – John Neal, Box 68, Louisville, IL 62858	New Hampshire	(26) Mary Jane LeBlanc, Box 70, Derry, NH 03038
Indiana	(25) Northern – Joseph (Joe) Holman, 1418 Fletcher Avenue, Fort Wayne, IN 45803	New Jersey	(25) Northern – James Riley, 3 Pearl Street, Dumont, NJ 07628
	(26) Southern – Maurice Haase, 310 Maple Lane, Mooresville, IN 46158		(26) Southern – Margaret (Maggi) Bolton, 3100 Chapel Avenue, Cherry Hill, NJ 08002
Iowa	(25) H. A. (Al) Weston, 2621 Guthrie, Des Moines, IA 50316	New Mexico	(26) Lawrence (Larry) Kloeppel, 509 Tascosa, N.W., Albuquerque, NM 87107
Kansas	(26) Jerry L. Sullivan, P.O. Box 544, Ulysses, KS 67880	New York	(25) *Central – Robert Wall, P.O. Box 51, 179 Front Street, Owego, NY 13827
Kentucky	(26) Percy Rogers, R.R. 1, Box 185, Vine Grove, KY 40175		(26) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Charles Wysocki, 345 Spring Avenue, Troy, NY 12180
Louisiana	(25) Dede Hoffmann, 1225 Trudeau Drive, Metairie, LA 70003		(25) *Southeastern – Leonard J. (Len) Jordan, 483 West End Avenue, New York, NY 10024
Maine	(26) Henry F. (Hank) Cleaveland, Box 41, New Sharon, ME 04955		(26) Western – James (Jim) McCullough, 640 Tionesta Avenue, Kane, PA 16735
Maryland	(26) Paul Wright, 1553 Harford Square Drive, Edgewood, MD 21040		(25) Edith Campbell, Box 181, Chapel Hill, NC 27514
Massachusetts	(25) Eastern – Ray Sullivan, 180 Broadway, Lynn, MA 01904	North Carolina	
	(26) Western – Colette Ross, 47 Mayfair Street, East Longmeadow, MA 01028	North Dakota	(26) M. T. (Bud) Grondahl, P.O. Box 1303, Fargo, ND 58102
Michigan	(25) Central – Duane Harder, 2144 South Unionville Road, Bay Port, MI 48720	Ohio	(25) Central & Southeastern – Retha M. Gresham, 959 Woodhill Drive, Columbus, OH 43212
	(25) Southeastern – Andrew (Andy) Quaid Jr., 634 Lakewood Boulevard, Detroit, MI 48215		(25) Northeastern – Robert (Bob) Bacon, 958 Brittain Road, Akron, OH 44305
	(26) Western – James Rouse, 10790 Kenowa, N.W., Sparta, MI 49345		(26) N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – Bill J. (Banjo) Tarjanyi, 364 Crestway Drive, Oregon, OH 43616
Minnesota	(26) Northern – Vern Radke, 512 Eighth Avenue S.W., Grand Rapids, MN 55744		(26) S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Richard Foster, 145 West Main Street, Williamsburg, OH 45176
	(26) Southern – Marvin Spooner, 7300 Thirteenth Avenue S., Richfield, MN 55423	Oklahoma	(25) Clark McCall, 439 N.W. 44th Street, Oklahoma City, OK 73118
Mississippi	(26) Donald G. (Don) Shipp, 402 School Street, Clarksdale, MS 38614	Oregon	(26) Leonard Truitt, P.O. Box 83, Warrenton, OR 97146
Missouri	(25) Eastern – Byron Barnes, 7 East 9th, Fulton, MO 65251	Pennsylvania	(25) Eastern – Francis A. (Fran) Green, 34 Berger Street, Emmaus, PA 18049
	(25) Western – F. P. Ryan, P.O. Box 613, Marshall, MO 65340		(25) *Western – Jane W. Allen, 456 Woodland Road, Pittsburgh, PA 15237
Montana	(26) Cecil Williams, P.O. Box 2712, Missoula, MT 59801		

*Alternate delegate

State	Panel	Canada	Panel
Rhode Island	(26) James Jones, P.O. Box 3562, Cranston, RI 02910	Province	
South Carolina	(26) Joseph A. (Joe) Kirby, P.O. Box 146, St. George, SC 29477	Alberta	(26) Gordon Matkin, 430 27th Street, Lethbridge, Alta.
South Dakota	(26) Joan Ullom, Aurora, SD 57002	British Columbia/ Yukon	(25) Abe Wiebe, 4446 Quebec Street, Vancouver, B.C. V5V 3L7
Tennessee	(26) Joe Kraus Jr., P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464	Manitoba	(26) Marg Fuller, 40 Almond Crescent, Brandon, Man. R7B 1A1
Texas	(25) Northeastern - John B. Henderson, P.O. Box 754, Linden, TX 75563	New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	(26) Kenneth L. (Ken) Dunphy, 115 Humphrey Street, Moncton, N.B., E1C 6P2
	(26) Northwestern - John Gillespie, P.O. Box 3493, Borger, TX 79007	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	(25) *Charles McCarthy, 6 Wyncrest Drive, Dartmouth, NS B2X 1C6
	(25) Southeastern - Olga Morris, P.O. Box 276, Friendswood, TX 77546	Ontario	(25) Eastern - Earl G. Homuth, 152 Laurier Avenue, Pembroke, Ont. K8A 2J2
	(26) Southwestern - Eugene C. (Gene) Daniel, 207 Larmie, San Antonio, TX 78209		(25) Northeastern - W. J. (Bill) Syms, 70 McNabb, Sault Ste. Marie, Ont.
Utah	(25) Ike Bowers, 5072 El Amador, Salt Lake City, UT 84117		(25) Northwestern - Jack Davis, 123 East Francis Street, Thunder Bay F, Ont.
Vermont	(26) Nancy Thomas, 109 High Street, St. Albans, VT 05478		(26) Western - John Rose, 1-15 Orchard Heights, Chatham, Ont. N7M 3G5
Virginia	(25) Ann Nuckols, 3301 Clover Hill Drive, Portsmouth, VA 23703	Quebec	(25)**Northeastern - Jerry Lapointe, 946 Dumas Street, St. Jean Chrysostome, Quebec, Que.
Washington	(25) Natalie Schwanke, 15223 N.E. 15th, Apt. 3305, Bellevue, WA 98007		(26) Northwestern - George McKerral, 99 Eleventh Street, Laval des Rapides, Que. H7N 1T2
West Virginia	(25) Larry Sebastian, 310 Maryland Avenue, Clarksburg, WV 26301		(25) Southeastern - Raymond Houle, 449 Notre Dame Ouest, Victoriaville, Que. G6P 1S7
Wisconsin	(26) N. Wisconsin/Upper Michigan - E. Leonard DeWitt, 406 North Street, Ishpeming, MI 49846		(26) Southwestern - Jean-Luc Bergevin, 1761 des Amarantes, Ile Goyer (Chambly), Que. J3L 3P9
	(25) Southern - Bernard Scarseth, 1524 South 22nd Street, LaCrosse, WI 54601	Saskatchewan	(26) Stanley N. (Stan) Cameron, 1513 Hilliard Street, Saskatoon, Sask.
Wyoming	(26) Larry W. (Turk) Lassiter, River Route, Box 34, Basin, WY 82410	*Charles McCarthy died on May 12, 1976; his term will be filled by the alternate delegate, Michael (Mike) Fleming, 630 Thompson Street, New Waterford, N.S.	
Puerto Rico	(26) Jeronimo Reyes Jr., Q19 Las Mercedes Street, Villa Espana, Bayamon, PR 00619	**Alternate delegate	



Dr. Bob's farewell talk*

*Dr. Bob and
Bill W. were
co-founders of A.A.*

My good friends in A.A. and of A.A.,

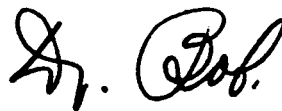
...I get a big thrill out of looking over a vast sea of faces like this with a feeling that possibly some small thing I did a number of years ago played an infinitely small part in making this meeting possible. I also get quite a thrill when I think that we all had the same problem. We all did the same things. We all get the same results in proportion to our zeal and enthusiasm and stick-to-itiveness. If you will pardon the injection of a personal note at this time, let me say that I have been in bed five of the last seven months and my strength hasn't returned as I would like, so my remarks of necessity will be very brief.

There are two or three things that flashed into my mind on which it would be fitting to lay a little emphasis. One is the simplicity of our program. Let's not louse it all up with Freudian complexes and things that are interesting to the scientific mind, but have very little to do with our actual A.A. work. Our Twelve Steps, when simmered down to the last, resolve themselves into the words "love" and "service." We understand what love is, and we understand what service is. So let's bear those two things in mind.

Let us also remember to guard that erring member the tongue, and if we must use it, let's use it with kindness and consideration and tolerance.

And one more thing: None of us would be here today if somebody hadn't taken time to explain things to us, to give us a little pat on the back, to take us to a meeting or two, to do numerous little kind and thoughtful acts in our behalf. So let us never get such a degree of smug complacency that we're not willing to extend, or attempt to extend, to our less fortunate brothers that help which has been so beneficial to us.

Thank you very much.



*From Dr. Bob's brief remarks on Sunday, July 3, 1950, at the First International A.A. Convention, in Cleveland, Ohio.